

ELEMENTS OF THEOLOGY.

ON THE ONE.

PROPOSITION I.

All multitude participates in a certain respect of *the one*.

FOR if it in no respect participates of *the one*, neither will the whole be one whole, nor each of the many from which the multitude is composed: but each of these will also be multitude, and this will be the case in infinitum; and each of these infinites will again be infinite multitude. For if it in no respect participates of *the one*, neither according to its whole self, nor according to each of its parts, every where, and throughout there will be infinite multitude. For each of these *manys*, which

* I have already mentioned this admirable work, with the praise it so justly deserves, in my account of the life and writings of Proclus. (Vol. I. of this work, p. 38.) I now add, with great pleasure that I have been no less fortunate with respect to the translation of these Elements than in translating the commentaries of Proclus. For the Greek text, is very frequently defective in parts essential to the meaning; and consequently necessary to the perfection of the whole. This defect I have been able to supply from a Latin version of Patricius (Ferrar. 1583) who appears to have had a perfect manuscript in his possession. But notwithstanding this assistance, I must freely own, that I never translated any thing which required so much intense thought, and severe labour in its execution. This indeed must necessarily be the case, if the abstruseness of the subject, the difficulty of finding proper terms, and the defects of the original, are properly considered. But the learned reader may be experimentally convinced of the truth of this assertion, if he only compares the Greek text with the Latin version of Amilius Portus; in which I am sorry to say, he will scarcely find one proposition, in which Portus has not mistaken the sense of his author. Indeed were I disposed to entertain the critical reader, I might swell the volume with copious notes from the blunders of Portus; and display the superiority of my own version by contrasting the English with the Latin. But I consider verbose criticisms of this kind as both useless and pedantic; as remote from the philosophical genius; and as alone calculated to fill up the leisure hours of men, who have ruined their understandings in the study of words. The genuine Platonist who may be ignorant of Greek, will I per-

which ever you assume, will either be *one* or *not one*, will either be multitude or nothing. But if each of these manys be nothing, that which is composed from them shall also be nothing. But if each be many, then each shall consist from infinite infinities. But these consequencies are impossible. Since no being is composed from infinite infinities*. For there is nothing greater than infinite. But that which is constituted from all is greater than each particular. Nor can any thing be composed from nothing. All multitude therefore participates in a certain respect of *the one*.

PROPOSITION II.

Every thing which participates of the one, is both *one* and *not one*.

FOR if it be not *the one itself* (*αὐτὸς*) (since it participates of *the one*) because it is something different from *the one*, it suffers *the one*, by participation, and sustains itself to become one. If then it be nothing else besides *the one*, it is one alone, and does not participate of the one, but is *the one itself*. But if it be something different from *the one*, which is not *the one*, but its participant, it is both *not one* and *one*, not indeed the self-subsisting *one*, but *one being*, as participating of the *one itself*. This then is neither *one*, nor does it subsist as *the one*, but it is *one being*, at the same time participating of *the one*, and on this account, since it is not the self-subsisting one, it is both *one* and *not one*, because it is something different from *the one*. For so far as it abounds it is *not one*; but so far as it is passive from participation, it becomes *one*. Every thing therefore which participates of one, is both *one*, and *not one*.

I persuade myself, rejoice to see this invaluable treasure in his native tongue: and those who have been led to consider the theology of the heathens as delusion, and absurdity, will doubtless be surprized to find, that it is replete with the sublimest knowledge, and the most important truths. Yet I must admonish the reader, that these Elements cannot be understood by any one, who is not a thorough adept in the preceding Commentaries on Euclid: for the propositions relate to the most abstract subjects that can be conceived; and the demonstrations are uncommonly subtle and profound. Indeed if opportunity permitted, I should attempt a commentary on every proposition: but this if ever I should be able to accomplish it, must be reserved for some more auspicious period. In the mean time I hope that my occasional elucidations, will be acceptable to the Platonic reader, and assist him in the study of this inestimable work. I only add, that these Elements form an admirable introduction to the six books of Proclus on Plato's theology.

* The absurdity of this consequence consists in this, that from the hypothesis of unity being excluded, infinite infinities would subsist separate from each other, without any bond of conciliating unity; which is evidently impossible. For though every line contains infinite infinities in *capacity*, because the smallest part of every line is capable of infinite division; yet these infinities in capacity are connected by the power of unity, and form one finite line.

PROPOSITION III.

Every thing which becomes one, becomes so through the participation of one; and is one, so far as it suffers the participation of one.

FOR if things which are not one, become one, it must be by a conjunction, and communication with each other: and they will sustain the presence of one, without being *one itself*. Hence they will participate one, so far as they suffer themselves to become one. For if they are already one, they will not become one: since that which is, does not become that which it already is. But if they are formed from non-one, and privation, they will in the first place possess one, from some *one*, being ingenerated in their nature.

PROPOSITION IV.

Every thing united, is different from the *one itself*.

FOR if it is united it will participate of one, so far as it is called united. And that which participates of one is both one, and non-one. But *one itself*, is by no means one and non-one. For if this also was both one and non-one, the one which it contains will also possess both, and this in infinitum; since there is no *one itself* in which the progression can stop; but every thing will be both one and non-one. That which is united therefore is something different from one. For if that which is united was the same with one, one would be infinite multitude; and in like manner each of the parts from which the united nature is composed.

PROPOSITION V.

All multitude is posterior to the one itself.

FOR if multitude is prior to the one, the one indeed will participate of multitude, but the multitude which is prior to the one, will not participate of the one: since it is multitude prior to the subsistence of the one. For it cannot participate that which is not: because that which participates of the one, is both one and non-one. But the one does not yet subsist, since multitude is the first. It is however impossible, that there
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should be any multitude, which in no respect participates of the one. Multitude therefore is not prior to the one. But if multitude subsists together with the one, it will be of the same order with the one: for time cannot hinder such a conjunction. Hence neither the one can be essentially many, nor multitude one, because they are at the same time contra-distinguished; since neither is prior, or posterior to the other. Multitude therefore will not be essentially one, and every thing it contains will be a non-one, and this in infinitum, which is impossible. Hence it naturally participates of the one, nor can any part of it be assumed which is not one: for if any part is not one, it will be an infinite composed from infinities, as we have demonstrated. And hence it entirely participates of the one. But if the one which is one itself, in no respect participates of multitude, multitude will be perfectly posterior to the one; participating indeed of the one, but not participated by the one. But if the one should participate of multitude in such a manner as to exist as one according to subsistence, but as not one according to participation; the one itself will be multiplied, in the same manner as multitude is united by the one. Hence the one will communicate with multitude, and multitude with the one. But things which coalesce, and communicate after a manner with each other, if they are congregated by something else, that something must have a prior existence. But if they connect themselves, they are not opposed to each other: for opposites do not hasten to a mutual conjunction. But if the one, and multitude have a contrary division, and multitude, so far as multitude, is not one, and the one so far as one, is not multitude; hence the one cannot subsist in the other: for they would be at the same time both one and two. But if there be any thing prior to the one, and multitude which collects them into one, this will either be one, or non-one. And if non-one, it will either be many, or nothing. But it is not many; lest multitude should be prior to the one. Nor is it nothing: for how can that congregate which is nothing? Hence it is the one alone. For this one is not also many, lest we should advance in an infinite progression. It is therefore the one itself; and all multitude proceeds from the one.

CONCERNING UNITY.

PROPOSITION VI.

Every multitude is either composed from things united, or from unities.

FOR that every one of things many is not multitude alone, is evident; and it is likewise clear that each part of this multitude again, is not multitude alone. But if it be not multitude alone, it is either united, or unities. And indeed if it participates of unity it is united: but if it be composed from things primarily united, it is unities. For
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f there be one itself, there is also that which primarily participates the one, and is primarily united. But this is composed from unities. For if it is composed from things united, these are again united from certain others, and this will take place in infinitum. But it is requisite that a nature which is primarily united, should be composed from unities. And thus we have discovered what we proposed in the beginning.

Concerning PRODUCING CAUSES, and THINGS PRODUCED.

PROPOSITION VII.

Every thing productive of another, is more excellent than the nature of the thing produced.

FOR it is either more excellent, or worse, or equal. Let it be in the first place, equal.

That which is produced from this therefore, will itself also, either possess a power productive of some other, or it will be entirely barren. But if it be barren, it will on this account be worse than its producing cause: and because of its inefficacy, it will be unequal to that which is prolific, and possesses a productive power. But if it be productive of other natures, it will either produce that which is equal to itself (and this will be the case in all things, and all beings will be equal to each other, and nothing will be more excellent than another, since the productive nature, always constitutes the thing produced equal to itself), or that which is unequal. But in this case, it will not be equal to its producing cause: for it is the property of equal powers to fabricate equal effects. But the productions of these are unequal to each other, since on this hypothesis the producing cause, is equal to that which is prior to itself, but that which is posterior is unequal to it. It is requisite, therefore, that the thing produced should not be equal to its producing cause.

But neither can the producing cause be ever worse than the thing produced. For if the producing cause, confers essence on the thing produced, it bestows power also, according to essence. And if it is productive of all the power which that posterior to itself possesses, it can also make itself such as its production. But if it can do this, it will also make itself more powerful: for impotence cannot hinder, since a fabricative power is present, nor a defect of will: for all things naturally desire good. Hence if it can form any thing else more perfect, it will also perfect itself, before it perfects that which is posterior to itself. The thing produced, therefore, is neither equal to, nor more excellent than its producing cause: and hence the producing cause is entirely more excellent than the nature of the thing produced.

On

On the FIRST GOOD, which is called THE GOOD ITSELF.

PROPOSITION VIII.

The first good which is no other than good itself, precedes all the participants of good.

FOR if all beings desire good, it is evident that the first good is above beings. For if he is the same with any one being, either being is the same with the good, and so this particular being, will no longer be desirous of good, since it is the good itself; for that which desires any thing, is indigent of that which it desires, and by its desire is different and foreign: or being and the good are different; and the good, will indeed participate of being, and being of the good. It is, therefore, a particular good resident in some particular participant, but not good simple and universal, and which all beings desire: for this is the common object of desire to all beings. But that which is generated in another, participates alone of that, in which it is generated. The first good therefore is nothing besides good. For if you add any thing else, by addition you diminish the good itself; effecting a particular good, instead of good simple and universal. For that which is added, since it is not good itself, but something less, diminishes by its essence the good itself.

Concerning that which is SUFFICIENT TO ITSELF.

PROPOSITION IX.

Every thing sufficient to itself, either according to essence, or according to energy, is more excellent than that which is insufficient, and the cause of whose perfection depends on another cause.

FOR if all beings, naturally desire good, and one thing supplies itself with good, but another is indigent of something else; the former, will indeed have the cause of good present, but the latter separate and apart. By how much the nearer, therefore, that is which affords the object of desire, by so much the more excellent will it be than that which requires a separate cause, and externally receives the perfection of its being or energy. Besides, that which is sufficient, is both similar and diminished, and more similar to the good itself. It is diminished, because it participates good, and because it is not the first good. Yet it is in some respect allied to the good, because it can possess good from itself. But that which participates, and participates through another, is more distant from the first good, which is nothing else than good.

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PROPOSITION X.

Every thing sufficient to itself is worse than that which is simply good.

FOR what is that which is sufficient, than that which from itself, and in itself, possesses good? But this is now full of good, which also it participates: but it is not the simply good. For that, as has been demonstrated, is more excellent than the participation and repletion of good. If then that which is sufficient fills itself with good, that from which it fills itself will be more excellent than that which is sufficient, and will be superior to sufficiency: for that which is simply good is not indigent of any thing. For it does not desire any other; since by desire it would be imperfect; and thus would be full of good, and not the first good.

CONCERNING CAUSE.

PROPOSITION XI.

All beings proceed from one first cause.

FOR either there is no cause of beings, or the causes of all terminated beings revolve in a circle, or there is an infinite ascent of causes; so that one thing is the cause of another, and the prior subsistence (*πρὸ τῆς οὐσίας*) of essence, no where stops its progression. But if there be no cause of beings, neither will there be an order of things second and first; of the perfecting, and perfect; of the adorning, and adorned; of the generating, and generated; of the active and passive: nor will there be any science of beings. For the knowledge of causes is the employment of science: and we then assert that we know, when we know the causes of beings. But if causes revolve in a circle, the same causes will be both prior and posterior, more powerful and more debile. For every thing which produces is more excellent than the nature of the thing produced. But there is no difference, whether we conjoin the cause with the thing caused by many, or fewer mediums, and place the thing caused as subordinate. For the cause is more excellent than all the intervening natures of which it is the cause: and by how much the greater the number of mediums, by so much the more is it a cause. But if there be an addition of causes in infinitum, and one always proceeds from another; on this hypothesis likewise science cannot subsist: for there is no knowledge of infinities. But causes being unknown, neither can there be any science of things

things subsequent to causes. If, therefore, it is requisite that there should be a cause of beings, and causes are distinct from things caused, and there can be no infinite ascent; there will be a first cause of beings, from which as a root particulars proceed, some of which exist in propinquity, and others at a distance from his nature. For that it is necessary there should be one principle, is demonstrated; because all multitude is secondary to the one.

PROPOSITION XII.

The principle and first cause of all beings is the good.

FOR if all things proceed from one cause, it is requisite to call that cause, either the good, or more excellent than the good. But if it be more excellent than the good, we ask whether *any thing* emanates from this cause into beings, and into the nature of beings, or *nothing*? And indeed if nothing, it will be absurd: for we cannot, on this hypothesis, any longer preserve it in the order of a cause; since it is every where requisite that something should be present from the cause to the things caused, and especially from the first cause, from which all things depend, and through which every being exists. But if there is a participation of this first cause in beings, in the same manner as there is of the good, there will be something more excellent than goodness, penetrating into beings from the first cause. For since it is more excellent, and superior to the good, it cannot bestow on secondary natures any thing worse than the benefits distributed by that which is posterior to itself. But what can be more excellent than goodness itself? Since we apply the term *more excellent* to that which participates more of the good. If then that which is non-good, is not more excellent, it must be posterior to the good. But if, likewise, all beings desire good, how can any thing be prior to this cause? For if good also desires, how can it be good in the most eminent degree? But if it does not desire, must not all beings desire that cause of all, from which they proceed? And if it is the good itself, from which all beings depend, the good must be the principle and first cause of all.

PROPOSITION XIII.

Every Good is endued with a power of uniting its participants, and every union is good; and *the good itself*, is the same with *the one*.

FOR if the good itself is the preserver of all beings, and on this account is desirable by all, but the one itself, preserves and contains the essence of each: (for all things

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are preserved by the one, and dispersion removes every thing from essence) hence the good causes those things to be one, to which it is present, and contains them by union. But if the one is endued with a congregating and containing power, it perfects every being by its presence: and hence it is good to all things to be united. But if union is essentially good, and good is unific (or unifying), the simply good, and the simply one is the same: at the same time uniting, and benefiting beings. Hence it is, that things which in a certain respect fall from good, are also deprived of the participation of one: and that things which are destitute of the one, because they are replete with separation, are after the same manner likewise deprived of good.

C O R O L L A R Y.

Hence both goodness is union, and union is goodness; and the good is the one, and the one is the first good.

Concerning an IMMOVEABLE, and SELF-MOTIVE PRINCIPLE
OR CAUSE.

P R O P O S I T I O N XIV.

Every being is either immoveable, or moved; and if moved, it is either moved by itself, or by another.

IN the first place if it is moved by itself, it is self-motive, but if by another, it is alter-motive (*irregulator*.) Every being therefore, is either immoveable, or self-motive, or alter-motive. For it is necessary, that since there are alter-motive natures, there should be something immoveable, and between these, a self-motive nature. For if every thing alter-motive, when in motion is moved by another, motions are either performed in a circle, or in infinitum. But they can neither subsist in a circle, nor in infinitum, since all beings are terminated by a principle, and the motive nature, is more excellent than the thing moved. Something immoveable therefore will be the first mover. But if this be the case, it is necessary that there should be something self-motive. For should all things stand still, what will that be which is first moved? It cannot be the immoveable itself, for motion is not natural to this. Nor the alter-motive, for it is moved by another. It remains therefore that the self-motive, must be that which is first moved; since it is this which unites the alter-motive to the immoveable, existing as a medium, moving, and at the same time moved. For of those, the one moves alone, and the other is alone moved. Every being therefore, is either immoveable, or self-motive, or alter-motive.

C O R O L L A R Y.

From hence also it is evident, that of things which are moved, a self-motive nature is the first, but of things motive, an immoveable nature.

Concerning an INCORPOREAL ESSENCE, and its PROPERTIES.

PROPOSITION XV.

Every thing which is converted to itself, is incorporeal.

FOR no body is naturally adapted to be converted to itself. For if that which is converted to any thing, is conjoined to that to which it is converted, it is evident that all the parts of a body must be conjoined with all the parts of that which is converted to itself: since self-conversion then takes place, when that which is converted becomes one with that to which it is converted. But this is impossible in body, and in all partible natures. For the whole of that which is partible, is not conjoined with the whole, on account of the separation of the parts which are differently situated. No body therefore is naturally adapted to self-conversion, so that the whole may be converted to the whole. And hence whatever is self-convertive is incorporeal and impartible.

PROPOSITION XVI.

Every thing which is converted to itself, has an essence separate from all body.

FOR if it be inseparable from any body, it will not possess some action separable from body. For if essence is inseparable from body, it is impossible that an essential energy should be separable: since in this case energy would be more excellent than essence; because the latter would be indigent of bodies, but the former would be sufficient to itself, without requiring the assistance of body. If then any thing be inseparable according to essence, it must be so likewise according to energy, or indeed more inseparable. But if this be the case, it is not converted to itself. For that which is converted to itself, as it is different from body, has an energy separate from body, neither subsisting through body, nor in conjunction with its nature: since action, and that to which action is directed, is not indigent of body. Hence that which is converted to itself, is entirely separable from bodies.

PROPOSITION XVII.

Every thing which moves itself primarily, is endued with a self-convertive power.

FOR if it moves itself its motive energy also is resident in its nature, and the thing moving is at the same time one with the thing moved. For either it moves with a part, but is moved in a part, or the contrary. But if one part is motive, and another
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part is moved, it will not be essentially self-motive, because it will subsist from non-self-motive natures: and it will appear indeed self-motive, but will not be so essentially. But if the whole moves, and a part is moved, or the contrary, there will be some part in each, which, according to one, will be at the same time both moving and moved*: and this will be primarily self-motive. But if one and the same moves and is moved, it will possess with itself the energy of moving, because it is self-motive; but it will be converted to that in which it energises. Every thing therefore primarily self-motive is converted to itself.

PROPOSITION XVIII.

Every thing which supplies being to others, is that primarily which it bestows on the things supplied.

FOR if it gives being, it procures the communication from its own essence. But that which it gives is worse than its own essence: and that which it is, is more excellent and perfect. For every artificer of any thing, is more excellent than the nature of the thing fabricated: and hence that which pre-exists in the donor, is more sublime than the gift; for the one is primary, but the other secondary and subordinate. For it is necessary, either that both should be the same, and that there should be one reason of both; or that nothing should be common, or the same in both; or that this should be first, but that the second. But if there be, one and the same reason, or definition, the one will no longer be cause, and the other effect; nor this in itself, but that in the thing given; nor will this be the efficient, but that the effect. But if they have nothing the same, the remainder will not subsist, in consequence of the existence of the other, because it will communicate nothing to its being. It remains therefore, that this which bestows is first; but that which is bestowed is second; among which the being of the one is supplied from the other.

PROPOSITION XIX.

Every thing which is primarily inherent in any of the natures among beings, is present to all the beings distributed according to that nature, in one reason, and after the same manner.

FOR if it be not present to all after the same manner, but to these, and not to those; it is evident that it will not be primarily inherent in that nature. But it will be present with some primarily, and in others which participate sometimes but not always,

* Because, since the whole is motive, the part which is moved will also be motive, and so will be at the same time both moving and moved. And if a part moves, and the whole is moved; then because of the motion of the whole, the part will be both moving and moved.

secondarily. For that which sometimes subsists, and sometimes not, does not exist primarily, nor essentially, but is adventitious, and extrinsically accedes to the natures in which it resides.

Concerning the GRADATION OF BEINGS.

PROPOSITION XX.

The essence of soul is superior to all bodies; and an intellectual nature is superior to all souls: and the one itself is superior to all intellectual essences.

FOR every body is moved by another, but is naturally incapable of moving itself. But it is moved by itself, through the participation of soul: it likewise lives through soul, and by means of its presence, is after a manner self-motive; but when soul is absent it is alter-motive; because it is essentially endowed with this nature, but soul is allotted a self-motive essence. For it imparts self-mobility to whatever it supervenes. But soul is much prior to that which it essentially imparts. It is therefore above bodies, as a self-motive essence: since these become self-motive through participation. Again, soul which is moved from itself, has the second order from an immoveable nature, existing immoveable in energy; because a self-motive nature precedes all things that are moved, but an immoveable essence, all moving natures. If therefore soul which is self-motive, moves others, it is requisite that an immoveable mover, should be prior to soul. But intellect moves, existing immoveable, and always energising according to the same. For soul participates through intellect of eternal intelligence; in the same manner as body participates through soul of a self-motive nature. For if eternal intelligence, was primarily resident in soul, it would be inherent in all souls; in the same manner as a self-motive nature. And hence this is not primarily inherent in soul. It is therefore requisite, that a first-intellective nature should be prior to soul. Intellect therefore is prior to souls. But the one is prior to intellect. For intellect though immoveable, is not the one: since it understands, and energises about itself. But all beings of whatever kind, participate of the one, but all do not participate of intellect. For it is necessary that those natures should participate of knowledge, to whom a portion of intellect is present; because intellectual cognition, is the principle, and first cause of knowledge. Hence the one is superior to intellect; nor is there any thing superior to the one: for the one is the same with the good. But the good is the principle of all things, as we have demonstrated.

That

That INTELLECT is not the FIRST CAUSE.

PROPOSITION XXI.

Every order beginning from unity proceeds into some multitude co-ordinate to unity: and multitude of every order is reduced to one unity.

FOR unity possessing the relation of a principle, generates a multitude proper to itself. Hence one series, and one universal order descends from unity into multitude. For there would neither be any order, nor series, if unity was essentially barren. But multitude is again reduced into one common cause of all co-ordinates. For that which is the same in every multitude, does not proceed from one of the things which multitude contains: since that which emanates from one out of many, is not common to all, but is alone peculiar to the property of that one. Since therefore according to every order, there is both a certain communion, coherence, and identity, on account of which *these* are said to be co-ordinate, and *those* of another order, it is evident that the sameness of every order proceeds from one principle *. There is therefore in every order an unity prior to multitude, affording one reason, and series to the things ordered in itself, as well with respect to each other, as likewise to the whole. For admitting that among things contained under the same series, one thing is the cause of another, yet it is necessary that before all things, there should be a cause that the series is one, and that from it all things should be generated as co-ordinates; not that every thing may be a particular something, but may exist of this particular order.

* The truth of this may be exemplified in light. Thus for instance we see many species of light; one kind emanating from the sun, another from fire and the stars, another from the moon, and another from the eyes of many animals. But this light though various, is every where similar, and discovers in its operations a unity of nature. On account of its uniformity therefore it requires one principle, and not different principles. But the sun is the only principle of all mundane light. And though there are many participants of light posterior to the solar orb, yet they scatter their uniform light, through one solar nature, property and power. But if we again seek for the principle of light in the sun, we cannot say that the solar orb is the principle of light: for the various parts of this orb diffuse many illuminations. There will therefore be many principles. But we now require one first principle of light. And if we say that the soul of the sun generates light, we must observe that this is not effected by her animal multiplicity, or she would diffuse different lights: and hence we must assert that she generates visible by intellectual light. But this production again, does not subsist through intellectual variety, but rather by a unity of intellect: and this unity is a symbol of that simple unity which is the principle of the universe. And to this principle the solar intellect is united by its unity: and through this it becomes a god. This divine unity of the sun, therefore, is the principle of the uniform light of the world, in the same manner as simple unity and goodness is the author of intelligible light to all intelligible natures.

COROL-

COROLLARY.

From hence it is evident that both one and multitude, is inherent in the nature of body, and that one nature has many coherent natures, and that many natures depend on the one nature of the universe. And this property belongs to the order of souls, to begin from one first soul, and to descend into a multitude of souls, and to reduce multitude into one. And to an intellectual essence it is peculiar to possess an intellectual unity, and a multitude of intellects proceeding from one intellect, and intimately converted to its nature. And to the one prior to all things, a multitude of unities is present, and to unities themselves a return to the one. Hence after the first one, unities * subsist; intellects after the first intellect; souls after the first soul; and natures after universal nature.

PROPOSITION XXII.

Every thing which subsists primarily, and according to the nature of a principle, is in every order one; and is neither two, nor more than two, but is universally self-begotten.

FOR if possible let it be two; since the same absurdity will ensue should more than two be admitted. Then if it be two, it is either that which is composed from both unities; and in this case the first will be one and not two: or it is each of the unities. But in this case, either one of each, and not both, will be the first; or both will be equally the first. But if equally, neither of them will be the first: for if the one is first, but this one is not the same with the other, what order will it possess? For that subsists primarily, which is nothing else than what it is denominated. But each of these being different, the one from the other, each at the same time is, and is not that which it is said to be. But if these differ from each other, yet not with respect to that which is called first (for this primarily suffers identity), both will not be first, but that through the participation of which, both are said to be first.

COROLLARY.

From hence it is evident that the first being is one alone, and that there are not two, or more first beings. And that the first intellect is one alone, but that there are not two

* This will be evident by considering that *the one*, or the first principle of all, must produce that which first proceeds from himself, by *union* (*καὶ ἑνωσιν*). And as his first production must be the most similar of all things to himself, and must be at the same time multitude (or in what respect would it differ from the one); hence it is necessary, that this progression must be no other than self-perfect unities. In consequence therefore of this sublime doctrine, as Proclus beautifully observes (*Theol. Plat. p. 123.*) there is one god, and many gods; one unity, and many unities prior to beings; and one goodness, and many goodnesses after this first good. It likewise follows that the first principle of all is a super-essential one; and that after this one, there are many super-essential unities. And we may consider every unity of beings, as the flower of some certain being; and as the summit and centre about which every being subsists. For a farther account and confirmation of this sublime doctrine, study the third book of Proclus on Plato's Theology.

first intellects. And that the first soul is one; and in every particular species, the same conclusion will result: as for instance the first beautiful, first equal, and similarly in all the rest. In like manner there is the same demonstration, with respect to one first form of animal and man.

Concerning the imparticipable * (or that which is without participation), and that which participates.

PROPOSITION XXIII.

Every imparticipable produces from itself participants, and all participated hypostases, or subsistencies, are reduced to imparticipable essences.

FOR an imparticipable possessing the relation of unity, as depending on itself, and not on another, and as separated from participants, generates things able to participate. For either it remains in itself barren, and possesses nothing honourable; or it gives something from itself. And that which receives from this imparticipable participates, and that which is given subsists in a participated manner. But every thing participating of another by which it is generated, is posterior to that nature which is similarly present to all things, and which fills all things from itself. For that which subsists in one thing is not in others: and that which is similarly present to all things, that it may illustrate all, is not in one thing, but before all. For it either subsists in all, or in one of all, or before all. But that which subsists in all, because distributed into all, again requires another, which may unite its divided nature: and all things will no longer participate of the same, but this will participate one thing, and that another, if the one is distributed into many. But if it subsists in one of all, it will no longer be common to all, but to one. If therefore it is common to things capable of participating powers, and is likewise common to all, it will be prior to all things. But this is imparticipable.

* By *imparticipable*, in these Elements, we must understand that which participates nothing belonging to the characteristic of its nature, and which is likewise participated through proper mediums by all subordinate natures. Thus for instance *imparticipable being*, is that which participates nothing of *being*, but is the source of *being*, to others: and at the same time it is not participated without a medium by subordinate essences; since the participation of being, in subordinate natures, is accomplished through the immediate progeny of *being itself*. And so of the rest. Nor ought it to seem wonderful that an imparticipable should preside over every series of causes: for this is a necessary consequence, if we consider that every cause must be that to its following progeny, which the first cause of all, is to the universality of things. But the first cause of all is perfectly imparticipable; since he would not be purely *the one*, if he was mingled with *many*, and received the condition of a subordinate nature. As the divine unities therefore are participated by all the following orders of things, and are the mediums, by which every being is conjoined with the first cause of all; so the immediate progeny of every primary cause conjoins all the subsequent progressions with that cause, which from its similarity to *the first* is properly denominated an imparticipable.

PROPO.

PROPOSITION XXIV.

Every participant is inferior to that which it participates, and that which is participated is subordinate to an imparticipable.

FOR the participant being imperfect prior to participation, but becoming perfect through participation, is entirely posterior to that which it participates; so far as it is perfect through participation. For so far as it was imperfect, it is inferior to that which it participates and which is the cause of its perfection. But that which is participated because common to some one, and not to all, is on this account allotted a subsistence inferior to that which is common to all, and not to some particular one: for the latter is more allied, but the former, less, to the cause of all things. Hence an imparticipable, precedes things participated; and these last precede participants. And in short that which is imparticipable is one prior to many; that which is participated is one in many; and every participant is at the same time non-one, and one.

CONCERNING THE PERFECT.

PROPOSITION XXV.

Every thing perfect proceeds to the procreation of such offspring as it is able to produce, imitating the one principle of the universe.

FOR as the principle of the universe, on account of his goodness is uniformly constitutive of all beings (for the good is the same with the one, and on this account that which is endued with the form of good, is the same with that which is uniform); so things posterior to the principle, on account of their proper perfection hasten to generate other things subordinate to their own essence: and this perfection is a certain portion of the good; and the perfect so far as perfect imitates the good. But this is constitutive of all things. Hence the perfect also is naturally productive of things within its power; and that which is more perfect, by how much the more perfect it is, by so much the more is it the cause of more numerous productions: for that which is more perfect, participates more of the good. But this is nearer to the good, is more allied to the cause of the universe, and is the cause of more numerous productions. But the imperfect, by how much the more imperfect it is, by so much the more is it the cause of less numerous effects: for existing more remote from the producer of all things, it becomes the cause of fewer effects. For to constitute and adorn, or perfect, or contain,

or

or vivify, or fabricate all things, and to effect each of these in many, is allied to the principle of all. But if this is accomplished in a few it, becomes more foreign from the principle.

C O R O L L A R Y.

From hence it is evident that matter which is most distant from the principle of the universe, is barren, and the cause of nothing. For if it should generate any thing, it would have something posterior to itself, and it would not be the most remote. But that which it produces, would be more distant than itself, and because it produces and imitates the productive cause of all beings, it would be nearer to the principle of the universe.

CONCERNING THAT WHICH PRODUCES.

P R O P O S I T I O N XXVI.

Every cause productive of other things, abiding in itself produces
natures posterior and subsequent to itself.

FOR if it imitates the one itself, but that immoveably generates natures posterior to itself, hence every productive nature will in a similar manner possess the cause of producing. But that the one itself immoveable generates, is evident from hence. For if he generates through motion, either motion will be resident or non-resident in his nature, and that which is moved will be no longer one; because it will be changed and moved from one. Hence the one will either produce in infinitum*, or immoveably. And every producing nature will imitate the one productive cause of the universe. For from that which is first, that which is not first every where emanates. And hence from that which is productive of all things, that which is productive of some things will proceed. Every producing cause, therefore, produces subsequent natures, abiding in itself: and while productive natures abide in themselves undiminished, secondary natures are produced from them. For that which is in any respect diminished, cannot abide such as it is.

* Because if the one generates through motion, an infinite motion must take place, through the want of an immoveable nature.

PROPOSITION XXVII.

Every producing nature, on account of its perfection, and abundance of power is productive of secondary natures.

FOR if it produces, not on account of its perfection, but through a defect of power, it cannot preserve its own proper order immovable. For that which affords being to another, through its defect and imbecillity, confers on it essence by a mutation and alteration of itself: but every producing nature abides such as it is, and while it abides, that which is posterior to itself proceeds into being. Hence existing full and perfect, it procreates secondary natures immovably, and without diminution: at the same time existing such as it is, neither changing itself into its progeny, nor diminishing its nature. For the thing produced is not a dissection of the parts of the producing cause: since this is neither proper to generated natures, nor to generating causes. Nor is it a transition; since it is not the matter of that which proceeds to generation. For the producing cause abides such as it is, and the production is different from itself. That which generates therefore abides without alteration, and without diminution, multiplying itself through its prolific power, and supplying from itself secondary subsistencies.

PROPOSITION XXVIII.

Every producing nature generates things similar to itself, prior to such as are dissimilar.

FOR since the producing cause is necessarily more excellent than the thing produced, these can never be mutually the same simply considered, or equal according to power. But if they are not the same and equal, but different and unequal; they are either entirely separated from each other, or they are both united and separate. But if they are entirely separate, they cannot be conciliated with each other, and the thing produced will not sympathize with its cause. Hence the one will not participate of the other, because they are entirely different. For that which is participated, imparts a communication to its participant, with respect to that of which it participates. But it is necessary that the thing caused should participate of the cause, as that from which its essence is derived. But if that which is produced is in one respect separated, and in another united to its producing cause; if it equally suffers both, it equally participates and does not participate of its producing cause. It will therefore both possess and not possess

possess an essence from it, after the same manner. But if it should be more separated, the thing generated will be more foreign from its generating cause than is proper, and will be to itself more inelegant than elegant, and more deprived than endued with sympathy of nature. If then generated natures, are both allied according to essence, and in sympathy with their causes, naturally depending upon, and desiring a contact with them, pursuing good and obtaining the object of desire through cause, it is evident that things produced are more united with their producing causes than separated from them. And things which are more united are more similar than dissimilar to the natures with which they are especially united. Every productive cause therefore generates things similar prior to such as are dissimilar.

PROPOSITION XXIX.

Every progression is accomplished by a similitude of things secondary to such as are first.

FOR if a producing cause generates similars prior to dissimilars, similitude generates things produced from their producing causes. For similars become similar through similitude, and not through dissimilitude. If, therefore, progression in its diminution preserves the identity of the thing generated to its generator, and exhibits that which is posterior to itself secondarily, such as itself is primarily, it will possess its essence through similitude.

PROPOSITION XXX.

Every thing immediately produced from another, both abides in its producing cause, and proceeds from it.

FOR if every progression is effected while things first abide, and is perfected through similitude, things similar subsisting prior to the dissimilar, the thing produced will abide in a certain respect in its producing cause: since that which has entirely proceeded from its cause, possesses nothing the same with that which abides, but is perfectly separated. But if it possesses any thing in common, and united with its abiding cause, it will also abide in its cause, in the same manner as that abides in itself. But if it abides only without proceeding, it differs nothing from its cause, nor will it while that abides, be effected something different: for if it is something else, it will be distinct and separate. But if separate, and its cause abides, it proceeds from its cause that it may be separated from its abiding generator. So far, therefore, as the thing produced possesses any thing

the same with its producing cause, it abides in this cause: but so far as it possesses something different, it proceeds from its cause. But on account of its similitude, it is at the same time in a certain respect both the same with, and different from its producing cause. It abides therefore, and at the same time proceeds with its cause, and neither is separate from the other.

PROPOSITION XXXI.

Every thing proceeding from another essentially, is converted to that from which it proceeds.

FOR if it should indeed proceed, without being converted to the cause of its progression, it will not desire this cause: since every desiderative nature (*τὰ ἐπιθυμητικόν*) is converted to the object of its desire. But every being desires good; and its acquisition takes place through a cause proximate to particulars. Hence particulars desire their cause. For well-being is distributed to any particular being, through the same cause as being itself. But desire is primarily directed to that cause from which well-being proceeds: and conversion is directed to that, to which desire primarily tends.

PROPOSITION XXXII.

Every conversion is effected by a similitude of the converted natures to the object of their conversion.

FOR every thing converting itself to another, hastens to conjoin itself with the object of its conversion, and desires its communion and conjunction. But similitude collects all things, in the same manner as dissimilitude separates and divides. Conversion therefore is a certain communion and contact. But every communion and every contact is caused by similitude. And hence every conversion is effected by similitude.

PROPOSITION XXXIII.

* Every thing proceeding from, and returning to another, has a circular energy.

FOR if it is converted to that from which it proceeds, it conjoins the beginning with the end. And there is one and a continued motion: this commencing from, and

* In order to understand this proposition the reader must observe that the hypothesis requires that both the progression and regression subsist together. And this hypothesis is no less proper than true; for unless effects were continually converted to their causes, they could not exist; since they depend on these for their subsistence, and this can only be procured by conversion.

that proceeding to the abiding nature. Hence all things proceed circularly, from causes to causes. But these circles of regression are greater and less: since some conversions proceed to things proximately placed above them, but others to things more superior, and so on to the principle of all. For all things proceed from this, and to this finally return.

PROPOSITION XXXIV.

Every thing which is naturally converted, converts itself to that from which it derives the progression of its peculiar subsistence.

FOR if it is naturally converted, it possesses an essential desire towards that to which it is converted, and it directs all its being towards that to which it makes an essential conversion. And it is also essentially similar to the object of its conversion; and on this account is in sympathy with it according to nature, because allied to it by essence. But if this be the case; either the essence of both is the same; or the one proceeds from the other; or both derive their similitude from some other one. But if the essence of both is the same, how can the one be naturally converted to the other? And if both proceed from one; both will be naturally converted to this one. It remains therefore that the one must derive its essence from the other. But if this be the case, progression also must originate from that to which there is a conversion according to nature.

COROLLARY.

From hence it is evident that intellect is the object of desire to all things: that all things proceed from intellect; and that the whole world, though eternal, derives its essence from intellect. For it is not because eternal excluded from proceeding from intellect. Nor is it because established in perpetual order, excluded from conversion. But it both perpetually advances and is eternal according to essence; and it is perpetually converted and indissoluble according to its invariable order.

PROPOSITION XXXV.

Every thing caused (or produced by a cause), both abides in its cause, proceeds from, and is converted to it.

FOR if it alone abides, it will differ in nothing from its cause; from which it will be indistinct. For progression subsists together with distinction. But if it alone proceeds, it will be unconjoined with its cause, and in no respect communi-

cate with it according to a sympathetic affection. But if it is alone converted, how can that which does not derive its essence from its cause, be naturally converted to that which is foreign from its nature? But if it abides and proceeds, and is not converted, how can the natural desire of every thing to well-being, and to good, and an excitation to its generator, arise? But if it proceeds indeed, and is converted, but does not abide, how, since it is distant from its cause, can it hasten to be conjoined with it? Since it would be unconjoined prior to its departure. For if it was conjoined, according to this conjunction it would entirely abide. But if it should abide and be converted, but should not proceed, how, since not separated, can it be converted? For every thing returning to its cause, in the act of returning is assimilated to that from which it is essentially divided. But it is necessary that the thing caused, should either alone abide, or be alone converted, or alone proceed; or that the extremes should be conjoined with each other; or that the medium between these, should be united with each extreme; or that all these should take place together. It remains, therefore, that every thing caused must abide in, proceed from, and be converted to its cause.

PROPOSITION XXXVI.

Of all things which are multiplied in progression, such as are first are more perfect than such as are second, and such as are second than those of a posterior order, and so on in continual succession.

FOR if progressions distinguish things produced from their causes, and are the subordinations of secondary natures to such as are first; first progressions will be more conjoined with their causes, from which they are produced, and of which they may be considered as the blossoms. But secondary progressions are more remote from their causes; and this will be the case in a continual succession. But things nearer, and more allied to their causes, are more perfect: for causes are more perfect than things caused. But such as are more remote are more imperfect, because on this account dissimilar to their causes.

PROPOSITION XXXVII.

Of all things which subsist according to conversion, the first are more imperfect than the second; and the second than those in succession. But the last are the most perfect.

FOR if conversions are produced in a circle, and conversion tends to that from which the progression began; but progression is from the most perfect, conversion also will tend to the most perfect. And if that to which progression tends is the last, the first conversion

conversion will originate from this. But progression to the last is the most imperfect; and conversion commences from the most imperfect. In things, therefore, subsisting according to conversion, the first are the most imperfect, but the last the most perfect.

PROPOSITION XXXVIII.

Every thing proceeding from a certain number of causes, is converted to them by the same number as it proceeds from them; and every conversion subsists through the same cause as progression.

FOR since both are produced through similitude, that which immediately proceeds from any cause, is immediately converted to it: for the similitude was immediate. But that which requires a medium in its progression, requires also a medium in its conversion. For it is requisite that both progression and conversion should subsist about the same. It will, therefore, be first converted to the medium, and afterwards to that which is more excellent than the medium. Hence well-being is distributed to every thing through the same number of causes as being; and the contrary of this is likewise true.

PROPOSITION XXXIX.

Every being is either alone essentially converted, or vitally, or according to a gnostic mode (*γνωστικῶς*).

FOR it either possesses being alone from its cause, or life together with being, or it receives from thence a gnostic power. So far, therefore, as it is *being* alone, it makes an essential conversion. But so far as it likewise *lives*, a vital conversion. And so far as it *knows*, a gnostic conversion. For according to its progression, such is its conversion; and the measures of its conversion are defined by the measures of its progression. Hence some are endued with desire according to being alone; this desire being adapted to the participation of causes. But others according to life; and this vital desire is a motion to more excellent natures. And others according to cognition, which desire is a perception of the goodness of causes.

PROPOSITION XL.

Self-subsistent natures antecede all things proceeding from another cause.

FOR if every thing sufficient, is more excellent, either according to essence, or according to energy, than that which depends on another cause, but that which produces itself, because productive of its own being, is sufficient to itself. But that which

is alone produced from another is not sufficient. Likewise since that which is sufficient is more allied to good; and things more allied and similar to causes, subsist from cause prior to dissimilars: hence things self-productive, and self-subsistent, are more ancient, than such as proceed to being from another alone. For either nothing is self-subsistent; or the good itself is such; or things which are the first subsistents from the good. But if nothing is self-subsistent, there will not be a true sufficiency in any thing. For this cannot reside in the good, since that is more excellent than sufficiency, subsisting as the one; and being *the good*, but not possessing good. But neither on this hypothesis can sufficiency reside in natures posterior to the good. For all things will be indigent of that which is prior to their nature. But if the good is self-subsistent, because it produces itself, it will not be one. For that which proceeds from one, is not one: and it will proceed from itself, if it subsists by itself. And hence the one itself will be at the same time one, and not one. It is necessary, therefore, that a self-subsistent nature should be posterior to the first: and it is evident, that it must likewise be prior to things alone proceeding from another cause. For it is more principal than these, and, as we have demonstrated, is more allied to the good.

PROPOSITION XLI.

Every thing residing in another is alone produced by another. But every thing residing in itself, is self-subsistent.

FOR that which abides in another, and is indigent of a subject, can never be generative of itself. For that which naturally generates itself, does not require a foreign seat, since it is contained by itself, and is preserved in itself separate from a superior. But that which is capable of abiding, and of being established in itself, is productive of itself: since it proceeds into itself, and contains its own nature; and abides in itself; as a thing caused in its cause. For it does not abide as in place, nor as in a subject. For place is different from that which subsists in place, and that which resides in a subject is different from its subject. But this is the same with itself. For it is self-subsistent, and abides in itself, as the thing caused in its cause.

PROPOSITION XLII.

Every thing self-subsistent is converted to itself.

FOR if it proceeds from itself, it will also return to itself. For that which is the source of progression to particulars, is likewise the end of a conversion co-ordinate to the progression. For if it should alone proceed from itself, but should

not

not be converted by a progression into itself, it will never desire its own proper good, and that which it is able to afford itself. But every cause is capable of conferring on its progeny, together with the essence it affords, well-being, which is conjoined to the essence which it distributes. Hence it can confer this on itself. And, therefore, this is the proper good of a self-subsistent nature. But this, according to the hypothesis, will not be desired by that which is converted to itself: and because it does not desire this, neither will it pursue it; and in consequence of not pursuing, it will be imperfect and insufficient. But if sufficiency and perfection belong to any thing, they must be proper to a self-subsistent nature. And hence it will pursue and desire its own proper good, and will be converted to itself.

PROPOSITION XLIII.

Every thing converted to itself, is self-subsistent.

FOR if it be naturally converted to itself, and is perfect in its self-conversion, it will also possess essence from itself. For that to which conversion according to nature tends; from this also the essential progression of every thing proceeds. If, therefore, it affords to itself *well-being*, it will also indeed afford to itself *being*; and it will be the lord of its own subsistence. Hence that which is capable of being converted to itself, is self-subsistent.

PROPOSITION XLIV.

Every thing converted to itself according to energy, is also converted to itself according to essence.

FOR if it can be converted to itself according to energy, but is not converted essentially, it will be more excellent according to energy than according to essence; since the former is convertible, and not the latter. For that which depends on itself, is more excellent than that which depends on another. And that which preserves itself, is more perfect than that which is only preserved by another. If, therefore, it is converted to itself, according to that energy which proceeds from essence, it will likewise be allotted a convertive essence; so that it will not only energize to itself, but will likewise depend on itself, and will be contained and perfected by itself.

PROPOSITION XLV.

Every thing self-subsistent is without generation.

FOR if it be generated, because generated it will be essentially imperfect, and indigent of that perfection which proceeds from another. But because it produces itself, it is perfect and sufficient. For every thing generated is perfected by another, which brings it into existence from a non-existent state. Since generation is the passage from that which is imperfect to its contrary, the perfect. But if any thing produces itself, it is always perfect; because it always coheres to its own cause, or rather inheres in that which is perfective of its essence.

PROPOSITION XLVI.

Every thing self-subsistent, is incorruptible.

FOR if it may be corrupted, it may desert itself, and exist separate from itself. But this is impossible. For, on account of the unity of its nature, it is at the same time both a cause and the thing caused. But every thing which is corrupted, is corrupted by a departure from its cause. For so far as any thing depends on that which contains and preserves it, so far it is contained and preserved. But that which is self-subsistent will never desert its cause, because it will not desert itself. For it is its own cause. And hence every thing self-subsistent is incorruptible.

PROPOSITION XLVII.

Every thing self-subsistent is impartible (i. e. without parts) and simple.

FOR if that which is self-subsistent is partible, it will constitute itself partible, and the whole will be converted to itself*, and all will be in all itself. But this is impossible. Hence that which is self-subsistent is impartible. But it is likewise simple. For if composite, it will contain both that which is excellent, and that which is base†; and the more excellent will proceed from the more base, and the more base from the

* This is absurd, because every partible nature must be converted to something different from itself, on account of its parts. So likewise since a self-subsistent nature resides in itself, if such a nature was partible, one divisible whole would be in another, not different from itself.

† Because every composite consists of matter and form; the former of which is base, and the latter more excellent.

more excellent, since, according to hypothesis, the whole proceeds from the whole itself. Besides it will not be sufficient to itself, because it requires the elements of itself, from which it is composed. Every thing therefore which is self-subsistent is simple.

Concerning that which is Eternal, for the Purpose of demonstrating the Eternity of the World.

PROPOSITION XLVIII.

Every thing not eternal, is either a composite, or subsists in another.

FOR it is either capable of being dissolved into its component parts, and is entirely composed from the parts into which it is dissolved; or being indigent of a subject, and deserting its subject, it passes into non-entity. But if it is simple, and abides in itself, it will be indissoluble and incapable of dissipation.

PROPOSITION LXIX.

Every thing self-subsistent is eternal.

FOR there are two modes according to which it is necessary, that any thing should be non-eternal. The one flows from composition, and the other from residing in a subject. But that which is self-subsistent, is neither compound, but simple; nor does it abide in another, but in itself. And hence it is eternal.

PROPOSITION L.

Every thing which is measured by time is *generation*, either according to essence, or according to energy, so far as it is measured according to time.

FOR if it is measured by time, essence or energy, according to time, is proper to its nature. And it is likewise proper that the terms, *it was*, and *it will be*, should be different from each other. For if *it was*, and *it will be*, were numerically the same, that which is measured by time would suffer nothing from time proceeding, and always having something prior and posterior. If then *it was*, and *it will be* differ from each

other, that which is measured by time is *in generation* (*γενεσις* *ἐκ*) and never truly is *, but proceeds together with time, by which it is measured, existing in a state of tendency

* The truth of this reasoning may be evinced by the following considerations: Every thing which is measured by time, and such is every corporeal nature, depends on time for the perfection of its being. But time is composed of the past, present, and future. And if we conceive that any one of these periods is taken away from the nature with which it is connected, that nature must immediately perish. Time, therefore, is so essentially and intimately united with the natures which it measures, that their being, such as it is, depends on the existence of time. But time, as is evident, is perpetually flowing, and this in the most rapid manner imagination can conceive. It is evident, therefore, that the natures to which it is so essential, must subsist in a manner equally transitory and flowing. As we cannot therefore affirm with propriety of any part of time, that it is; since even before we can form the assertion, the present time is no more; so with respect to all corporeal natures (from their subsistence in time) before we can say that they exist, they lose all identity of being. But as it appears to me this flowing, and evanescent nature of things existing in time, may be aptly illustrated by the following similitude. Conceive a line, all whose parts are in a continual flux, like the waters of the most rapid river: and let it be distinguished by three different colours, so profoundly mingled with each other, that every part of the line may possess these colours, in the same manner as the whole line. Now a line of this kind, will very properly represent time, distinguished by past, present, and future, to which the three colours correspond. If then we conceive another line moving on this coloured line, with an equable uniform motion, corresponding to the motion of the parts of the coloured line, and so that in every instant of its motion it may be tinged with one of these colours in regular succession; we shall see the condition of a nature whose being is measured by the progressions of time. For as the perpendicular line, in its uniform motion, no sooner assumes one colour, than it deserts it for another, and cannot on this account be said to possess any colour; so every corporeal nature, from its being profoundly mingled with the fleeting and unreal essence of time, cannot be said to possess any true and substantial being.

Such then is the unreal condition of every thing subsisting in time, or of every thing corporeal, and entangled with matter. But this shadowy essence of body is finely demonstrated by Plotinus in the sixth book of his third Ennead, as follows: "Being (says he) properly so called is neither body, nor is subject to corporeal affections: but body, and its properties, belong to the region of non-entity. But you will ask, how is it possible, that visible matter, should possess no real being: that matter, in which stones and mountains reside, the solid earth, and bodies which mutually resist; since bodies which impel each other, confess by their collision, the reality of their existence? You will likewise ask after what manner things which neither strike against, nor resist each other: which neither externally act, nor internally suffer, nor are in any respect the objects of sight, viz. soul and intellect, are to be reckoned true and real beings? We reply, that, on the contrary, things more corpulent are more sluggish and inert, as is evident in bulky masses of earth: but whatever is less ponderous is more movable and alert; and the more elevated the more movable. Hence fire, the most movable of all the elements, flies in a manner from a corporeal nature. Besides, as it appears to me, whatever is more sufficient to itself, disturbs others less, and brings less inconvenience: but such things as are more ponderous and terrene, unable, from their defect of being, to raise themselves aloft, and becoming debile and languid, strike and oppress surrounding bodies, by their falling ruin and sluggish weight. Since it is evident, that bodies destitute of life, fall with mollescence on any proximate substance, and more vehemently impel and pain whatever is endued with sense. On the contrary, animated beings, as participating more of entity, by how much the more of being they possess, by so much the more harmless they impinge on their neighbouring bodies. Hence motion, which is a kind of life, or soul, is more present with whatever is less corpulent; as if more of body was necessarily produced where a defect of being happens in a greater degree. Again, it will more manifestly appear from passivity, that whatever is more corpulent is more passive; earth in a greater degree than the other elements; and the rest in a similar proportion. For some things, when divided, suddenly return to their former union, when no obstacle prevents their conjunction; but from the section of a terrene body, the divided portions, always remain separate; as if destitute of natural vigour, and without any inherent desire of union and consent.

dency to being, or in becoming to be (*is τὸ γίνεσθαι εἶναι*). Nor does it stop in the same state of being, but always receives different being; so that its *now* becomes perpetually different on account of the progression of time, and prevents its existing totally at the same period of time. For it subsists in a dispersion of temporal extension, and is co-extended with time. But this is no other than to possess being, in non-being. For that which is in generation, or a state of becoming to be, is not generated. *Generation*, therefore, is that which subsists in a flowing existence.

PROPOSITION LI.

Every thing self-subsistent is exempt from things measured by time according to essence.

FOR if that which is self-subsistent is without generation, it cannot be measured by time according to essence. For generation subsists about a nature measured by time. Hence nothing self-subsistent subsists in time.

PROPOSITION LII.

Every thing eternal, is at once total.

FOR whether it only possesses an eternal essence, it will possess the whole at once present. Nor will it have one of its parts already constituted, but another which remains to be constituted; because not yet in existence; but as much as is possible it possesses the whole without diminution, and without extension. Or whether it possesses an energy with respect to essence, and this collected into one, and abiding in the same measure of perfection, and established as it were according to one and the same

consent. Hence they are ready, by every trifling impulse, to remain as they are impelled; to rush from the embraces of *bound*, and hasten into multitude, and non-entity. So that whatever becomes corporeal in an eminent degree, as falling fast into non-entity, has but little power of recalling itself into one. And on this account ponderous and vehement concussions are attended with ruin, when by mutual rushing one thing impels another. But when debility runs against debility, the one is valid against the other, in the same manner as non-entity rushing on non-entity. And this we think a sufficient confutation of their opinion, who only place being in the genus of body, persuaded by the testimony of impulses and concussions, and the phantasms perceived through the senses, which testify that sense is alone the standard of truth. Such as these are affected in a manner similar to those in a dream, who imagine that the perceptions of sleep are true. For sense is alone the employment of the dormant soul: since as much of the soul as is merged in body, so much of it sleeps. But true elevation, and true vigilance, is a resurrection from and not with the dull mass of body. For indeed a resurrection with body, is only a transmigration from sleep to sleep, and from dream to dream, like a man passing in the dark from bed to bed. But that elevation is perfectly true, which entirely rises from the dead weight of bodies: for these possessing a nature repugnant to soul, possess something opposite to essence. And this is farther evident, from their generation, their continual flowing and decay; properties entirely foreign from the nature of being, substantial and real."

bound,

bound, immovably, and without progression, it will still possess the whole at once present. For if it be eternal, as its name denotes, it is a perpetual being (*τὸ αἰὼν.*) But to be sometimes, and to have an existence in *becoming to be*, is different from that which always is. And hence it is requisite that an eternal nature should not possess any thing prior and posterior: for in this case it would become generation and non-entity. But where neither prior, nor posterior, not *it exists*, and *it will be* have any subsistence, but being alone, there an essence at once total abides *. And every thing energizes according to its essence.

COROL.

* The account of eternity given by Plotinus, in which its *total* nature is copiously demonstrated, is so inimitably sublime and profound, that I cannot refrain from presenting the reader with the following paraphrased translation, of the most considerable part of the seventh book of his third Ennead, relative to the nature of eternity. Proclus (in Theol. Plat. p. 149.) observes that the definition of eternity given by Plotinus in this discourse, viz. "Infinite life, which at once openly exhibits itself, and manifestly declares its own being," is a definition framed in a most divinely inspired manner (*ἡ θεϊκώτατα*.)

"Since we reckon eternity and time to be different from each other, and that the one respects a nature which always is, and that the other is conversant with things in generation, unstable and flowing, from which this sensible universe is composed; we are apt to believe that from our natural ingenuity, and a sudden view of intelligence, an instinctive knowledge concerning time and eternity, is profoundly inherent in our souls; since we always affirm the same properties of these, and never vary in the appellations we assign them. But when we endeavour to approach nearer to these, and to explain their natures in a more perfect manner, we are immediately perplexed with doubts; and receiving the different sentiments of the ancients on this subject, according to the difference of our opinions, and perhaps conceiving the same sentiment, in a manner different from other men, we advance no farther in our enquiries; esteeming it sufficient, if when interrogated, we are able to relate the opinions of antiquity on this important subject. Indeed it is proper to believe that some of the ancient, and blessed philosophers, have discovered the truth: but it is highly necessary to enquire what method they pursued in their investigation, and how we may arrive at the knowledge of the same exalted truths. And first, it will be proper to enquire what they think of eternity, who judge it to be different from time: since from the knowledge of that which is, as the exemplar, we may perhaps more plainly understand, the nature of its image, which is denominated time. But if any one previous to his contemplation of eternity, should conceive the nature of time in his imagination, he may perhaps happen, by advancing into the intelligible world, and by a certain reminiscence, to comprehend that to which time is assimilated: since time possesses a similitude to eternity.

What then shall we say eternity is? Is it intelligible essence itself, in the same manner, as some are reported to affirm, that time is the whole heavens, and the world? For since we imagine and understand eternity to be something especially venerable, which we likewise affirm of an intelligible nature, we are not able to discern which of these is most venerable. And as that which is superior to these, ought not to be described by appellations of this kind, perhaps eternity, and an intelligible nature, may with propriety be received as the same. Again, both eternity, and the intelligible world, comprehend in themselves beings entirely the same. But when we say that the one abides in the other, placing intelligibles in eternity, and when we pronounce every thing intelligible eternal, as in the *Timæus* of Plato, where it is written, "If the nature of the exemplar is eternal, &c." in these cases, I say, we affirm eternity to be something different from an intelligible nature; at the same time confessing that eternity dwells about, or is resident in, or is present with an intelligible nature. For indeed it is not necessary that because both are venerable, they should be perfectly the same: since perhaps the venerableness of the one, is derived from the other. And what is farther added to establish their identity, that the same things are contained by each, is to be thus explained: that an intelligible nature contains every thing belonging to itself, as parts; but that eternity comprehends at the same time the whole, not as a part, but because all things of this kind are called eternal, from its continual presence. But ought we to judge of eternity according to permanent station in the intelligible world, as in this sensible world we are accustomed to consider time according to motion?

COROLLARY.

From hence it is evident that eternity is the cause of total existence. Since every thing eternal, has either its essence or its energy totally present with itself, either according to essence, or according to energy.

PROPO-

motion? But it may be properly enquired, in the first place, whether eternity, is the same with station belonging to being. For if it is the same with station, we cannot with more propriety, speak of a station which is eternal, than we can of an eternal eternity: since that eternal which participates of eternity. Besides, if station is the same with eternity, how can motion be eternal? For in this case, it must lose its nature, and become permanent and stable. Besides, how is the notion of station contained in the *ever itself*? I do not mean the *ever*, or *always* which respects time, but that which we understand when we speak of eternity. But if the *ever itself*, is contained in the station of being, we must consequently segregate the other genera of beings from eternity. Besides, it is requisite to conceive of eternity, not in station alone, but as abiding in *one*; and to preserve its indistant property, lest it should become entirely the same with time. But station, considered simply as station, neither contains in itself the intelligence of one, nor of that which is indistant. Hence we predicate of eternity, that it abides in *ones* and consequently it participates of station, without being station itself.

What then is the nature of that, by which we call the whole of the divine world eternal and perpetual? And what is perpetuity itself? Is it the same with eternity, or does eternity subsist according to the perpetual? Perhaps we ought to conceive of eternity, as a certain one collected from many; viz. either as one intelligence, or one nature; whether consequent to things in the intelligible world, or existing together with it, or beheld as situated in the depths of its essence. All these, I say, reduced into eternity as one, which is also many, and is endowed with a various capacity. Indeed he who beholds a various capacity, when he considers it as a subject, denominate it essence; but so far as he perceives life, he denominates it motion, and afterwards station, considered as abiding in a manner entirely the same. He will likewise behold difference and sameness, so far as they are many, bound in one. So that he who contracts the difference, subsisting in things which are many, into one life alone, and contemplates an unceasing sameness of energy, never passing its intelligence, or life, from one thing into another, but ever abiding in the same manner in itself, far remote from all distance; he, I say, who beholds all these, contemplates eternity, viewing life ever possessing a present whole, where all things abide together in sameness, without the order of first and last, and are comprehended in an indivisible bound. Where all things are collected into one, as into a point, not yet proceeding into a linear flux, but abiding in sameness, that is, in itself, in an ever present *one*: because nothing of its nature is past, nothing in it is future; but what it is, it always is. Hence eternity is not a subject, but that which beams as it were from its subject, according to the possession of an ever present identity; promising itself, that its ever abiding nature, will never be changed. For what should happen to this in future, which it is not at present? Since it is a perfect and present plenitude of all things. Nor can the term *was*, the appellation of time past, belong to eternity. For what can that be, which *was* present with its nature, and *is past*? It is in like manner independant of all connection with futurity. And hence eternity is that which neither *was*, nor *will be*, but alone *is*, which it possesses in a stable manner; because it is neither changed into a future, nor altered from a past duration. So that the eternity, which we are now investigating, is life total and full, abiding in its essence about being; and is every where indistant and one.

Nor indeed is it to be thought, that eternity happens extrinsically to the first essence; but we should consider it, as dwelling in this essence, as emanating from, and abiding together with it. For it is beheld as profoundly resident in its essence; because from perceiving every thing else which we affirm to abide there, as perfectly intimate, we say that all things emanate from essence, and abide together with essence. For it is requisite that first natures should abide with, and reside in first beings, and in these have the whole of their essence, because the beautiful dwells in these, and emanates from them: and this also may be asserted of truth. And partly indeed the whole itself, is as it were in a part, but partly, as parts in the whole: as if this true nature was a whole, not congregated from parts, but itself generating parts, that on this account it may be truly all. Besides, truth which flourishes there, is not a certain consonance towards another, but is peculiar to every thing of which it is the truth. Indeed it is requisite that this total truth, if total, should not only be total, so far as it is all things, but should

PROPOSITION LIII.

Eternity itself has an existence prior to all eternal natures, and *time itself* exists before all temporal natures.

FOR if every where participated natures are prior to their participants, and imparticipables before such as are participated, it is evident that an eternal being is different from the eternity in an eternal nature, and different from eternity itself. For the first of

should likewise so possess the whole, that nothing may be wanting to itself. And if this is the case, no affection of futurity can possibly belong to this being: for if the circulation of time can add any thing to its essence, it must be defective till such an accession takes place. Besides, nothing contrary to nature can happen to this true being; for it suffers nothing. So that since nothing is generated in it, its being is independent of all temporal connections; and hence it is neither *about to be*, nor *will be*, nor *was made*, nor *is made*. If indeed the affections of futurity are taken away from generated natures, because they are conversant with perpetual acquisition, they cease to exist. But to things of a nature essentially different, the addition of any future circumstance of being causes them to fall from the stable seat of essence. So that it is manifest from hence, that being itself could not reside in these natures, if they were composed from the past, and future processions of time. Since essence in generated natures appears to be nothing more than a certain procession from *real being*, from the beginning of generation, till it arrives at the extremity of time, when it ceases any longer to exist. And that which is called the being of these, subsists in such a manner that by diminishing any part of this extension, life is likewise diminished: for in this manner it is necessary that every thing which participates of futurity should exist. Hence it continually hastens, by a natural desire, to what is future, without desiring to repose; since it continually draws fresh supplies of being to itself, while it performs one thing after another, and is moved in a certain orb of progression, by its desire of essence. And thus we have discovered the existence of temporal beings, and the cause of their motion to eternal duration, through the assistance of futurity. But to such things as are first, and to beings truly blessed, the desire of futurity is unknown: for they are already total; and whatever of life they ought to possess, they now totally possess: so that they seek after nothing, because nothing which is requisite to the full energy and perfection of their essence is future, and consequently nothing happens to them connected with futurity. The absolute and total essence, therefore, of a being which is not separated into parts, but is total in all its parts, and in no one circumstance of being deficient; and to which nothing of non-entity can possibly happen (for it is not only requisite that all beings should be present with that which is universal, and total, but that every thing appertaining to non-entity, should be always excluded) is eternity: for that is called eternal which always is.

And shortly after this, he adds: "Hence eternity is something especially venerable, and is the same with a god, as inherent intelligence affirms. But intelligence likewise dictates that eternity is the same with that god, whom we denominate being and life. And it may with the greatest propriety be said, that eternity is a deity shining and unfolding himself in intelligible light, such as he is in his essence: in an essence, I say, perfectly unchangeable, and the same, and thus firmly abiding in an unceasing energy of life. Nor ought any one to wonder that we speak of eternity, as composed from many. For every thing which abides in the intelligible world, is called many, on account of its infinite power; since infinite there receives its denomination, because it never falls off from the consummate intellectual plenitude of its nature. And indeed it is particularly called after this manner, because it loses nothing of its own: and if any one should describe eternity after this manner, as life already infinite because universal, and because it never defects the integrity of its nature; (since it cannot be diminished by the past, nor increased, by the future, because it is a perfect whole) he who thus describes eternity, will approach very near to its true definition. For what is afterwards added, that it is a perfect whole, and loses nothing of its integrity, is only a certain exposition of the definition which affirms it to be infinite life. But because a nature of this kind, thus all-beautiful and eternal, abides about the *essence itself*, emanating and in no respect departing from it, but ever abiding about and in it, and living with it, in indissoluble union; hence it is said by

of these subsists as a *participant*, the second as a thing *participated*, and the third as an *imparticipable*. In like manner with respect to time, one thing exists as a *participant*, and the time which it contains, as a thing *participated*, and the time prior to this, as an *imparticipable* *. And each of these consists from imparticipables every where, and in all things the same. But participated time alone exists in the natures by which it is participated. For there are many eternal and temporal natures, in all of which eternity abides according to participation. And since such a time is indivisible, there is also a divided time. And there is one time prior to these. And *eternity itself* is an *eternity of eternities*, but *time itself*, is a *time of times*; and they are sustainers of participated natures.

PROPO-

by Plato, not rashly, but in a manner truly beautiful, and profound, *that eternity abides in one*: so that he not only reduces that which eternity contains into one; but the life of being in like manner reduces itself, about *the one itself*. This then is what we investigate, and that is eternity, which thus abides. For that which is the energy of life abiding from itself, and residing in the depths of unity, without any deception, either in essence or life, is without all controversy eternity. Since truly *to be*, is never *not to be*, and to possess no diversity of being. But when in discoursing on eternity, we use the term *ever*: also when we say, it is not sometimes *being*, and sometimes *non-being*, we must consider these appellations as adopted only for the purpose of explanation: because the term *ever* is not perhaps principally assumed, but is employed, in order to shew, an incorruptible, and never-failing nature.

But here it is proper to enquire, whether we affirm all this concerning eternity, by means of a power foreign from its nature, and as of a foreign concern? But how is this possible? For how can intelligence take place in the soul, unless by an intimate union of intellect, with the object of its intellection? And after what manner can this profound union subsist, by an intelligence of such things as are foreign from our intellectual nature? It is therefore requisite, that we should be partakers of eternity; or we could not thus define its nature, and exhibit the properties which it contains."

* The nature of *time itself*, which every thing in generation participates, has been a subject of much subtle and profound speculation to the Pythagoric, Platonic, and Peripatetic philosophers. According to Archytas the Pythagorean (as we are informed by Simplicius, on Aristotle's Categories) "time is a generative number, proceeding from the motion of the mundane soul, as from unity." But others of the ancients considered it as a certain extension of soul about intellect. Others confessed, that time was the period of soul and intellect. According to the determination of others, it is a natural extension about intellect. And others described time, by circulations in a circular nature: all which the Pythagoric sect comprehends. Time, therefore, according to Archytas and the most ancient philosophers, is a self-moving motion, and the number of temporal unity: for as eternity abides in *one*, so time is moved in *number*. According to Plato, "time is a certain image flowing in number, of eternity abiding in *one*." But according to Aristotle, "it is the number, or measure of motion according to prior, and posterior." But the opinion of Plotinus respecting time, is perhaps the most profound of all: and though the preceding definitions when attentively considered contain an abundance of intellectual truth, yet the doctrine of Plotinus on this subject *rekindles* a greater light in our intellectual conceptions. In his book then on eternity and time, which we have cited in the preceding proposition, after many admirable doubts concerning the nature of time, he enters on its definition, as follows:

"But it is requisite to recal ourselves again to that nature which we have said resides in eternity: a nature immutable and total, and a life infinite and indeclinable, and abiding in, and about the one. But time was not as yet, or at least was not among these true beings, but was about to follow, by a certain reason and nature of a posterior energy. Supernal natures therefore acting quietly among themselves, if any one desires to know how time first fell, he will not perhaps improperly call upon the Muses, who then were not, for the important explanation. Perhaps also he will opportunely invoke them, since the Muses then existed, according to true conceptions of their nature. And perhaps such a one will find time already generated, such as it now is, and manifests itself to our intellectual view. But he will speak concerning it after the following manner:

"Before priority originated, and was indigent of that which is posterior, time not yet existing according to pro-
 Vol. II. Z z cession,

PROPOSITION LIV.

Every *eternity* is the measure of eternal natures, and every *time* of temporal natures; and these are the only two measures of life and motion in beings.

FOR every thing which measures, either measures according to a part, or measures the whole, when it is accommodated to that which is measured. But that which measures according to the whole is eternity; and that which measures according to parts is time. There are therefore only two measures, this of eternal, and that of temporal natures.

cession, reposed together with priority in being itself, with a tranquil and intellectual energy. But at length time desiring a nature engaged in a multiplicity of affairs, and anxious to govern itself, and become independent, and always chusing to possess more of that which is present, began to be agitated, and at the same time commenced a flowing duration, subsisting in continual succession, and a transition into different periods of existence. And by conceiving that from this motion, a certain longitude of procession is effected, we establish time, as an image of eternity. For since it is a certain reflects power of the mundane soul, desirous of transferring what it there beholds, into another, it cannot sustain that a collected whole should be at once present with its nature: but as the spermatie reason, unfolding itself from a certain quiet seed, acts according to an abundant discursive energy; dispersing in the mean time that which is called abundant, by a certain division, and instead of the one which abides in itself, unfolding and consuming a non-abiding one, and thus proceeding into a more debile extension: so likewise the nature of the mundane soul fabricating the sensible world in imitation of that which is superior, and agitated with a motion, not such as the intelligible world contains, but rather similar to the motion which is there; with a motion I say affecting to represent its image, it renders itself in the first place temporal, as a substitute for eternity. But afterwards it endeavours to become subservient to time, because it compels the world to reside in time, comprehending all its transitions in its forming nature. For the world is moved in this nature; since there is no other place for the universe than the mundane soul; and in the time of this soul, it is agitated without end. For this soul applying one energy after another in succession, generates that which is consequent, together with its energy, and at the same time proceeds with a cogitation posterior to this energy, and which before this had no existence, because cogitation was not yet in energy. Its present life too, is now not entirely similar to the preceding life: and hence together with this energy, another life succeeds; and in consequence of this another time is produced. Time, therefore, is allotted a distance and protraction of life; and a perpetual prorogation of life, possesses a perpetual time. If any one, therefore, should say that time is an energy of the mundane soul, perpetually proceeding in a certain transitory motion, from one life to another, he will perhaps appear to assert something correspondent to the truth. For if eternity is life abiding in station, and in a habit similar and the same, and already infinite; and if it is requisite that time should be the image of eternity, in the same manner as this universe is the image of the intelligible world, certainly instead of the life which flourishes there, another life must reside in a certain power of the mundane soul, equivocal with respect to intelligible life; and instead of intellectual motion, it is requisite that there should be a motion of some part of the soul. Likewise instead of identity, and a similar and abiding habit, that which does not abide in the same, but always pursues a different energy must succeed. And again instead of a property indistant, and one, a resemblance of one possessing unity in a continued succession. Besides instead of that which is infinite and total, that which perpetually propagates itself in infinite succession. Lastly, instead of that which is a collected whole, that which sustains parts, and is always about to be total and perfect. For thus it will imitate that which is total, collected, and infinite, if it wishes its essence to consist in a continual pursuit of being; and thus resembles the being of eternity itself. But it is requisite not to receive time external to soul, in the same manner as eternity is not external to being itself. Nor again, must we conceive that time exists as an appendage, or any thing posterior, in the same manner as conceptions of this kind, are not proper to eternity: but we must contemplate it as beheld seated in the recesses of soul, with which it exists in conjunction, just as eternity subsists in being itself."

PROPO.

PROPOSITION LV.

Every thing subsisting according to time, either subsists in an eternal time, or has its subsistence in some part of time.

FOR if all progressions subsist by similitude, and prior to things perfectly dissimilar, things similar are more proximate to first natures than such as are dissimilar: and if it is impossible to conjoin with eternals, things formed in a part of time: (for as things generated differ from such as are self-subsistent, and things which have a partial, from such as have a perpetual existence, but the middle of these and those, are partly similar to them, and partly dissimilar.) Hence between things which are sometimes generated, and such as are eternal, the medium must either be that which is always in generation, or that which is sometimes, or that which is not truly, or does not possess true being. But it is impossible that the medium should be that which sometimes truly is. And that which is not true being, is the same with that which is sometimes in generation. Hence the medium cannot be that which *sometimes is*. It remains therefore that that which is always in generation, or in becoming to be, must be the middle of both: for on account of its passing, or flowing existence, it is conjoined with the worse nature, but on account of its perpetuity it imitates an eternal nature.

COROLLARY.

From hence it is evident that eternity is two-fold: for some things are of themselves eternal, but others according to time. And the former of these, is an *abiding* eternity; but the other a *flowing* eternity, or such as exists in becoming to be. And the former of these has its being united, and at once total; but the latter diffused, and unfolded according to temporal extension. And the former of these is essentially total; but the latter is composed from parts, each of which are separated according to prior, and posterior.

PROPOSITION LVI.

Every thing which is produced from secondary causes, is also produced from those prior and more principal causes, from which secondary causes are produced.

FOR if that which is secondary possesses its whole essence from that which is prior to itself, its power of producing emanates also from thence. For productive powers reside in producing causes according to essence, and replenish the essence of these. But if they are allotted a productive power from a superior cause, they possess from this

the cause of being, measured from thence according to an hypostatic, or fabricative power. But if this be the case, the productions of this secondary cause, are caused on account of that which is prior to its nature: for that which perfects a cause perfects also the thing caused. And that the thing caused is more perfected from thence, is manifest. For if that which is first gives to the second, the cause of producing, it will primarily possess this cause; and on this account that which is second generates, receiving from thence a secondary generative power. But if the one becomes productive through participation, but the other by communication; on this hypothesis likewise that will be the primary and more principal cause, which bestows a power of generating on another proximate to its nature.

PROPOSITION LVII.

Every cause both energizes prior to the thing caused, and is productive of more effects posterior to the things caused.

FOR so far as it is cause, it is more perfect and powerful than that which is posterior to its nature. And if this be the case it is the cause of more effects. For it is the property of a greater power to produce more, of that which is equal, equal, and of that which is less, less effects. And that which in things similar can effect greater things, can also accomplish such as are less. But that which can accomplish less effects, cannot necessarily effect greater. If, therefore, the cause is more powerful than the thing caused, it is also productive of more effects. But whatever the thing caused can accomplish, the cause is much more capable of effecting. For every thing which is produced from secondary causes, is much more produced from prior and more principal causes. Whatever, therefore, the thing caused is naturally adapted to produce, co-exists with the cause. But if the cause produces prior to the thing caused, it is evident that it energizes before the thing caused, according to its productive energy. Every cause therefore energizes prior to the thing caused; and in conjunction with, and posterior to its nature constitutes other effects.

COROLLARY.

From hence it is manifest, that whatever is caused by soul, is also caused by intellect, but whatever is caused by intellect, is not also caused by soul. For intellect energizes prior to soul; and whatever the soul confers on secondary natures, intellect also confers in a more ample manner. And when soul no longer energizes, intellect illuminates with its gifts, natures to which soul does not communicate its essence. For that which is inanimate, so far as it participates of form, participates of intellect, and the formation
of

of intellect. Besides, this likewise follows that whatever is caused by intellect is also caused by the good, but not the contrary. For the privations of forms emanate from the good: since all things flow from this. But intellect since it is form, is not the fabricator of privation.

PROPOSITION LVIII.

Every thing produced from many causes, is more compounded, than that which is produced from a few.

FOR if every cause confers something on that which proceeds from it, many causes will confer many gifts, but fewer causes will bestow fewer gifts. Of participants, therefore, some will consist from many, but others from a few of the things which each participates; the former indeed on account of their progression from many causes, but the latter on account of their progression from a few. But the former proceeding from many causes are more composite: and things proceeding from a few, are more simple than those which proceed from many causes. Hence every thing produced from many causes, is more compounded; but that which proceeds from a few is more simple. For the more compounded participates of that which the more simple participates, but the contrary to this, is not true.

PROPOSITION LIX.

Every thing essentially simple, is either more excellent, or worse than composite natures.

FOR if the *highest* of beings are produced from things fewer and more simple, but such as are in the *middle*, from a many, these will be composite. And with respect to the *extremes*, some are more simple, according to that which is more excellent, but others according to that which is worse. But that the highest beings are produced from fewer causes, is evident from their being superior, and originating prior to inferiors, and extending themselves over beings, beyond the progressions of subordinate natures, on account of their diminution of power. For on this account the last of beings *, is most simple, as well as the first, because it proceeds from the first alone. But one kind of simplicity subsists according to a nature more excellent, but another kind, according to that which is more base than every compound; and there will be the same proportion in all things.

* By the last of beings, he means matter, which on account of its formless nature may be considered as nothing more than the shadow of being; or something if possible still more privative and simple.

PROPOSITION LX.

Every thing which is the cause of a multitude of effects, is more excellent than that which is allotted a power productive of a few; when the few are parts of the many.

FOR if this is the cause of a few, but that of a many, and the few are parts of the many, that which forms the one, will also form the rest, if fabricative of a many. It is, therefore, more powerful and comprehensive of a greater multitude. For as production is to production, so is one producing cause to another, according to a mutual relation. But that which is capable of accomplishing more, possesses a greater, and more universal power. And this is nearer to the cause of all: but that which is nearer is a greater good: since the cause of all, is the good itself. Hence that which is the cause of many effects, is essentially more excellent than that which produces but a few.

PROPOSITION LXI.

Every power when impartible is greater, but when divided becomes less.

FOR if it is divided, it passes into multitude. And if this is the case, it becomes more distant from unity; and on this account is diminished in power; since it departs from unity by which it is contained, and acquires imperfection. Since the good of every thing subsists through the benefit of union.

PROPOSITION LXII.

Every multitude which is near to unity, is less in quantity than things farther distant, but is greater in power.

FOR that which is near is more similar to unity. But unity is constitutive of all things without multiplication. The cause, therefore, of many effects, is more similar to unity. Since the cause of all is the most uniform and impartible of all things; if the cause of all is *one*. As, therefore, that which is less multiplied is more allied to the one; so that which is productive of a multitude of effects, is more allied to the cause of all. But a nature of this kind is more powerful.

COROL

C O R O L L A R Y.

From hence it is evident, that there are more corporeal natures than souls; more souls than intellects; and more intellects than divine unities. And in all other natures there is the same proportion.

P R O P O S I T I O N LXIII.

Every imparticipable produces twofold orders of things participated; one in things which sometimes participate; but the other in such as participate always, and in a connate manner.

FOR that which is always participated, is more similar to an imparticipable than that which is sometimes participated. Hence that which is always participable, will subsist prior to that which is sometimes participated. Because it is participated indeed, differing from that which is posterior to itself, but because it is always more allied, it is also more similar to an imparticipable. Nor are there alone things, which are sometimes participated: for prior to these are the natures which are always participated; through which they are conjoined with imparticipables according to a certain well ordered progression. Nor are there alone natures which are always participated: for these, since they possess an unextinguishable power (on account of their perpetuity), bear other natures in their essence, viz. the natures which are sometimes participated. And as far as to these diminution and subjection extends.

C O R O L L A R Y.

From hence it is manifest, that of the unions, which illustrate beings from the one, some are always participated, but others sometimes: and that intellectual participations are in the same manner twofold; and likewise the animations of souls, and of other forms. For beauty, and similitude, and station, and identity, are imparticipable, but they are participated, through things which always participate, and by things which sometimes participate in a secondary manner, according to the same order.

P R O P O S I T I O N LXIV.

Every principal unity produces a twofold number; one indeed of self-perfect substances; but the other of illuminations, possessing their subsistence in others.

FOR if its progression takes place by subjection, and through things proper to fabricative causes; and if perfect natures proceed orderly from the perfect, and things imperfect

imperfect through these as mediums: hence some will be self-perfect substances, but others imperfect; and these last will become the forms of participants. For since they are imperfect, they will be indigent of subjects to their existence. But the perfect natures will make themselves their own participants: for since they are perfect, they will replenish and establish themselves. But they will require nothing of inferior natures, to their proper subsistence. Self-perfect substances, therefore, on account of their distinction into multitude, are diminished from their principal unity; but on account of their self-perfect essence, they are in a certain respect assimilated to it. But imperfect substances because they reside in others, are remote from that which is self-subsistent; and because they are imperfect, they are distant from that which perfects all things. But progressions are accomplished by things similar, as far as to things perfectly dissimilar. Hence every principal unity produces a twofold number.

C O R O L L A R Y.

From hence it is evident, that with respect to unities, some are self-perfect proceeding from *the one*: but that others are illuminations of unities and intellect. And again, that some of these are self-perfect essences, but others nothing more than resemblances of souls which are animated. And hence, neither is every unity a god, but this is peculiar to a self-perfect unity alone. Nor is every intellectual property an intellect, but that which is essential alone. Nor is every illustration of soul, a soul: but there are likewise images of souls.

P R O P O S I T I O N LXV.

Every thing which subsists in any manner whatever, either subsists according to cause, in a primary manner (or possessing the form of a principle ἀρχοειδώς) or according to hyparxis*, or according to participation, after the manner of an image (εικονικώς.)

FOR either the thing produced is beheld in its producing cause, as in a pre-existent cause: (because every cause previously assumes in itself, the thing caused, being that primarily, which its effect is secondarily) or the producer, is beheld in the thing produced. For since that which is produced participates of its producing cause, it exhibits in itself, in a secondary manner, that which its producer is primarily. Or every

* By *ὑπαρξίς*, *hyparxis*, in these Elements is meant that *characteristic* or *summit* of any nature, through which it subsists: and in the gods is the same with the *unity* and *deity* of their natures. And it is likewise necessary to inform the reader, that by *ὑποστάσις*, *hypostasis*, or subsistence, is meant any individual nature whether essential, or super-essential, considered as something distinct and different from accident.

thing is to be considered in its own order, and is not to be contemplated either in its cause, or in the thing caused. For the one so far as it exists, subsists after a more excellent mode; but the other, so far as it is, in a subordinate manner. But it is requisite that this last also, should be such as it is. And every thing subsists in its own order, according to hyparxis.

PROPOSITION LXVI.

All beings are to one another either wholes, or parts, and are either
the same, or different.

FOR either one comprehends, but the remainder are comprehended; or they neither comprehend, nor are comprehended. And they either suffer that which is the same, as participating one; or they are distinguished from one another. But if they comprehend they are wholes: and if they are comprehended they are parts. But if many things participate one, they are the same according to one. But if they are many only; so far as many they are different from each other.

PROPOSITION LXVII.

Every totality is either prior to parts, or composed from parts, or contained in a part.

FOR we either contemplate the form of every thing in its cause, and affirm that the whole which subsists in its cause is prior to parts; or we contemplate the form of a thing in the parts which participate of that form. And this in a twofold respect. For the form is either collectively in all the parts; and this is a whole composed from parts, any one of which when absent diminishes the whole itself. Or it is in each of the parts; so that every part according to participation becomes a whole, i. e. a partial whole. But the whole composed from parts subsists on account of essence. But that which is prior to parts according to cause: and that which subsists in a part, according to participation. For this is a whole according to ultimate subjection, so far as it imitates the whole consisting from parts; since it is not any part indifferently, but that which is capable of being assimilated to a whole, whose parts also are wholes.

PROPOSITION LXVIII.

Every whole contained in a part, is a part of that whole which is composed from parts.

FOR if it is a part, it is a part of some whole: and is either a part of that whole which abides in itself, according to which it is called a whole in a part. But on this hypothesis the whole would be a part of itself, and a part would be equal to the whole, and each would be the same. Or it will be a part of some other whole; and if of some other, it is either only a part of that other, in such a manner as again to differ in no respect from the whole. Or it will be a part together with some other whole. For the parts of every whole, are more than one; and this will be a whole composed from many parts. And thus the whole contained in a part, is a part of that whole which is composed from parts.

PROPOSITION LXIX.

Every whole composed from parts, participates of that totality which is prior to parts.

FOR if it is composed from parts, it becomes passive to a whole. For the parts since, they are made one, suffer a whole, on account of their union: and this is a whole subsisting in parts which are not wholes. But that which is imparticipable has an existence prior to every thing participated. An imparticipable totality, therefore, exists prior to a participated totality. And hence there is a certain species of totality, prior to that whole, which is composed from parts. And this is not a passive whole, but is an essential totality; from which the totality resulting from parts proceeds. Since likewise that whole which is composed from parts, subsists in many places, and in various ways, in many other things composed from parts. But it is requisite that there should be an essential monad or unity of all totalities. For each of these wholes is not sincere, because indigent of the parts from which it is composed, and which are themselves different from wholes. Nor if this whole was generated in any thing particular, could it be the cause that all others are wholes. The cause, therefore, by which all things are wholes, is prior to parts. For if this also was composed from parts, it would be a *certain whole*, and not that which is *simply whole*. And this again would subsist from another whole: and this must either be the case in infinitum, or there must be a first whole; a whole not composed from parts, but that which is a perfect totality.

PROPO-

PROPOSITION LXX.

That which is more universal subsists in principal causes, and prior to particulars illuminates participants; and leaves that which participates as second in order from principal causes.

FOR a more universal cause begins its energy in secondary natures, prior to that which is posterior to a more universal cause: and it is present not only when that which is posterior is present, but even when the energy of that which is posterior is no more; and it energises in a more causal manner, and this not only in different subjects, but also in each of the things which sometimes participate. Thus for example it is requisite, that being should be first, afterwards animal, and then man. And the species man no longer exists, when deserted by the rational power: but animal, breathing and sentient, will still subsist. And again, though life is taken away, being remains: for when man ceases to live, being is present. And the same reasoning may be adopted in all things. But a cause which is more efficacious, and which is on this account more causal, energises first in a more causal nature: for it suffers the same from a cause more powerful, and prior to itself; and it co-energises with that which is secondary when in energy. For every thing which generates that which is secondary, congenerates also that which is more causal: and when that which is secondary deserts the more causal nature, that which generates the secondary nature is present. For the communication of a more powerful cause, when it is more efficacious, leaves that which participates it, the last of all. For through the communication of that which is second, it strengthens its own illumination.

PROPOSITION LXXI.

All things which abide in principal causes, and which possess a more universal and superior order in effects, according to the illuminations proceeding from them, become in a certain respect the subjects of the communications of particulars. And the illustrations emanating from superior, receive the progressions of secondary natures. And thus some participations antecede others, and representations,

sentations, or resemblances (*ἐμφάσεις*) supernally coalesce one after another in the same subject: things more universal energizing first, but particulars posterior to the energy of universals, bestowing their communications on their participants.

FOR if things which partake more of cause, energize prior to things secondary, on account of their exuberance of power, and are present with, and illuminate things endued with a more imperfect aptitude: but if things more subordinate, and which are second in order, receive their communications from these; it is evident that the illustrations of superior natures pre-occupy that which participates of both, and establish the communications of subordinate natures. But these illustrations use the resemblances emanating from superior natures, as supports and foundations, and operate in a participant prepared by superior natures.

PROPOSITION LXXII.

All things which in their participants have the relation of a subject, proceed from more perfect and universal causes.

FOR the causes of many effects are more powerful and universal, and nearer to *the one*, than the causes of a few effects. But things producing the subjects of others, are the causes of many effects, because they likewise produce aptitudes, before forms are present. And hence these are more universal and perfect in the order of causes.

COROLLARY.

From hence it is evident why matter which derives its subsistence from *the one*, is essentially destitute of form. And why body is effectually destitute of soul, although it participates of being. For matter which is the subject of all things proceeds from the cause of all*: but body which is the subject of animation, subsists from that which is more universal than soul, because it participates of being in a certain respect.

* By matter proceeding from the cause of all, nothing more is meant than that it depends entirely on the first cause for its shadowy and unreal subsistence: for as the emanations of causes are extended in proportion to their eminence; hence the processions of the one extend beyond those of every other cause, and even leave faint traces of their illuminations in the dark receptacle of matter.

PROPO-

PROPOSITION LXXIII.

Every whole is at the same time a certain being, and participates of being: but every being is not a whole.

FOR either *being* and *whole* is the same; or the one is prior, and the other posterior.

But a part also, so far as a part, is a certain being (for that which is a whole consists from partial beings) yet is not an essential whole. And hence *being* and *whole* is not the same: for on this hypothesis, a part would be a *non-entity*. But if the part is a *non-entity*, neither can the whole be *being*. For every whole is a whole of parts, either considered as existing prior to the parts*, or as inherent in the parts. But the part being a *non-entity*, it is impossible that the whole can exist. But if the whole is prior to being, every being will be immediately a whole; and so a part, will not be a part, which is impossible. For if a whole is a whole, and is a whole of parts; the part also existing as a part, will be a part of the whole. It remains therefore that every *whole* is *being*, but not every *being* a *whole*.

COROLLARY.

For hence it is evident that the first being is above totality, since being is present to a multitude of things: for it affords essence to parts, so far as parts. But totality is present to fewer natures. For the cause of a multitude of effects is more excellent: but that of a few is subordinate, as is demonstrated.

PROPOSITION LXXIV.

Every form is a certain whole.

FOR it is composed from a multitude of things, each of which replenishes the form.

But every whole is not a form. For that which is particular, and an indivisible, is indeed a whole, so far as it is an indivisible; but is not a form: For every whole consists from parts. But form or species, is that which may be divided into many particular forms. Hence *whole*, and *form* differ from each other: and the former is inherent in more natures than the latter. That which is *whole*, therefore, is above the *forms* of beings.

COROLLARY.

From hence it is evident that *whole* possesses a middle order between being, and forms: and hence it follows that being is prior to forms, and that forms, are beings;

* This follows from Prop. 69. For every whole prior to parts, may be said to be a whole of parts, because every whole formed from parts, participates of that totality which is prior to parts.

and yet every being is not a form. From hence likewise in effects, privations are after a certain manner beings, yet they are not forms *. But on account of the unifying power of being, they likewise receive a certain debile representation of being.

PROPOSITION LXXV.

Every thing which is called a cause properly, is exempt from its effect.

FOR if it subsisted in its effect, it must either replenish its effect, or be indigent of it in a certain respect, in order to its being; and thus be more imperfect than its effect. But that which abides in its effect, is more an assistant-cause than cause itself: because it is either a part of that which is made, or an instrument of that which makes. For the part subsisting in that which is made, is more imperfect than the whole: and the instrument which supplies the measures of fabrication to the efficient, is not able to separate itself. Every thing, therefore, which is properly a cause, if it is more perfect, than that which proceeds from it, affords likewise a measure to generation, and is exempt from instruments, and elements, and from every thing which is simply called an assisting cause.

PROPOSITION LXXVI.

Every thing which is produced from an immoveable cause, possesses an immutable hyparxis: but every thing which emanates from a moveable cause, possesses a mutable hyparxis.

FOR if every thing which fabricates is entirely immovable, it produces that which is second from itself, not by motion, but by being. But if this be the case, that which emanates from it, concurs with its essence. And if this be the case, as long as it exists, it will produce. But it always is, and therefore will always produce that which is posterior to itself. Hence too that which is posterior always emanates from thence, and always is; conjoining its own *progressive ever*, with the *ever* according to energy, of an immoveable cause. If, therefore, the cause is moved, that also which is produced by it will be essentially mutable. For that which derives its essence through motion, when

* Thus matter possesses a certain obscure image of being, but does not preserve the most debile impression of form. For as the gradations of being are more extended than those of form, and as matter is the last of things; hence matter may be said to retain the footstep of being in its dark receptacle, whilst the processions of form are reflected like echoes from its rebounding seat.

the motion is changed, changes its being. For if that which is produced from motion abides immutable, it will be more excellent than its producing cause: but this is impossible. It will not, therefore, be immutable; and will consequently be changed, and moved according to essence, imitating the motion by which it is produced.

PROPOSITION LXXVII.

Every being in *capacity*, emanates from that which is *energy*; and that which is in capacity proceeds into energy. But that which is in a certain respect in capacity, so far as it is in capacity, emanates from that which is in a certain respect in energy. And that which is all things in capacity proceeds from that which is all things in energy.

FOR that which is in capacity is not adapted to produce itself into energy, because it is imperfect. For if that which is imperfect should become the cause of perfection to itself, and this in energy, the cause will be more imperfect than that which it produces. Hence that which is in capacity, so far as in capacity, will not be to itself, the cause of subsisting in energy. For on this hypothesis, so far as it is imperfect, it will be to itself the cause of the perfect: since every thing in capacity, so far as in capacity, is imperfect. But every thing which is in energy, so far as in energy, is perfect. If then that which is in capacity becomes in energy, it will inherit perfection from something else. And this again, will be either in capacity; (but then again, the imperfect will be generative of the perfect), or it will be in energy. And either something else, or this which is in capacity, will rise into energy. But if something else in energy operates, acting according to its propriety, it will produce into energy, that which is in capacity, in another. Nor will this again be in energy; unless it rises into energy from capacity. It remains, therefore, that from that which is in energy, that which is in capacity must be changed into energy.

PROPOSITION LXXVIII.

All power or capacity is either perfect, or imperfect.

FOR that which produces energy is a perfect power: for it makes other things perfect through its energies. But that which is perfective of others, is greater, because it is more self-perfect. But the power which is indigent of something pre-existing

ing in energy, according to which it is something in capacity, is imperfect: for it is indigent of the perfect abiding in another, that it may become perfect through its participation. And hence such a power is essentially imperfect. Hence too the power which subsists in energy is perfect, because prolific of energy. But the power which subsists in capacity is imperfect; deriving its perfection from power in energy.

PROPOSITION LXXIX.

Every thing which is generated, is generated from a twofold power.

FOR it is requisite that it should be adapted to generation, and that it should possess an imperfect power. It is likewise requisite that the agent being in energy, such as that which is generated is in capacity, should previously assume a perfect power. For every energy proceeds from inherent power. For if the agent does not possess power, how can it energise, and operate in another? But if that which is generated, does not possess power according to aptitude, how can it be fabricated? For that which produces, produces every thing, in that which possesses a passive power; but not in every thing; nor in that which is not naturally passive to the energies of the producing cause.

PROPOSITION LXXX.

Every body is naturally adapted to passivity: but every thing incorporeal is naturally adapted to fabricate. And the former is essentially inefficacious, but the latter is impassive. Yet that which is incorporeal becomes passive through its communion with body: just in the same manner, as bodies are enabled to fabricate, through the participation of incorporeals.

FOR body, as body is divisible alone, and through this becomes passive; being every way partible, and this every way in infinitum. But that which is incorporeal, because it is simple, is impassive. For neither can that which is impartible be divided, nor can that which is incomposite be altered. Hence nothing will be fabricative, or this must be affirmed of an incorporeal: since body so far as body, does not operate, because it is alone exposed to division and passivity; while on the contrary every agent possesses an active power. Hence it will not fabricate so far as body, but according to a power of operating, which it contains. But body is essentially inefficacious, and impotent: and hence when it fabricates, it fabricates by a participation of power. But incorporeals
likewise

likewise participate of passions, when they abide in bodies; because in this case they are divided in conjunction with bodies, and enjoy their partible nature, though at the same time, they are impartible according to their proper essence.

PROPOSITION LXXXI.

Every thing which is participated in a separable manner, is present by a certain inseparable power, which it inserts in its participant.

FOR if it is separable from its participant, and does not abide in it, as that which possesses a subsistence in itself, a certain medium is requisite, which may connect the one with the other, and which is more similar to that which is participated, and to that which participates. For if this medium is separable, how can it be participated by the participant? Since neither the participant contains the medium nor any thing proceeding from this medium. A power, therefore, and illumination emanating from this medium, into its participant, conjoins both. One thing, therefore, is that through which participation subsists, but the second is that which is participated, and the third is the participant.

PROPOSITION LXXXII.

Every thing incorporeal, because converted to itself, when it is participated by others, is participated in a separable manner.

FOR if in an inseparable manner, its energy will not be separable from its participant, any more than its essence. But if this be the case, it will not be converted to itself. For if it is converted it will be separable and different from its participant. If, therefore, it is capable of being converted to itself, it is participated in a separable manner, when it is participated by others.

PROPOSITION LXXXIII.

Every thing endued with a self-gnostic power, is entirely converted to itself.

FOR that which is converted to itself, in energy, manifestly knows itself: for that which knows is one and the same with that which is known; and the knowledge

ing in energy, according to which it is something in capacity, is imperfect: for it is indigent of the perfect abiding in another, that it may become perfect through its participation. And hence such a power is essentially imperfect. Hence too the power which subsists in energy is perfect, because prolific of energy. But the power which subsists in capacity is imperfect; deriving its perfection from power in energy.

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FOR it is requisite that it should be adapted to generation, and that it should possess an imperfect power. It is likewise requisite that the agent being in energy, such as that which is generated is in capacity, should previously assume a perfect power. For every energy proceeds from inherent power. For if the agent does not possess power, how can it energise, and operate in another? But if that which is generated, does not possess power according to aptitude, how can it be fabricated? For that which produces, produces every thing, in that which possesses a passive power; but not in every thing; nor in that which is not naturally passive to the energies of the producing cause.

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FOR body, as body is divisible alone, and through this becomes passive; being every way partible, and this every way in infinitum. But that which is incorporeal, because it is simple, is impassive. For neither can that which is impartible be divided, nor can that which is incomposite be altered. Hence nothing will be fabricative, or this must be affirmed of an incorporeal: since body so far as body, does not operate, because it is alone exposed to division and passivity; while on the contrary every agent possesses an active power. Hence it will not fabricate so far as body, but according to a power of operating, which it contains. But body is essentially inefficacious, and impotent: and hence when it fabricates, it fabricates by a participation of power. But incorporeals
likewise

likewise participate of passions, when they abide in bodies; because in this case they are divided in conjunction with bodies, and enjoy their partible nature, though at the same time, they are impartible according to their proper essence.

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Every thing which is participated in a separable manner, is present by a certain inseparable power, which it inserts in its participant.

FOR if it is separable from its participant, and does not abide in it, as that which possesses a subsistence in itself, a certain medium is requisite, which may connect the one with the other, and which is more similar to that which is participated, and to that which participates. For if this medium is separable, how can it be participated by the participant? Since neither the participant contains the medium nor any thing proceeding from this medium. A power, therefore, and illumination emanating from this medium, into its participant, conjoins both. One thing, therefore, is that through which participation subsists, but the second is that which is participated, and the third is the participant.

PROPOSITION LXXXII.

Every thing incorporeal, because converted to itself, when it is participated by others, is participated in a separable manner.

FOR if in an inseparable manner, its energy will not be separable from its participant, any more than its essence. But if this be the case, it will not be converted to itself. For if it is converted it will be separable and different from its participant. If, therefore, it is capable of being converted to itself, it is participated in a separable manner, when it is participated by others.

PROPOSITION LXXXIII.

Every thing endued with a self-gnostic power, is entirely converted to itself.

FOR that which is converted to itself, in energy, manifestly knows itself: for that which knows is one and the same with that which is known; and the knowledge

of itself reverts to itself, as that which is known. And as this knowledge belongs to that which knows, it is a certain energy: but it is an energy of itself to itself, because it possesses a power of knowing itself. But that this also subsists in essence if in energy has been demonstrated. For every thing which is converted to itself in energy, contains also an essence verging to itself.

PROPOSITION LXXXIV.

Every thing which always *is*, possesses an infinite power:

FOR if its essence is never-failing, its power also, according to which it is what it is, and is able to be, must be infinite. For if the power according to which it subsists was finite, it would some time or other fail. But if it should fail, the being also of that which possesses this power must fail; nor would it be any longer an eternal being. It is requisite, therefore, that the power belonging to, and containing that which always is, should be essentially infinite.

PROPOSITION LXXXV.

Every thing which is always *in generation* (ἀεὶ γινόμενον), possesses an infinite power of *being generated* (τε γίνεσθαι).

FOR if it is always in the act of becoming to be, it contains a never-failing power of generation. For if its power was finite, it would cease in a infinite time. But if its power of being generated ceases, that also which is in generation will cease; viz. that which is in generation according to this power will cease; nor will it any longer be always in generation*. But it is always in generation, according to the hypothesis: and consequently it possesses an infinite power of being generated.

* The proposition ends here in the Greek, though very erroneously; and its conclusion forms the beginning of the next proposition. It is strange that Portus should not have detected, this egregious mistake, which the alteration of a single letter, would have enabled him to rectify. Thus if after ἀλλὰ μὲν εἰς ἐκείνους γινόμενον. ἀμείβετο ἀεὶ ἔχει τὸ τε γίνεσθαι δύναμις, which is the conclusion of the proposition; καὶ τὸ εἶναι δέ, &c. is retained, instead of καὶ τὸ εἶναι δέ, and is made the beginning of the next proposition, the whole will be correct and plain. Such mistakes, are dreadful instances of the danger attending the understanding from the study of words alone.

PROPOSITION LXXXVI.

Every *true being* is infinite, not according to multitude, nor according to magnitude, but according to power alone.

FOR every infinite is either in multitude, or in magnitude, or in power. But true being is indeed infinite, as possessing an inextinguishable life, a never-failing essence, and an undiminished energy. Nor is it infinite on account of magnitude; since that which is true being, is without magnitude, and self-subsistent. For every self-subsistent being, is impartible, and simple. Nor is it infinite, on account of multitude, for it is most uniform, on account of its vicinity, and alliance to the one. But the one is infinite according to power: and hence through this, true being will be impartible and infinite. And indeed by how much the more it is one and impartible, by so much the more will it be infinite. For power when distributed into parts, becomes debile, and finite. And powers entirely partible, are entirely finite. For such as are last, and most distant from the one, are after a certain manner finite: but first powers are on account of their impartibility infinite. For partition dissipates and dissolves the power of every thing. But impartibility, from its binding and collective nature, contains in itself, that which is never-failing and undiminished. But infinite according to magnitude and multitude, is entirely a privation, and desertion of impartibility. For that which is finite proximately approaches to that which is impartible; while that which is infinite is most distant from an impartible nature, because it on all sides departs from the one. Hence that which is infinite according to power, does not belong to the infinite, either of multitude, or magnitude: since infinite power is co-existent with impartibility. But infinite, either in multitude or magnitude is most distant from an impartible nature. If, therefore, true being was infinite, either in magnitude, or multitude, it would not be endued with infinite power. But it is endued with infinite power, and is, therefore, not infinite, either according to magnitude, or multitude.

PROPOSITION LXXXVII.

Every thing eternal, is *being*; but not every being is *eternal*.

FOR in generated natures the participation of being, is after a certain manner inherent, so far as they are not that, which is in no respect being. But if that which is in generation, is not that which is in no respect being (*οὐδαμῶς ὄν*), it is being, in a certain respect (*ἐν τινὶ ὄν*). But that which is eternal, or eternity itself, is in no respect inherent

in generated natures; and is particularly separated from things which do not participate of eternity, according to the whole of time. But every thing eternal always is; for it participates of eternity itself, which confers perpetual being, on the natures by which it is participated. *Being*, therefore, is participated by more natures than *eternity*; and hence *being* is above *eternity*. For things which participate eternity, participate also of being: but not all that participate of being, participate also of eternity.

PROPOSITION LXXXVIII.

Every true being, is either prior to eternity, or abides in eternity, or participates of eternity.

BUT that it is above, or prior to eternity, is demonstrated in the preceding proposition. And it likewise abides in eternity: for eternity possesses perpetuity together with being. And this is also true of that which participates of eternity: for every thing eternal, is called eternal from its participation of perpetuity and being. For this according to participation possesses both perpetuity and being. But *eternity* possesses perpetuity the first of all; but *being*, through participation *. And being itself, is the first being.

PROPOSITION LXXXIX.

Every *primary being* (*πρώτως ὄν*) consists of *bound*, and *infinite*.

FOR if it is endued with infinite power, it is evident that it is infinite, and through this subsists from *infinite*. But if it is impartible and uniform, through this it participates of *bound*. For that which participates of the one, is bounded. But that which is impartible, is at the same time endued with infinite power. Every true being, therefore, consists from *bound* and *infinite*.

* To a reader not skilled in the Platonic philosophy, it will doubtless appear strange, that *being* should be prior to *eternity*, and yet each participate of one another. This apparent paradox may be easily solved, by considering that the mode of participation is different in each. For *being* participates of eternity, as establishing, illuminating, replenishing, and deifying eternity: but *eternity* participates of being, as depending upon, established and deified by being. So that when a superior, participates of an inferior nature, the participation consists in the energy of the former on the latter: but when an inferior participates of a superior nature, the participation consists in its receiving the communications of the superior nature.

PROPOSITION XC.

First bound, and first infinity, have a self-subsistence prior to all things which consist from bound and infinite.

FOR if beings which subsist from themselves, subsist prior to certain beings, because common to all, and primary causes, and this not to some in particular, but simply to all; it is requisite that there should be a first bound, and a first infinity prior to that which consists from both. For in that which is mixed, *bound* participates of *infinity*, and *infinity* of *bound*. But the first of each, is no other than that which it is. It is requisite, therefore, that that which is *primarily infinite* should not possess the form of *bound*, and that that which is *primarily bound*, should not possess the form of *infinity*. And hence these subsist primarily prior to that which is mixed.

PROPOSITION XCI.

Every power is either bounded, or infinite. But every terminated power subsists from infinite power: and infinite power from *first infinity*.

FOR powers which have a partial existence, or subsist sometimes, are bounded; because they have fallen from the infinity of perpetual being. But the powers of eternal beings, are infinite, because they never desert their own hyparxis.

PROPOSITION XCII.

Every multitude of infinite powers, depends on one first infinity, which is not as a participated power, and which does not subsist in things endued with power, but is essential; not existing as the power of any participant, but as the cause of all beings.

FOR though the first being possesses power, yet it is not power itself: for it likewise possesses bound. But the first power is infinity: for infinite powers, are infinite, through the participation of infinity. Infinity itself, therefore, will be before all powers; through which being also possesses infinite power, and all things participate of infinity. For *that which is first*, is not infinity: for that is the measure of all things, because it is the good, and the one. Nor is *being* infinity: for this is infinite, but not infinity (or infinite itself.) Hence between that which is first, and being itself, infinity subsists, as the cause of all things endued with infinite power, and of all the infinity in beings.

PROPO-

PROPOSITION XCIII.

Every infinite subsisting in beings, is neither infinite with respect to superior natures; nor is it infinite to itself.

FOR that by which every thing is infinite, by this also it is without circumscription. But every thing in natures superior to beings, is bounded in itself, and in all things prior to itself. It remains, therefore, that the infinite belonging to inferior natures, belongs to them alone, above which it is expanded in such a manner, that it is incomprehensible by them all. For however they may extend themselves towards this infinite, yet it possesses something entirely exempt from their nature. And though all things enter into this infinite, yet it possesses something occult, and incomprehensible by secondary natures. And again, though it expands its powers, yet it contains something on account of its union, invincible, convolved, and surpassing their involutions. Likewise containing and bounding itself, it will not be infinite to itself; and much less will it be infinite with respect to superior natures, because it possesses a portion of the infinity which they contain. For the powers of more universal natures are more infinite*, because they are more universal, and are placed nearer to the first infinity.

PROPOSITION XCIV.

Every eternity is a certain infinity, but every infinity is not an eternity.

FOR many infinities possess *the infinite*, not on account of their perpetuity; as is evident in the infinity according to multitude, and according to magnitude, and in the infinity of matter; and whatever else may be infinite, either because it cannot be passed over, or on account of the indefinite nature of its essence. But that eternity is an infinity, is evident: for that which never fails is infinite: and this because it possesses a never-failing subsistence. Infinity, therefore, is prior to eternity. For that which constitutes a greater multitude, and is more universal, is a more causal nature. *First infinity*, therefore, is above eternity, and *infinity itself*, is prior to eternity.

* The reader must not be surprised to find that among infinities, some are more infinite than others. For as among beings some are truer than others, and possess more of real being in proportion as they approach nearer to being itself; at the same time that they are all in a certain respect beings: so infinities possess more of infinity, as they approach nearer to the infinite itself. Thus for instance eternity possesses infinity more truly than time, though time also is infinite; because the infinity of eternity, is a stable indivisible life, but the infinity of time consists in an unceasing progression, or as it were an unwearied pursuit of infinity, which it can alone obtain in an extended and partible manner. And this difference among infinities extends even to matter itself, which is the most degraded and abject of all infinities, because it is infinite only in the most dormant capacity.

PROPO-

PROPOSITION XCV.

Every power which possesses more of the nature of the one than of multitude, is more infinite than the power which is multiplied.

FOR if the first infinity is the nearest to the one, hence of the powers which are more allied to the one, that which is less distant from the one, is more infinite. For when multiplied it loses its uniform nature; in which when it abides, it will possess a superiority among other natures, being contained by impartibility. For among partible natures, collected powers are multiplied, but such as are divided, are debilitated.

PROPOSITION XCVI.

The power of every finite body, when infinite is incorporeal.

FOR if this power is corporeal, since in this case it would be an infinite body, infinite would reside in that which is finite. But if this power is a finite body, it will not be an infinite power, on account of body, but on account of something else. For if through body it is finite, but through power infinite; it will not be power, on account of body. Hence the infinite power, which resides in a finite body is incorporeal.

PROPOSITION XCVII.

Every principal cause in every series, communicates its property to all that series: and the series is that by remission, or subjection, which this cause is after a primary manner.

FOR if it is the leader of the whole series, and all kindred natures, are co-ordinated to this cause, it is manifest, that it confers on all one idea, through which they are allotted an order under the same series. For either all things participate of similitude with this principal cause, without a cause; or the sameness which is in all, proceeds from this principal cause. But that this should be the case, without a cause, is impossible: for that which is without a cause is fortuitous. But among things in which there is order, and a connection with each other, and which always abide in the same state,

state, chance can never take place. From this principal cause, therefore, the whole series receives the property of its subsistence. And if from this cause, it is evident that it receives this property with remission, and a descent accommodated to secondary natures. For either this property subsists in a similar manner, in that which is principal, and in things secondary, and the former presides, but the latter are allotted a subsistence posterior to the principal; or it subsists in a dissimilar manner. And if this is the case, it is manifest that identity in multitude proceeds from one, and not the contrary; and that the property which primarily pre-exists in one, is secondarily in multitude, and is exempt from the series.

PROPOSITION XCVIII.

Every separate cause, is at once, every where, and no where.

FOR by the communication of its power, it is every where. For this is a cause, which replenishes things naturally adapted to participate of its nature, and is the leader of all secondary natures, and is present to all the prolific progressions of illustrations. But, on account of an essence unmingled with things in place, and through its excellent purity, it is no where. For if it is separate from effects, it is placed above all things. In like manner it resides in none of the natures subordinate to itself. For if it was alone every where, it would not indeed be hindered from being a cause, and it would be in all participants: but it would not be in a separate manner prior to all. But if it was no where, without being every where, it would not indeed be restrained from being prior to all things, and it would not be any one of subordinate natures, but it would not be in all things; as causes are naturally in things caused, through their abundant communications. On account of its being a cause, therefore, it is in all things which are able to participate its nature: and from its being separate in itself, it is prior to all the natures which it replenishes; and is at once every where and no where. And indeed it is not according to a part every where, and according to a part no where: for thus it would suffer a divulsion and separation from itself: since one part of itself would be every where in all things, and another part would be no where, and prior to all things. But it is total, every where and no where, after the same manner. For things which are able to participate of this cause, abide in the whole, and find the whole present with their nature; while this whole is exempt from its participants. For its participant does not establish this whole in itself, but participates of it as much as it is able to receive. Nor in communicating does it contract itself, through the participations of a multitude of things: for it is separate. Nor do the participants participate in a defective manner: for that which communicates is every where.

PROP O-

PROPOSITION XCIX.

Every imparticipable, so far as it is an imparticipable, does not subsist from another cause, but is the principle and cause of all participated natures. And in consequence of this every principle in every series is without generation.

FOR if it is imparticipable, it is allotted a principality in its own proper series, and does not proceed from others: for it would not be the first, if it received that property on account of which it is imparticipable, from any other. But if it is worse than others and proceeds from them, it is not allotted a progression, so far as it is imparticipable, but so far as it is a participant. For in this case it participates of the natures from which it proceeds, and the things which it participates have not a primary subsistence. But that which is imparticipable has a primary subsistence. And hence so far as it is imparticipable it does not flow from a cause*. For if it proceeded from a cause, it would be a participant, and not an imparticipable. But so far as it is an imparticipable, it is the cause of participants, and not that which participates of others.

PROPOSITION C.

Every series of wholes is extended to an imparticipable cause and principle. But all imparticipables depend on one first principle of all.

FOR if every series suffers a certain sameness, there is something in every ruling nature, which is the cause of identity. For as all beings proceed from *the one*, so likewise every series emanates from *one*. But all imparticipable unities are reduced to the one itself: because all of them are analogous to the one. So far, therefore, as they suffer a certain sameness, through their analogy to the one, so far they are reduced to the one itself. And so far as they all proceed from *the one*, none of them is a principle, but they flow from *the one*, as from a principle. But so far as each of them is imparticipable,

* Thus for instance the first being, or *being itself*, does not flow from any being as its cause, because it is without any participation of being: and though it proceeds from a superior cause, i. e. the *one itself*, yet it does not proceed from this cause, on account of its being an imparticipable, but on account of its being subordinate to *the one*, and consequently a participant of the one. And this is likewise true in every other imparticipable.

ble, so far each of them is a principle. Because, therefore, they are principles of certain things, they depend on the principle of all: for that is the principle of all, of which all participate. But the first is alone participated by all things; while some things only participate of the rest. And hence *the one* is that which is simply the first. But others are firsts with relation to a certain order, but are not simply firsts.

PROPOSITION CI.

The leader of all things participating of intellect, is an imparticipable intellect: of all things participating life, an imparticipable life: and of all things participating being, an imparticipable being. But of these, being is prior to life, and life is prior to intellect.

FOR since in every order of beings, imparticipables are prior to participants, it is requisite that there should be an intellect prior to intellectuals, life prior to things vital, and being prior to beings. But since that which is the cause of more effects precedes that which is the cause of a fewer; hence among these being will be the first: for it is present to all things, to which life and intellect is present. For every thing vital and intellectual participates of being; but the contrary is not a necessary consequence: since all beings are not endued with life, and intellect. But the second in order is life: for all things to which intellect is present, participate also of life; but the contrary is not true. For many things are endued with life, but are destitute of cognition. But the third is intellect. For every thing which is endued in any respect with cognition, both lives, and possesses being. If, therefore, being is the cause of more effects; but life of fewer; and intellect of still fewer: hence *being* is the first in order, *life* the second, and *intellect* the third.

PROPOSITION CII.

All beings, in whatever manner they may possess being, consist from *bound* and *infinite*, through the first being. But all vital natures, are self-motive, through the first life. And all gnostic natures, participate of cognition, through the first intellect.

FOR if that which is in every series imparticipable, communicates its peculiar property, to all things under the same series; it is evident that being first communicates

cates to all things *bound* together with *infinite*; since it is primarily mixed from these. And life imparts the motion resident in its nature: for life is the first progression and motion, from the stable subsistence of being. And lastly, intellect imparts cognition: for the summit of all cognition, is in intellect; and intellect is the first gnostic nature.

PROPOSITION CIII.

All things are in all, but subsist peculiarly in each.

FOR in being there is both life and intellect; and in life, being and intellection; and in intellect, being and life. But in intellect all things subsist intellectually, in life vitally, and in being, according to true beings. For since every thing subsists, either, according to cause, or according to essence, or according to participation: and since in the first the rest subsist according to cause; and in the second, the first subsists through participation, and the third through cause: and in the third, natures prior to its own, subsist through participation; hence in *being*, *life* and *intellect* preside. But since every thing receives its characteristic, according to hyparxis, and not according to cause (for cause pertains to other things, or to effects); nor yet according to participation (for it receives externally that which it participates): hence in being there is *true* * life and *true* intelligence, essential life and essential intellect. And in life, there is being according to participation; but intelligence according to cause. But both of these are vitally inherent in life: for its hyparxis is according to life. And in intellect there is both life and essence, through participation: but both these subsist intellectually. For the being and life of intellect is knowledge.

PROPOSITION CIV.

Every thing which is primarily eternal, has both its essence, and energy eternal.

FOR if it is primarily allotted the perpetuity of eternity, it does not partly participate of this, and partly not; but it entirely participates of perpetuity. For either participating according to energy, it does not participate according to essence: but this is impossible, since in this case, energy would be more excellent than essence. Or parti-

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icipating according to essence, it does not participate according to energy. And thus that which is primarily eternal, will be the same with that, which primarily participates of time *. And time will primarily measure the essence of some things, but eternity which is more excellent than all time, will be the measure of nothing: since that which is primarily eternal, will not be contained by eternity according to energy †. Every thing, therefore, primarily eternal, has both its essence and energy eternal.

PROPOSITION CV.

Every thing immortal is eternal, but every thing eternal is not immortal.

FOR if that is immortal which always participates of life, and that which always participates of life, participates also of being, and that which is always vital is perpetual; hence every thing immortal is eternal. For that is *immortal* which does not receive death, and perpetually *lives*: but that is *eternal* which cannot receive non-being, and which always *is*. But if there are many beings more excellent and worse than life, but which are not susceptible of immortality, though they are perpetual beings; it follows that every thing eternal is not immortal. But that many perpetual beings; are not immortal is evident. For there are certain beings, destitute indeed of life; yet perpetual and incorruptible ‡: since as being is to life, so is that which is eternal to that which is immortal. For that life which cannot be taken away, is *immortality itself*. And being which cannot be destroyed, is *eternity itself*. But being is more comprehensive than life: and hence that which is eternal is more comprehensive than that which is immortal §.

* For if that which is primarily eternal, is eternal according to essence, but not according to energy, it will be the same with the world, which is the first participant of time. For the world is essentially eternal, because though its parts are subject to change, yet considered as a whole, it is perpetually the same. But then it is not eternal in energy, but in capacity alone. For it subsists in a perpetual capacity of existence; and its flowing essence is perpetually composed from the past, present, and future circulations of time.

† In the original it is *κατ' ἐνέργειαν*, but it should doubtless be read, according to our translation *κατ' ἰσχύαν*.

‡ Thus for instance the qualities which subsist about bodies are incorporeal, and consequently eternal and incorruptible; but yet they are not immortal, because they are destitute of life.

§ In the Greek *ἀθάνατος* is erroneously printed, instead of *ἀβυσσος*, which the reader will evidently perceive must be the true reading. But though this is sufficiently obvious to those who understand the proposition; yet Portus, who seldom attends to the meaning, has, from not rectifying this mistake, given the most ridiculous translation of this concluding sentence, that can possibly be imagined. The original is: *τὸ δὲ ἐν τῷ ζωῇ περιλαμβανόμενον, καὶ τὸ ἀθάνατον, (lege ἀβυσσος) ἅπα τὰ αἰῶνα*. The translation of Portus: "Illud vero, quod est, vitam, et mortem magis complectitur, vel, ipsum vero ens, plura complectitur, et latius patet, quam vita et mors. Ergo ipsum eternum est illud, quod non recipit ipsum non esse, et quod semper est; i. e. "But that which is, comprehends in a greater degree, life and death; or being itself comprehends more, and is of greater extent than life and death. Therefore, eternity itself, is that which does not receive non-being, and which always is."

PROPO-

PROPOSITION CVI.

The medium of every thing entirely eternal, both according to essence, and according to energy, and of that which has its essence in time; is that which is in a certain respect eternal, but which in a certain respect is measured by time.

FOR that which has its essence comprehended by time is entirely temporal: for this in a most primary manner, is allotted a temporal energy. But that which according to all things is temporal, is perfectly dissimilar to that which is according to all things eternal. But all progressions subsist through similars. There is, therefore, some medium between these. Hence either that is the medium which is eternal in essence, but temporal in energy; or the contrary. But this is impossible: for energy on this latter hypothesis would be more excellent than essence. It remains, therefore, that the former hypothesis must be the medium.

PROPOSITION CVII.

Every thing which is in a certain respect eternal, but in a certain respect temporal, is at the same time *being* and *generation*.

FOR every thing eternal, is *being*, and that which is measured by time is *generation*. And hence, if the same thing participates both of time and eternity, yet not according to the same, or after the same manner; this same thing will be, both *being* and *generation*, yet will not be both according to one of these alone*.

COROLLARY.

From hence it is evident that *generation*, since it has a temporal energy, depends on that which partly participates of *being*, and partly of *generation*; and which at once participates of eternity and time. But this is related to that which is eternal according to all things. But that which is eternal according to all things is related to eternity itself: and eternity itself is related to *being*, which is prior to eternity.

* That is neither according to time alone, nor eternity alone: but from the participation of both.

PROPOSITION CVIII.

Every thing which is particular in each order, is capable of participating in a twofold manner, that unity which is placed in a proximate superior disposition; either by its own proper totality, or through that which it contains, of a partial nature, and which is allied to something particular, according to an analogy to the whole series.

FOR if all things are converted through similitude, the particular nature which subsists in an inferior order, is dissimilar to that which in a superior order is monadic, and total; and is as that which is particular to that which is universal, and as different orders are to each other. But this particular nature is similar to a *whole* of the same series, on account of a communion of peculiarity; and to that superior proximately co-ordinated property, through an analogous subsistence. It is, therefore, evident that through these mediums a conversion from one to the other is effected, as through similars, to that which is similar*. For *particular*, is similar to that which is *particular*, but that which is of the same series is peculiar. And the universal, or whole which is placed above the series, is dissimilar according to each of these.

PROPOSITION CIX.

Every particular intellect participates of that unity, which is above intellect, and is the first; both through that which is *universal*, and through a *particular* unity, co-ordinated to its nature. And every particular soul, participates of universal intellect; both through *universal* soul, and a *particular* intellect. And every particular nature of body, participates of universal soul, both through *universal* nature, and a *particular* soul.

FOR every thing particular (by the preceding proposition) participates of that unity placed in an order above it; either by its own proper universality; or by that particular nature which it contains, and which is co-ordinated to something particular.

* Instead of *ὡς δὲ τῶν ὁμοίων ἀντίστοιχον*, read *ὡς δὲ τῶν ὁμοίων ὡς ἴσους*. And read with astonishment the version of Porus; who not perceiving the error of the text, has made nonsense of the passage, as usual.

PROPOSITION CX.

Of all things placed in order, according to every series, such as are first, and are conjoined with their unity, may participate of those which are proximately established in a superior order, through analogy. But such as are more imperfect, and remote from their proper principle, are not naturally adapted to participate of their superiors.

FOR because some things are allied to their superiors being allotted in their proper order, a more excellent and divine nature; but others are more distant, because they are allotted a secondary and ministerial, but not a primary and principal progression in every series: hence some things are naturally conjoined with those of a superior order; but others are not conjoined with a superior order. For all things are not of equal dignity, though they belong to the same distribution. For there is not one reason, of all things: but all things proceed from one, and return to one, from their own proper unity. And hence they are not allotted the same power. But some are able to receive continually the participations of their superiors. But others of a dissimilar nature, are deprived of such a power, through their far distant progressions from their principles.

PROPOSITION CXI.

Of every intellectual series, some are divine intellects receiving the participations of the gods; but others are intellects alone. And of every animastic series (i. e. a series composed of souls) some are intellectual souls, depending on their proper intellects; but others are souls alone. And of every corporeal nature, some have supernally-presiding souls, but others are natures alone, destitute of the presence of souls.

FOR in every series the whole genus is not naturally adapted to depend on that which is prior to itself; but this belongs to that more perfect nature which the genus contains, and which is sufficient to coalesce with superior natures. Hence every intellect is not connected with a god; but this belongs to the highest and most uniform intellects,

lects, (i. e. to intellects which participate most of unity). For these are allied to the divine unities. Nor do all souls participate of participable intellect; but this belongs to such as are most intellectual. Nor do all corporeal natures enjoy the presence of soul, and of that soul which is participated; but such only as are more perfect and rational. And the mode of demonstration is the same in all.

PROPOSITION CXII.

First natures in every order, possess the form of things prior to themselves.

FOR the highest genera in every order, are conjoined with their superiors by similitude, and through a continuation of the progression of universals. Hence such as superior natures are primarily, such is the form which things first in every order are allotted, and which is allied to the nature of superiors. And through the peculiarity of their subsistence, they appear such as natures prior to themselves.

PROPOSITION CXIII.

Every divine number is *unical* (*ἐνίας*), i. e. possesses the form of unity.

FOR if a divine number has the one itself, as its preceding cause, in the same manner as an intellectual number has intellect, and an animatic number (*ψυχικός*, or number possessing the form of soul) soul as its preceding cause, and if multitude is every where analogous to its cause; it is evident that a divine number also, is uniform. Since *the one itself, is the deity*: and this because *the good itself* is the same with *the one*. For the *good itself*, and *the deity* are the same: since that above which there is nothing, and which all things desire, is *the deity*. And that from which all things proceed, and to which all things tend, is *the good*. If, therefore, there is a multitude of gods, it is an uniform multitude. But that there is a multitude is evident: since every principal cause is the leader of a proper multitude*; and to this multitude it is similar and allied.

PROPO-

* To such as understand these Elements, this argument for the existence of a multitude of gods, is perfectly demonstrative and clear. Indeed as every production of nature possesses the power of generating its similar, it is much more necessary that the first cause of all should generate a multitude the most similar to himself, that can possibly be conceived. For every being produces that which is similar prior to the dissimilar; as indeed a contrary mode of proceeding would be absurd and impossible. The immediate or first productions therefore of the first god, must be a multitude of gods: or otherwise his first progeny would not be perfectly similar to himself. Nor does this doctrine, in any respect derogate from the dignity of the supreme god, as the ignorant suppose.

PROPOSITION CXIV.

Every god is a self-perfect unity: and every self-perfect unity is a god.

FOR if there is a two-fold number of unities, as we have previously demonstrated, and some of these are self-perfect, but others illuminations emanating from the self-perfect unities; and if a divine number is allied, and of a similar nature to the good; hence the gods are self-perfect unities. And on the contrary every self-perfect unity is a god. For as unity is most excellently allied to the one itself, and that which is self-perfect to the good, and through both the one, and the good, participates of a divine property; so likewise that which is self-perfect is a god.

COROLLARY.

But if a god was a unity, yet not a self-perfect unity; or a self-perfect hypostasis, yet not a unity, he would be placed in another order, on account of a mutation of his property.

PROPOSITION CXV.

Every god is super-essential, supervital, and super-intellectual.

FOR if every god is a self-perfect unity, but each of these (viz. essence, life, and intellect) is not a unity, but united; it is evident that every god, is above essence,

and life; but on the contrary tends to exalt his majesty, and evince the ineffable beneficence and perfection of his nature. For though it establishes a multitude of gods, yet it teaches that they are dependant on the first, who is perfectly incomprehensible, and without participation. So that it leads us to consider the subordinate deities, as so many lesser luminaries shining before the presence of the sun of good, and encircling with awful grandeur his ineffable radiance, and occult retreats. And that this doctrine fully displays his superlative goodness, is sufficiently manifest; since by a contrary assertion we must ascribe imperfection to the fountain of excellence, and leave deity impotent and barren. Indeed this opinion is so natural and reasonable, that, excepting the Jews, it was embraced by every nation of the ancient world. Nor ought we to wonder that the Jews were an exception to the universal consent of mankind, in this important particular. For with respect to the origin of this despicable, though chosen people, it was scarcely known to the Heathens; "the greater part of whom," as Dr. Burnet justly observes (*De Origin. Rer. cap. 7.*) "supposed them to be natives of Egypt, sprung from the same root, or considered them as a vile, and inconsiderable people." And as to their learning we may remark with the same author, "that they never excelled in philosophical, or mathematical knowledge; and never gave the world a famous example of the strength of human wit; from whence arose that bitter reproach of Apollonius, *That the Jews were the most trifling of all the barbarians, and that they were the only people who had never found out any thing useful for life.*" The example of the Jews, therefore, ought to be so far from deciding against Polytheism, that when their character is impartially estimated, it will strengthen the evidence of its reasonableness and truth.

life, and intellect. For if these differ from each other, but all are in all, every one of these being *all things* will not be *one* alone. Besides, if the first deity is super-essential, but every god, so far as a god is of the first series *; hence every god will be super-essential. But that the first deity is super-essential is evident: for *essence* is not the same with *unity*; nor is *to be*, and *to be united* one and the same. But if *essence*, is not the same with *unity*, that which is first will either be both of these, and so will not be *one* alone, but something besides *one*, and will participate of *the one*, without being *the one itself*; or it will be either of these. But if indeed it is essence, it will be indigent of the one. But it is impossible that *the good*, and *the first* should be indigent. It will, therefore, be *the one* alone; and will consequently be super-essential. But if every thing subsisting in a primary manner, confers the property of its primary subsistence on the whole series; hence every divine number is super-essential. For every principal cause produces similars prior to dissimilars. If, therefore, the first god is super-essential, all the gods, will be super-essential: for by this means they will be perfectly similar. But if they were essences they would be produced from the first essence, as the unities of essences.

PROPOSITION CXVI.

Every deity, except *the one*, is participable.

FOR that *the one* is imparticipable, is evident; since if he participated any thing, and thus became dependant on some other nature, he would no longer be the cause of all things; both of such as are prior to beings, and of beings themselves. But that other

* Though the first cause or *the one itself*, confers on every thing a proper symbol of his ineffable nature; yet this occult unity, or impression is not divine in things subject to generation and decay, but in true essences alone, in the number of which rational souls must be ranked. Such of these, however, as are of a partial nature, and on this account are not the immediate progeny of *the first one*, do not contain a unity which can be called a god; because they are connected with motion, and are in a certain respect composite essences. But where there is a most true essence, as in separate intellects, and celestial souls, the unity of each is a god. And indeed on account of these unities, which are as it were expressive characters of the first unity, the essences of the gods contain all things, and extend their providential care to every part of the universe, with unbounded beneficence, and immaculate power. But these divine unities are perpetually united to the first one, like rays to light, and lines to a centre. They likewise subsist in the most perfect union with each other. For since union in other natures is effected through the power of unity, these divine unities must be much more closely united, through their subsisting much nearer to the first and most perfect one. Every divine unity, therefore, though it is neither essence, nor obnoxious to essential multitude, yet abides in essence; or is rather the summit, and as it were blossom of essence. And as every thing is established in its proper species through form, and as we derive our being through soul; so every god is a deity, from the secret unity which he contains. Hence these divine unities subsist in the intelligible world, and in the essences of the gods, like so many splendid lamps in diaphanous spheres, mingling their rays with an ineffable union, energy, and consent. And situated in most admirable order, in the vestibule of the good, they occultly signify divine silence, and solitary beauty; and perspicuously announce to posterior natures the awful sanctuary of their incomprehensible cause.

unities.

unities are participants we shall now demonstrate as follows: For if there is another im-participable unity after the first, in what does it differ from *the one*? For it either sub-sists in the same manner as that: but how in this case, is the one second, and the other first? Or it does not subsist in the same manner. And so *that* will be the one itself, but *this* will be both *one*, and *non-one*. But this non-one, if it is no hypostasis (or subsistence) will be one alone. But if it is some other hypostasis besides the one, *the one* will be par-ticipated by non-one: and that will be a self-perfect one, by which it is conjoined. Hence this again, will be the deity. But that which subsists as non-one, will subsist in the participation of the one. Every unity, therefore, which subsists after *the one* is par-ticipable, and every god is participable.

PROPOSITION CXVII.

Every god is the measure of beings.

FOR if every god possesses the form of one (*ἑνότης*), he defines and measures all the multitudes of beings. For since all multitudes, are naturally indefinite, they are bounded by *the one*. But that which is one, measuring and bounding whatever it super-venes, is willing to lead into bound, by its terminating power, whatever is indefi-nite. For that which is one becomes uniform through participation: but that which is indefinite recedes from the one, through its interminable and infinite nature. And by how much the less it is uniform, by so much the more is it indefinite and immense. And hence every multitude of beings, is measured by the divine unities.

PROPOSITION CXVIII.

Every thing which is in the gods, according to their idioms (or pro-perties), pre-exists in their natures. And the property of the gods, is uniform and super-essential. And hence all things are contained in the gods, uniformly, and super-essentially.

FOR if every thing subsists in a three-fold manner, either through cause, or through hyparxis, or through participation, but the first of all numbers is the divine num-ber; hence nothing will be inherent in the gods according to participation. But al- things will reside in them, either through hyparxis, or through cause. But likewise, whatever the gods, as the authors of all things previously receive, they previously re-

ceive in a manner convenient, and apposite to their union. For every thing which presides over secondary natures according to cause, naturally contains the cause of inferiors. All things, therefore, are in the gods uniformly, and super-essentially.

PROPOSITION CXIX.

Every god subsists according to a super-essential goodness, and is good neither through habit, nor through essence.

FOR both habit and essence are allotted an order secondary and remote from the gods: but these have a super-essential subsistence. For if the first one, is also the good, and so far as the one is the good itself, and so far as the good the one itself; hence every series of gods, is both uniform, and beneficent (*ἀγαθοὺς*), on account of one property alone, and not through more than one. But every god, so far as a unity is also a goodness, and so far as a goodness is also a unity; and on account of progression from the first is also beneficent and uniform. For the first cause of all, is both the one itself, and the good; and consequently all the gods are unities and goodnesses. As therefore *the one* of the gods is super-essential, so likewise *the good*, which they contain, is super-essential, and is nothing else than *one*. For every god is not first of all something different from good, and afterwards *good*; but is good alone. Nor is first of all something besides *one*, and afterwards *one*; but is *one* alone.

CONCERNING PROVIDENCE.

PROPOSITION CXX.

Every god contains in his hyparxis a providence of the universe; and primary providence resides in the gods.

FOR all things posterior to the gods, provide through the communion of the gods: but providence is connate with the gods. For if to communicate good to things provided for, is the peculiar employment of a providential property, but all the gods are goodnesses; hence they will either communicate themselves to nothing, and so there will be no good in secondary natures (for whence can that which subsists by participation emanate, but from natures which are primarily endued with properties); or if they communicate, they will communicate good, and through this communication provide for the universe. Providence, therefore, primarily subsists in the gods. For where
can

can an energy prior to intellect abide, but in super-essential natures? And hence providence as the name indicates, is an energy prior to intellect. The gods, therefore, on account of their being, and because they are goodnesses, provide for all things*; and fill all things with that goodness which is prior to intellect.

PROPOSITION CXXI.

Every thing divine has for its hyparxis goodness itself, and possesses an uniform power, and a knowledge occult, and incomprehensible by all secondary natures.

FOR if it provides for the universe, it contains a power comprehensive of the things for which it provides; and by this invincible and indiscrivable power, it fills all things with itself, and subjects every thing to its own nature. For every principal and ruling cause, rules through its abundance of power, and contains according to nature. There is, therefore, a primary power in the gods, which does not govern some things, and not others, but it equally assumes in itself in a primary manner, the powers of all beings: and this is neither an essential power, nor much more unessential, but it is con-nate to the hyparxis of the gods, and is super-essential. But likewise the boundaries of all cognitions, pre-exist uniformly in the gods. For all other cognitions subsist, on ac-

* We may farther infer the necessity of providence in the gods, from considering that as they are the producing causes of all things, so all things abide, and are radically established in their natures. For where can any thing subsist, which is not contained in their unknown and all-pervading comprehensions? But if this be the case, since all things are in reality the offspring of the gods, they must continually be the objects of their providential exertions. For as goodness is the characteristic of these divine natures, it is impossible that they should abandon their progeny, or cease to impart their beneficent, unenvying, and all-powerful communications. Nor must we think that these providential exertions are laborious to the gods, since, as Proclus well observes, (Theol. Plat. p. 41.) that which is according to nature, is not laborious to any thing. "For neither (says he) is it laborious for fire to give warmth, nor for snow to refrigerate, nor for bodies themselves to energize according to their peculiar powers. Nor prior to bodies, is it laborious to natures themselves to nourish, or generate, or increase: for these are the operations of natures. Nor again, prior to these, is it laborious to souls to exert their peculiar energies: for many of their energies are attended with delight, many are the result of their essence; and many motions are produced by their presence alone." Hence if the communication of good naturally belongs to the gods, providence also is natural to these divinities, which they exert in a tranquil, unpolled, and incorporeal manner.

Should it be enquired in what manner providence operates, the following beautiful passage from Proclus on the Parmenides, as cited by Ficinus, in his commentary on that dialogue, will give us abundant satisfaction: "Let us conceive (says he) a ship agitated by the winds and waves, and let us suppose, that the imagination of some one is so powerful, that while he imagines the sea, the sea immediately flows; that while he imagines the ship, the ship is constructed; and that the winds and waves, arise agreeable to his imagination, and as the consequences of its vehement energy. Now it is evident, that such a one would not be compelled, in surveying these particulars, to employ a confused and distracted vision; but both his knowledge and operation, would equally subsist in a uniform manner. And such is the simplicity of divine intelligence, with respect to the intuition and fabrication of inferior concerns."

count

count of divine cognition, which is abstracted from the universality of things. And this cognition is neither intellectual, nor much less does it belong to the cognitions posterior to intellect: but according to its divine property, it is constituted above intellect. If then this knowledge is divine, it is an occult and uniform cognition. But if the power is divine, it is uncircumscribed by all things, and, in a similar manner, comprehensive of all things. But if the goodness is divine, it gives bound to the hyparxis of the gods. For if all things are contained in the gods, and among these knowledge, power, and goodness; and if their hyparxis is characterized with that which is best, the subsistence also of the gods will take place according to the best: and this is no other than goodness.

P R O P O S I T I O N CXXII.

Every thing divine both provides for secondary natures, and is separated from the things for which it provides; providence neither remitting its unmixed and uniform excellence, nor a separate union obscuring providence.

FOR the gods abiding in their uniform nature, and hyparxis, fill all things with their power. And every thing which is able to participate, enjoys the goods, which it is capable of receiving according to the measure of its proper subsistence; the gods in the mean time, through being itself, or rather through a nature prior to being, pouring their illuminations on every thing which exists. For since they are no other than goodnesses, they abundantly confer good upon all things, through being itself; not making a distribution according to a reasoning energy, but because these receive according to their dignity, and those confer according to their hyparxis. Hence, in their providential operations, they receive no impediment from the natures for which they provide: for they benefit all things through their very being itself. But every thing which operates essentially, operates without habitude or respect: for respect, is an addition to being itself: and is on this account contrary to nature. Nor again, because they are separate, do they take away their providential care; for thus they would remove (which it is unlawful to say) their peculiar hyparxis whose property is goodness. For the communication of good extends to every thing capable of its participation: and that which is greatest, is not that which is endued with a form of good, but that which is beneficent. This beneficent nature, therefore, either no being will possess, or the gods will possess it prior to beings. For to goods subsisting through communication, it is impossible that a greater good should be present, but a less good only, to such goods as are first.

PROPO-

PROPOSITION CXXIII.

Every thing divine, on account of its super-essential union, is ineffable and unknown to all secondary natures ; but it is comprehensible, and knowable by its participants. And hence *that which is first*, is alone entirely unknown, because it is imparticipable.

FOR all knowledge subsisting through reason, belongs to *beings*, and in *beings* possesses the apprehension of its truth : for it is conversant with *conceptions*, and subsists in intellects. But the gods are above all beings. Hence that which is divine, is neither to be apprehended by opinion, nor by a rational energy, nor by intellect. For every being, is either sensible, and on that account the object of opinion, or true being, and on that account intelligible. Or it subsists between these, and is at the same time *being*, and *generable*, and is on this account the subject of a rational energy. If, therefore, the gods are super-essential *, and prior to beings, there can neither be any opinion of their natures, nor science, nor cogitation, nor intellect. But they are known by dependant natures in a manner correspondent to their properties : and this by a necessary consequence. For the diversities of participants are divided together with the properties of the things participated. Nor does every thing participate every thing : for neither is there a composition of things perfectly dissimilar, nor does any thing participate fortuitously of another : but a kindred nature is conjoined with every thing kindred, and derives its progression from that to which it is allied.

PROPOSITION CXXIV.

Every god knows partible natures, in an impartible manner, things subsisting in time without time, things not necessary, necessarily, things mutable, immutably ; and universally, all things, in a manner more excellent than the order of the things known.

FOR if every thing which is present with the gods is present, according to their *characteristic* ; it is evident that the knowledge of the gods will not subsist according to

* The reader must remember that the gods are alone super-essential, through their *unities*, which are the characteristics of their natures : for as irrationality is the essential signature of a brute, and rationality of a man ; so a divine unity, is the invariable characteristic of a god.

the nature of things inferior, but according to the singular excellence which the gods contain. Their knowledge, therefore, of multiplied, and passive natures, will be uniform and without passion. Likewise if that which is the object of cognition, is partible, divine knowledge will be impartible. If the subjects are mutable, the gnostic energy of the gods will be immutable: if contingent, divine knowledge will be necessary; and if indefinite, definite. For that which is divine does not receive knowledge into itself from subordinate natures, that so cognition may correspond to the object of knowledge; but inferiors receive their indefinite subsistence, about the terminated nature of the gods, are changed about their immutability, receive with passivity that which is impassive, and temporally, that which subsists without time. For it is possible that subordinate, may be surpassed by more excellent natures: but it is not lawful for the gods to receive in themselves any thing from natures inferior to their own.

PROPOSITION CXXV.

Every god proceeds through all secondary natures, in the order from which he begins to indicate himself. Always indeed multiplying and dividing his communications, yet preserving the characteristic of his own proper subsistence.

FOR since progressions are produced through remission, things first, every where multiply into the decrements of secondary natures. But proceeding according to a similitude to their producing causes, they receive the same ordination; so that the whole, is in a certain respect the same and different, and that which proceeds, with that which abides. For on account of its remission, it appears different, but on account of its coherence with the whole, it does not depart from identity. But such as *that* is among first natures, such is the subsistence of *this* among things secondary, and such is its preservation of the indissoluble communion of the series. Every god, therefore, appears in a manner adapted to the orders in which he exhibits his presence: but he proceeds from thence even to the last of things, through the generative power of primary natures. But he always multiplies the progression from one into multitude: but preserves identity, in the progression, on account of the similitude of the progressions to the governing and first operative cause of every series.

PROP-

PROPOSITION CXXVI.

Of every deity, he is the more universal, who is nearer to the one:
but he is more particular, who is more distant.

FOR he who is the cause of more effects, is nearer to the cause of all, but he who produces fewer effects, is more distant. And he who is the author of many is more universal, but he who produces fewer effects, is more particular. And each of these is a unity. But the one is greater, and the other less according to power. And the more particular goods are generated from such as are more universal, without the latter receiving any division, (for they are unities) or alteration (for they are immovable) or being multiplied according to habitude (for they are unmixt). But they generate from themselves through an abundance of power, secondary progressions, diminished from such as are first.

PROPOSITION CXXVII.

Every thing divine is primarily, and especially simple, and through
this is most sufficient.

FOR that it is simple, is evident from its unity: for the whole is eminently uniform. But a nature of this kind, is most eminently simple. But that it is likewise most sufficient, may be learnt by any one who considers, that a composite, is indigent, though not of things external to its nature, yet of those from which it is composed. But that which is most simple, and uniform, and one, is the same with *the good*, in which good establishing itself, it becomes most sufficient. But every thing divine, is of this kind. And hence it is neither indigent of externals, because it is goodness itself, nor of things requisite to composition, because it is uniform.

PROPOSITION CXXVIII.

Every god, who is participated by natures nearer to his own, is *immediately* participated: but when he is participated by far distant natures, this is effected through *mediums* more or less numerous.

FOR the former, since they are by their alliance uniform, are on this account enabled to participate the divine unities. But such as through their diminution, and

extension into multitude become far distant, are indigent of other things more united, that they may participate such as are no longer united, but are essential unities. For multitude united, subsists between essential unity, and divided multitude. And thus united multitude is able to coalesce with unity, through union; but is at the same time allied to divided multitude, through the manifest appearance of multitude.

PROPOSITION CXXIX.

Every divine body is divine, through a divine soul. But every soul, is divine, through a divine intellect. And every intellect is divine through the participation of a divine unity. And unity indeed, is a god from itself (*αὐτόθεν θεός*) but intellect, is most divine: and soul is divine, but body deiform, or endued with a divine form.

FOR if every number of gods is above intellect, but participations are effected through kindred and similar natures, an impartible essence will first of all participate the super-essential unities. But in the second place things conjoined with generation. And in the third place, generation itself. And each particular will participate through its proximate superior; the peculiarity of the gods proceeding even to the extremities of things in participants, through mediums allied to their natures. For unity confers on the first intellect, its own illustrious power among divine concerns, and causes this intellect to be like itself, according to an uniform multitude. But through intellect it is present also to soul, adapting and inflaming its conjunction with intellect, when this intellect is participable. And by the resounding echo* as it were of soul, it imparts its idiom or peculiarity to body, if it is a body participating in any respect of soul. And thus body becomes not only animated, and intellectual, but also divine. For it receives life and motion from soul, but indissoluble permanency from intellect, and divine union from participated unity. For each of these communicates its subsistence to subsequent natures.

* By this *ἀντήχουσα*, or *resounding echo of soul*, we must understand that vital quality, by which the soul is united to the body; and which is nothing more than the extreme image and shadow of the soul. The necessity of such a connecting quality, will easily appear, from considering that an *incorporeal* nature, like that of soul, cannot be connected with *body*, without a vital medium. In consequence of this we may consider with Plotinus, (*Ennead. ix. lib. 4.*) the animated body as resembling illuminated and heated air: and the pains and pleasures of the body, will be conversant with this shadow of the soul.

PROPOSITION CXXX.

In every divine order, things first, are more exempt from the natures proximately placed under them, than these last are from things subsequent: and secondary natures are more dependant on their proximate superiors, than following natures are dependant on these.

FOR by how much the more uniform, and universal any thing is, by so much the more is it allotted an excellence: greater than subsequent natures: and by how much the more it is diminished according to power, by so much the more is its alliance encreased with things posterior to its nature. And sublimer natures are indeed more united with their more principal causes: but inferiors are less united. For it is the property of a greater power to be more exempt from its inferiors, and to be more united with more excellent natures. And on the contrary to recede more, and to be passive together with these, implies a diminution of power. And this indeed happens to secondary natures in every order, but not to such as are first.

PROPOSITION CXXXI.

Every god begins his own proper energy from himself.

FOR he first exhibits in himself the peculiarity of his presence in secondary natures, because he likewise communicates himself to others, according to his own exuberant plenitude. For neither is defect, nor plenitude alone, peculiar to the gods: since every thing deficient is imperfect; and it is impossible that the imperfect, can cause any thing to be perfect. But that which is full, is alone sufficient, and is not yet prepared for communication. It is requisite, therefore, that the nature which fills, and extends its beneficence to others, should be above measure full. Hence, if that which is divine, fills all things through itself, with the goods which it contains in itself, every thing divine is beyond measure full. And if this be the case, it will primarily possess in itself, the property which it confers on others. For thus it will extend to others the communications of over-flowing goodness.

PROPOSITION CXXXII.

All the orders of the gods, are bound in union, by a medium.

FOR all the progressions of beings, are effected through similars; and much more is it necessary that the orders of the gods, should possess an indissoluble continuity, because they subsist uniformly, and are terminated according to one principal cause of their subsistence. Their remissions, therefore, take place in an united manner, and through that similitude alone which is found among beings, of things secondary to such as are first: and this because the subsistence of the gods, much more consists in union, than the subsistence of beings. All the divine genera, therefore, are bound together by proper mediums; so that first natures do not immediately proceed into progressions entirely different, but through genera common to each, and of which they are the immediate causes. For these genera combine the extremes into one union, being subjected to some, through an alliance of nature, but proximately separated from others: and they preserve the well-ordered progeny of divine causes.

PROPOSITION CXXXIII.

Every god is a beneficent unity, or a goodness unific (*ἑνωποιός*); and each possesses this hyparxis, so far as a god. But the first god is simply good, and simply one. And every god posterior to the first, is a certain goodness, and a certain unity.

FOR a divine property or idiom distinguishes the unities and goodnesses of the gods: so that every god confers goodness on all things, according to a certain characteristic of goodness; such as that of perfecting, or containing, or defending. For each of these is a certain good, but not every good. But that which is first primarily establishes a uniform cause. And this is no other than the good, constitutive as it were of all goodness. For all the hyparxes of the gods are not together equal to the one: so great is the super-eminence of the first, with respect to the multitude of the gods.

PROPOSITION CXXXIV.

Every divine intellect, understands as intellect, but provides as a god.

FOR to possess a knowledge of beings, and a perfection in intellectual conceptions, is the property of intellect. But it is the province of a god to exercise a providential care,

care, and to fill all things with good. But this communication, and replenishing, subsists through a union of the things replenished, with natures prior to their own. And intellect imitating this, becomes in its intellects the same with intelligibles. So far, therefore, as a divine intellect provides, it is a god; because providence is an energy prior to intellect. Hence, as a god, it communicates itself to all things; but as intellect, it is not present to all things. For a divine unity, extends beyond the progressions of an intellectual property. And this will be evident by considering, that natures void of intelligence, desire to provide, and to participate something of good: and this because all things do not desire intellect, even among such as are capable of its participation; but all things desire good, and hasten to acquire its possession.

PROPOSITION CXXXV.

Every divine unity is immediately participated by some being; and every thing which is deified, is extended to one divine unity; and the number of the participating genera of beings is the same as that of the participated unities.

FOR neither two, or more unities are participated by one being*. For how is it possible, that when the properties, which the unities contain, are changed, that which is connate to each, can remain without alteration; since conjunction subsists through similitude? Nor is one unity participated in a divisible manner by many beings: for many beings are unconjoined with unity; both considered as beings, with respect to that which is prior to beings, and as multitude to unity. But it is requisite that the participant, should be partly similar to that which it participates, and partly different and dissimilar. Since, therefore, that which participates, is something belonging to beings, but unity is super-essential, and the two are on this account dissimilar; it is requisite that *that* which participates should be one, that by this means it may become similar to the participated one; though the latter is one, because it is a unity, but the former is one, because it is passive to the communications of one, and is united through its participation.

* This must be understood of immediate participation; and on this hypothesis, it is certainly true, that neither two or more unities are participated by one being. For since there is an order among the unities, and some are more universal than others, two cannot be immediately participated by one being, without an alteration taking place in the subsistence of each. This is evident from the cxxxi. Proposition, in which it is proved that all the orders of the gods are bound in union by a medium: and consequently since all the unities are connected by proper mediums, it is impossible that any two can be immediately participated.

PROPO-

PROPOSITION CXXXVI.

Every god having a more universal subsistence, and being placed nearer to *the first*, is participated by a more universal genus of beings. But every god who is more particular and remote, is participated by a more particular genus of beings. And as being is to being, so is unity to divine unity.

FOR if the number of unities, is the same with that of beings, and on the other hand one unity is participated by one being; it is evident that the order of beings proceeds according to the order of unities, assimilated to an order prior to that of beings. And more universal beings coalesce with more universal unities, but more particular beings, with more particular unities. For if this be not the case, dissimilars will again be joined with dissimilars, and distribution will not subsist according to dignity of nature: but both these cases are impossible; since the one itself, and a proper measure, through the divine unities illuminates and supervenes all other natures. Much more, therefore, will there be an order of participation in the divine unities; similars depending on similars according to the power which they contain.

PROPOSITION CXXXVII.

Every unity, together with *the one* constitutes being participating of its nature.

FOR *the one*, as it is hypostatic, (*ὁμοστατικὸν*) or constitutive of all things, so likewise it is the cause of participated unities, and of beings depending on unities. But the unity belonging to every being, produces the property, which shines forth to view in that particular being. And *the one*, indeed, is the cause of *simple being*; but *unity* is the cause of alliance, because it is connate to *the one*. Hence unity, is that which of itself defines the being, which is its participant, and *essentially* exhibits in it a *super-essential* characteristic. For universally, from that which is primary, that which is secondary obtains its subsistence. If, therefore, there is any super-essential property of deity, it must belong to being, which participates it essentially.

PROPO-

PROPOSITION CXXXVIII.

Of all things which participate of a divine property, and which are deified, the first and highest is *being itself*.

FOR if being is above intellect and life, as we have demonstrated, and is the most abundant cause after the one; hence *being* will be the highest after *the one*. For it is more uniform than intellect and life, and is on this account more venerable. But there is no other prior to this, except *the one*: for what besides *the one*, can be prior to uniform multitude? But *being itself* is uniform multitude, because it consists from bound and infinite. And universally, super-essential being* is prior to essence. For in the illuminations which are imparted to secondary natures, *the one* alone extends beyond *being*. But *being* subsists immediately after *the one*. For that which is *being* in capacity, and is not as yet *being* in energy, is nevertheless according to its nature one. And the being, which subsists after *the one*, is being in energy. Among the principles of being, therefore, *non-being*† subsists immediately above being, as something more excellent, and no other than the *one itself*.

PROPOSITION CXXXIX.

All the participants of the divine unities originate from *being*, and end in a corporeal nature.

FOR being is the first of participants, but body the last: for we say that there are divine bodies. For the highest of all genera are attributed to the gods, whether they are bodies, souls, or intellects; as in every order, things analogous to the gods, contain and preserve secondary natures, and every number is a whole, containing all things in itself according to that whole which is contained in a part, and possessing before all things a divine characteristic. The divine genus, therefore, subsists both *corporeally*, and *animistically* (or according to the nature of soul *ψυχικῶς*) and *intellectually*: and it is evident that all these are divine through participation. For that which is primarily divine subsists in the unities. The participants, therefore, of the divine unities, originate from being, but end in a corporeal nature.

* For as being itself, is no other than the highest order of the gods and the most uniform multitude, and as the characteristic of every god is a divine unity; hence the characteristic of being itself, will be the unity proceeding from bound. But as all the divine unities are super-essential; hence *being itself* according to its characteristic will be super-essential.

† For as matter is deservedly called *non-being*, because it is *worse* than all things; in like manner this appellation is proper to the first cause, as he is *better* than all things.

PROPOSITION CXL.

All the powers of divine natures, having a supernal origin, and proceeding through proper mediums, extend to the extremity of things, and to places situated about the earth.

FOR nothing intercepts these powers, and restrains their universal presence; because they are in no respect indigent of places and intervals, on account of their invincible excellence in all things, and a presence every where pure and unmixed. Nor is that which is adapted to the participation of these powers, prohibited from participation: but as soon as any thing is prepared for their communications, they are immediately present, neither then approaching, nor being prior to this absent, but always possessing themselves in the same uniform manner. If, therefore, any terrene nature is adapted to the participation of these divine powers, they are present to this; and fill all things with themselves. And indeed they are more present to superior natures, but they are present to such as are middle according to the order of these, and to last natures, in an ultimate respect. They supernally, therefore, extend themselves to the extremities of things: and on this account last natures contain the images of such as are first; and *all things sympathize with all* *. For secondary pre-exist in first natures; and first natures manifestly appear in such as are second. For every thing subsists in a three-fold manner; either through *cause*, or through *hyparkis*, or through *participation*.

* He who understands this divine sentence, that *all things sympathize with all*, will see that the *wisdom* cultivated by the ancient philosophers, is founded in a theory no less sublime than rational and true. Such a one will contemplate the universe as one great animal, all whose parts are in union and consent with each other; so that nothing is foreign and detached; nothing strictly speaking void of sympathy and life. For though various parts of the world, when considered as separated from the whole, are destitute of *peculiar* life; yet they possess some degree of animation however inconsiderable, when considered with relation to the universe. Life indeed may be compared to a perpetual and universal sound; and the soul of the world resembles a lyre, or some other musical instrument, from which we may suppose this sound to be emitted. But from the unbounded diffusion as it were of the mundane soul, every thing participates of this harmonical sound, in greater or less perfection, according to the dignity of its nature. So that while life every where resounds, the most abject of beings may be said to retain a faint echo, of the melody produced from the mundane lyre. It was doubtless from profoundly considering this sympathy between the mundane soul, and the parts of the world, that the ancient philosophers were enabled to procure the presence of divinity, and perform effects, beyond the comprehension of the *vulgar*. And that this was the opinion of Plotinus, the following passage evinces: "It appears to me that the ancient wise men, who wished to procure the presence of the gods, by fabricating statues and performing sacred rites, directed their intellectual eye to the nature of the universe, and perceived that the nature of soul was every where easy to be attracted, when a proper subject was at hand, easily passive to its influence. But every thing adapted to imitation, is readily passive; and is like a mirror able to seize a certain form, and reflect it to the view." Ennead iv. lib. 3.

PROPO.

PROPOSITION CXLI.

Every providence of the gods, is partly exempt from the natures for which it provides, and is partly co-ordinated with them.

FOR one kind of providence is entirely extended above the things which are illuminated, according to its subsistence, and the characteristic of its order. But another kind provides for subjects of the same co-ordination with itself; these subjects themselves imitating the providential energy of the gods, who are separated from the concerns for which they provide; and desiring to fill secondary natures with the goods, they are capable of receiving.

PROPOSITION CXLII.

The gods are present to all things after the same manner, but all things are not after the same manner present to the gods. For every thing participates of their presence according to its order and capacity. And this is accomplished by some things uniformly, and by others variously; by some things eternally, and by others according to time; and by some things incorporeally, and by others in a corporeal manner.

FOR it is necessary that the different participation of these, should either proceed from the participant, or from the thing participated. But every thing divine always possesses the same order: and with respect to all things, is without restraint, and without mixture. It remains, therefore, that mutation must subsist through the participant; and that in these that which is not perpetually the same must abide; and that these are differently present to the gods. Hence the gods are present to all things, in the same uniform manner, though all things are not equally present to them. But particulars are present according to their ability; and they enjoy the divinities, agreeable to the manner in which they are present to their illuminations. For the participation of these is according to the measure of their presence.

PROPOSITION CXLIII.

All inferior natures fail before the presence of the gods, though a participant among these may be adapted to participation. Indeed every thing foreign departs from divine light, but all things are at once illuminated by the gods.

FOR divine natures always possess a more comprehensive capacity, and are more powerful than their progressions. But the inaptitude of the participants, is the cause of the privation of divine light: for it obscures divine light by its debility*. But this obscured light, appears to receive another domination, not according to its own power, but according to the impotency of the participant, which seems to fail and die away, before the illumination of a divine form.

PROPOSITION CXLIV.

All beings, and all the distributions of beings, extend as far in their progressions as the orders of the gods.

FOR the gods produce beings together with themselves, nor is any thing able to subsist, and to receive measure, and order beyond the influence of the gods. For all things are perfected, disposed, and measured through the power of the gods. Hence the gods have a subsistence prior to the last genera of beings; who also dispose these, and impart to them life, formation, and perfection; who convert them to *the good*, and who are in like manner prior to middle, and primary natures. And all things are bound, and stably rooted in the gods, and through this derive the continuance, and preservation of their being. But when any thing apostatizes, or recedes from the gods, and becomes on this account solitary and destitute, it entirely departs into non-entity, and perishes: because perfectly deprived of those natures, by which it was contained.

* For as this divine light operates according to the debilitated nature of the subject into which it is received (and there is no other way in which it can operate), it necessarily appears to receive a dominion foreign from its own. Hence it appears both obscure and impotent, though in reality neither: for these are the imperfections of the subject which it actuates and illumines.

PROPOSITION CXLV.

The characteristic of every divine order, pervades through all secondary natures, and imparts itself to all the subordinate genera of beings.

FOR if the distributions of beings, extend as far as the orders of the gods, there must be in every genus of beings, a supernally-illuminated property of the divine powers. For every thing receives from its proximate cause, that characteristic, or property, by which it is allotted its peculiar subsistence. I say, for example, if any deity possesses a cathartic, or purgative power, there will also be a purgation in souls and in animals, in plants and in stones. And in the same manner with respect to a defensive, converting, perfective, and vivifying power. And a stone indeed participates of a purgative virtue, but in a corporeal manner only. But a plant participates it more clearly according to life. An animal possesses this form, according to the motion of appetite: but a rational soul, in a rational manner; and intellect, intellectually. But the gods possess this super-essentially, and uniformly. And the whole series is endued with this power, from one divine cause: and there is the same mode of reasoning in the rest. For all things depend on the gods. And different natures are illuminated by different gods; the divine series, descending even to the extremity of things. And some things are connected with the gods immediately, but others through more or fewer mediums; *while all things in the mean time are full of gods.* And whatever any being naturally possesses it possesses from the gods.

PROPOSITION CXLVI.

The extremities of all the divine progressions, are assimilated to their principles; preserving a circle without beginning and end, through a conversion to their principles.

FOR if every progression returns to the principle from which it proceeds, much more must total orders, proceeding from their summit, be converted to it again. But the conversion of the extreme to its principle, forms one whole, finite, and verging to itself; and exhibiting through its inclination uniformity in multitude.

PROPOSITION CXLVII.

The summits of all the divine orders, are assimilated to the extremes of their superiors.

FOR if it is requisite that there should be a coherence, and continuity in a divine progression, and that every order should be connected by proper mediums; it is necessary that the summits of secondary orders, should be conjoined with the extremes of such as are first. But conjunction subsists through similitude: and hence there will be a similitude of the principles of an inferior order, to the extremes of one superior.

PROPOSITION CXLVIII.

Every divine order is united to itself in a triple respect; by the summit which it contains; and by its middle, and end.

FOR its *summit* possessing a most united power, transmits this power into a total union, and unites every thing supernally flowing into itself. But its *middle* extending to each extreme, connects every thing about itself: transfusing the gifts of primary natures, but extending the powers of such as are last; and inserting in all things a communion and connection with each other. For by this means one co-ordination is produced from replenishing and replenished natures, mutually verging to the middle, as to a certain centre. But the *end* returning again to the beginning, and reducing to this the progressive powers, affords similitude and a mutual inclination to the whole order. And thus the whole order is one, through the unifying power of its primary parts; through the coherence subsisting in its middle; and through the conversion of the extreme, to the principle of the progressions.

PROPOSITION CXLIX.

Every multitude of divine unities, is bounded according to number.

FOR if it is proximate to the one, it is not infinite; since that which is infinite is not connate to the one, but foreign from its nature. For if multitude essentially recedes from *the one*, it is evident that infinite multitude is perfectly destitute of the one: and hence it is likewise impotent and inefficacious. The multitude of the gods, therefore, is not infinite: and consequently, it is uniform and bounded,

bounded, and more bounded than any other multitude, because it is more allied to the one. If, therefore, multitude was the principle of things, it would be requisite that every thing nearer to, should be a greater multitude than that which is more distant from the principle: for that which is nearer is more similar. But since that which is first is *the one itself*, the multitude conjoined with it must be less multitude than that which is more remote from *the one*. But infinite is not a less multitude, but multitude in the most eminent degree.

PROPOSITION CL.

Every thing progressive in the divine orders, is not naturally adapted to receive all the powers of its producing cause. Nor do secondary natures entirely receive all the powers of natures prior to themselves: but these possess some powers abstracted from inferiors; and incomprehensible by things posterior to themselves.

FOR if there is a difference in the characteristics of the gods, those of the inferior must pre-exist in the superior gods: but the characteristics of the superior, as being more universal, do not reside in the inferior divinities. But the more excellent characteristics impart some powers to their productions, but eminently pre-occupy others in themselves. For it has been demonstrated that those are more universal, which are nearer to the one, but more particular, which are more distant. But if the more universal possess powers comprehensive of the more particular characteristics; hence those which possess a secondary, and more particular order, will not contain the power of such as are more universal. Hence in the superior, there is something incomprehensible, and uncircumscribed by the inferior properties. For every thing divine is truly infinite; nor does it exhibit itself to itself; nor to things of a much prior superiority to itself: but to all such as are posterior to its nature. But infinity resides in these last, according to capacity. And infinite is incomprehensible by those to whom it is infinite. Hence inferiors do not participate of all the powers, which more excellent natures pre-occupy in themselves. For the latter are incomprehensible by the former. Hence things secondary, from their more particular subsistence, will neither possess the whole of superior natures, nor will they contain the properties which they possess, in the same manner, as their superiors; on account of that infinity through which superior excel subordinate natures.

PROPO.

PROPOSITION CLI.

Every thing paternal* in the gods has a primary subsistence, and pre-exists in the order of *the good*, according to all the divine distributions.

FOR that which is paternal, produces the hyparxes of secondary natures, and universal powers, and essences, according to one ineffable excellence. And on this account it is denominated *paternal*, indicating the uniform and beneficent power of *the one*, and the hypostatical, or procreative cause of secondary natures. And in every order of the gods, that which is paternal, obtains the principality, producing and adorning all things from itself; because it is established analogous to *the good*. And with respect to these divine fathers, some are more universal, but others more particular; just as the orders of the gods differ in the proportion of cause, according to more universal, and more particular. As many therefore as are the universal progressions of the gods, so many also, are the differences of fathers. For if in every order there is something analogous to the good, it is requisite that *the paternal* should reside in all, and that each order should proceed from a paternal union.

PROPOSITION CLII.

Every thing generative in the gods proceeds according to the infinity of a divine power, multiplying itself, penetrating through all things; and eminently demonstrating a never failing energy, in the progressions of secondary natures.

FOR what else but the infinite power of the gods, through which all divine natures are filled with prolific good, can multiply progressions, and produce them into offspring from their occult comprehension in causes? For that which is universally full,

* According to the Chaldaic theology, which is the same with the Platonic, the intelligible order, subsisting immediately after *the one*, consists of three triads; the summit of each being called *father*, the middle, *power*, and the third *intellect*. This is profoundly and beautifully explained by Proclus in Theol. Plat. lib. 3. to which I refer the reader desirous of copious information, on this sublime and interesting subject. I only add that Plato in the *Timæus*, ascribes these appellations to the demiurgus of the universe: and this sufficiently proves that words of this kind are not the invention of the latter Platonists, according to the ignorant assertion of Hyde, in the preface to his book, "On the Religion of the Persians;" a work of an alluring title, but of insignificant execution.

produces

produces other things from itself, through its overflowing power. Hence a dominion of power, is the characteristic of generative deity: and this absolute dominion multiplies the powers of generated natures, causes them to be prolific, and excites them to the generation and production of others. For if every thing imparts its primary characteristic to others, every thing prolific must insert in natures posterior to itself, a prolific progression, and form a figurative representation of that infinity, which is the first progeny of the universe; from which every generative power proceeds, and which eminently scatters as from a fountain, the perennial progressions of divine natures.

PROPOSITION CLIII.

Every thing perfect in the gods, is the cause of divine perfection.

FOR as with respect to hypostases, or subsistences, some belong to beings, and others are super-essential; so likewise of perfections, some belong to the gods themselves according to hyparxis, but others to secondary beings posterior to the gods. And the former indeed are self-perfect, and first-artificers, because in these good is contained in a primary manner: but the latter possess perfection through participation. On this account, therefore, the perfection of the gods is different from the perfection of things deified. But that which is primarily perfect in the gods, is not only the cause of perfection to things deified, but to the gods themselves. For if every thing perfect is converted to its domestic principle, the cause of every divine conversion, is the perfective genus of the gods.

PROPOSITION CLIV.

Every thing in the gods endued with a protecting power, preserves every thing in its proper order; uniformly separating secondary natures, and establishing them in such as are first.

FOR if the preservation of every order, preserves measure in an immutable manner, and contains all the protected natures, in their proper perfection, divine protection will insert in all things an eminence above their inferiors, and will permanently establish in itself every thing, without mixture. It will likewise be the cause of immaculate purity, to protected natures, and will establish them in their superiors. For every thing adhering to primary natures is perfect; but at the same time it abides in itself, and is extended above inferior natures.

PROPO-

PROPOSITION CLV.

Every thing vivific in the divine genera, is a generative cause; but every prolific order is not also vivific.

FOR a generative power is more universal than that which is vivific, and is nearer to the principle of all. For generation manifests a cause producing beings into multitude: but vivifying (*ζωογονία*) represents deity the supplier of universal life. If, therefore, the former multiplies the hypostases of beings, but the latter the progressions of life; it will be as *being* is to *life*, so is the *generative* order to the *vivific* series. And hence the generative order will be more universal, and the cause of more effects, and on this account nearer to the principle of all.

PROPOSITION CLVI.

Every cause of purity, is contained in the protecting order. But the protecting is not the same with the purifying genus.

FOR purity inserts an unmixed nature in every thing inferior to the gods, and an unpolluted power, in the providence of secondary natures. But protection likewise produces this, comprehending all things in itself, and firmly establishing them in their superiors. Hence the protecting is more universal than the purgative genus. For it is simply the property of protection, to preserve the order of every thing, both with respect to itself, and to things prior and posterior to its nature. But it is the property of purity to separate things more excellent from such as are more base*: and the former of these are primarily contained in the gods. For it is requisite that there should be one antecedent cause of that which is contained in all things. And universally the uniform measures of every thing good, are first received from the gods; and there is no good in [secondary] natures, which does not pre-exist in the gods according to cause. For what other origin, or cause, can this possess? In the gods, therefore, purity is likewise a primary good, together with protection, and every thing of this kind.

* In consequence of this the cause of protection must be superior to the cause of purgation, or purity. For since protection preserves things in their proper order, but purity separates things excellent from such as are base, and the latter is preparatory to the former; hence protection must be superior in the order of causes to purgation.

PROPOSITION CLVII.

Every paternal cause supplies every thing with being, and constitutes the *hyparxes* of beings. But every demiurgic, or fabricative cause of forms, precedes composite natures, together with their order, and division according to number: and is of the same order with a paternal cause, in the more particular genera of things.

FOR each of these belongs to the order of bound, because both *hyparxis*, and *number*, and *form*, are all of them endued with the form of bound: and hence through this they are co-ordinate to one another. But that which is a *demiurgic cause*, deduces fabrication into multitude. And that which is *uniform*, supplies the progressions of beings. And the former indeed is the artificer of forms, but the latter produces essence. In whatever respect, therefore, *form* and *being* * differ from each other, in the same respect that which is *demiurgic* differs from that which is *paternal* †. But form itself, is a certain one. A paternal cause, therefore, is both more universal and causal, and is superior to the demiurgic genus; in the same manner as being itself is more universal than form.

PROPOSITION CLVIII.

Every reductorial cause (*τὸ ἀναγωγόν*) in the gods differs both from a cathartic or purifying cause, and from convertive genera.

FOR that a reductorial cause, ought to be primarily resident in the gods, is evident; as in these all the causes of universal good pre-exist. But it subsists prior to a cathartic cause; because that liberates from baser, but a reductorial cause connects with more excellent natures. It has, however, an order more particular than the convertive genus; because every thing convertive, is either converted to itself, or to a more excel-

* That *being* and *form* differ from each other is evident from the 73d and 74th proposition of these Elements, in which it is demonstrated that *being* is superior to *form*; because being is above that which is total, and that which is total is above form.

† He who understands this will see the propriety of the appellation *fabricator*, and *father*, given by Plato in the *Timæus* to the artificer of the world; and why *fabricator* is placed before *father*; concerning which consult Proclus on Plato's Theology, lib. v. cap. 16.

lent nature. But the operation of that which is reductorial, is characterized according to a conversion to that which is more excellent; because it leads that which is converted to something superior, and more divine.

PROPOSITION CLIX.

Every order of the gods consists from the first principles, *bound* and *infinity*. But one order consists more from the cause of *bound*, and another from that of *infinity*.

FOR every order indeed proceeds from both, because the communications of primary, penetrate through all secondary causes. But in some orders *bound* predominates in the mixture, and in others *infinity*. And hence that in which *bound* prevails, becomes a genus possessing the form of bound; but that in which *infinity* has the dominion, becomes a genus endued with the form of infinity.

CONCERNING INTELLECT.

PROPOSITION CLX.

Every divine intellect is uniform, and perfect; and is a primary intellect subsisting from itself, and producing other intellects.

FOR if it be a god, it is full of divine unities, and is uniform. But if this be the case it is also perfect, being full of divine goodness. And again, if this be the case, it is a primary intellect, as being united to the gods: for deified intellect is more excellent than every intellect. But since it is a primary intellect, it also confers subsistence on other intellects: for from first entities, all secondary beings obtain their hyparxis.

PROPOSITION CLXI.

Every true being depending on the gods, is a divine intelligible, and is imparticipable.

FOR since true being as we have demonstrated is that which first participates a divine unity, it also fills intellect, from itself. For intellect is being, as that which

is

is replenished with being: and consequently true being is a divine intelligible. It is divine indeed, as that which is deified; but as that which is filled with intellect, which it also participates, it is intelligible. And intellect indeed is being, through the first being. But the first being is separated from intellect, because intellect is posterior to being. And imparticipables are prior to things participated. Hence being united with intellect, pre-exists by itself, and is imparticipable. For it is intelligible, not as co-ordinated with intellect, but as eminently perfecting intellect; because it communicates being to intellect, and fills it with essence substantial and real.

PROPOSITION CLXII.

Every multitude of unities illustrating true being, is occult and intelligible. *Occult* indeed, as conjoined with the one; but *intelligible*, as participated by being.

FOR all the gods are denominated from their dependants, because the different hypostases of the gods may be known from these. For every thing divine is of itself ineffable and unknown, because connate to the ineffable one. But by the permutation of participants, it happens that the properties of the gods become known to subordinate natures. Indeed the unities which illustrate true being are intelligible; because true being is a divine intelligible, and is likewise imparticipable, as subsisting prior to intellect. For this would not depend on the first gods, unless they possessed a primary hypostasis, and a power perfective of other gods: since as participants are to each other, so likewise are the hyparxes of participated natures.

PROPOSITION CLXIII.

Every multitude of unities participated by imparticipable intellect, is intellectual.

FOR as intellect is to true being, so are these unities, to intelligible unities. So far, therefore, as they illuminate divine and imparticipable intellect, they are intellectual: but they are not so intellectual, as subsisting in intellect, but as subsisting through cause prior to, and generating intellect.

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Every true being depending on the gods, is a divine intelligible, and is imparticipable.

FOR since true being as we have demonstrated is that which first participates a divine unity, it also fills intellect, from itself. For intellect is being, as that which

is replenished with being: and consequently true being is a divine intelligible. It is divine indeed, as that which is deified; but as that which is filled with intellect, which it also participates, it is intelligible. And intellect indeed is being, through the first being. But the first being is separated from intellect, because intellect is posterior to being. And imparticipables are prior to things participated. Hence being united with intellect, pre-exists by itself, and is imparticipable. For it is intelligible, not as co-ordinated with intellect, but as eminently perfecting intellect; because it communicates being to intellect, and fills it with essence substantial and real.

PROPOSITION CLXII.

Every multitude of unities illustrating true being, is occult and intelligible. *Occult* indeed, as conjoined with the one; but *intelligible*, as participated by being.

FOR all the gods are denominated from their dependants, because the different hypostases of the gods may be known from these. For every thing divine is of itself ineffable and unknown, because connate to the ineffable one. But by the permutation of participants, it happens that the properties of the gods become known to subordinate natures. Indeed the unities which illustrate true being are intelligible; because true being is a divine intelligible, and is likewise imparticipable, as subsisting prior to intellect. For this would not depend on the first gods, unless they possessed a primary hypostasis, and a power perfective of other gods: since as participants are to each other, so likewise are the hyparxes of participated natures.

PROPOSITION CLXIII.

Every multitude of unities participated by imparticipable intellect, is intellectual.

FOR as intellect is to true being, so are these unities, to intelligible unities. So far, therefore, as they illuminate divine and imparticipable intellect, they are intellectual: but they are not so intellectual, as subsisting in intellect, but as subsisting through cause prior to, and generating intellect.

PROPOSITION CLXIV.

Every multitude of unities participated by imparticipable soul, is super-mundane.

FOR since imparticipable soul, is primarily super-mundane, the gods also participated by this soul, are super-mundane; possessing the same proportion to the intellectual, and intelligible gods, which soul has to intellect, and intellect to true being. As therefore every soul is extended to intellect, and intellect is converted to that which is intelligible; so likewise the super-mundane depend on the intellectual gods, in the same manner as these last, on such as are intelligible.

PROPOSITION CLXV.

Every multitude of unities participated by any sensible body, is mundane.

FOR it supernally illuminates the parts of the world, through the mediums of intellect and soul. For neither is intellect present without soul to any mundane body; nor are deity, and soul immediately conjoined: for participations subsist through similars. And intellect according to the intelligible which it contains, and the summit of its nature, participates of unity. Unities, therefore, are mundane, so far as they fill the whole world, and deity apparent bodies. For each of these is divine, not through soul; (for soul is not the first god) nor through intellect; (for this is not the same with *the one*), but is animated and self-motive, through soul. But it always contains itself in the same manner, and is carried in the best order through intellect; being at the same time divine through a divine unity. And if it possesses a providential power, it is such through unity as the cause.

PROPOSITION CLXVI.

Every intellect is either imparticipable, or participable. And if participable, it is either participated by super-mundane, or mundane souls.

FOR an imparticipable intellect possessing a primary hyparxis presides over every multitude of intellects. But of participated intellects, some are super-mundane, and illustrate

illustrate imparticipable soul; but others are mundane. For multitude emanating from an imparticipable, is not immediately mundane; since progressions subsist through similars. But that which is separated from the world, is more similar to an imparticipable, than that which is divided about it. And there is not only a super-mundane, but likewise a mundane multitude. Since there is likewise a mundane multitude of gods, and the world is at the same time animated and endued with intellect. And the participation of super-mundane gods by mundane souls, subsists through mundane intellects as the connecting mediums.

PROPOSITION CLXVII.

Every intellect understands itself. But the first intellect understands itself alone*. And in this, intellect and that which is intelligible is one in number. But all succeeding intellects, understand both themselves and prior intellects. † And the intelligible to this first intellect, is partly that which it is itself, and partly that from which it proceeds.

FOR every intellect either understands itself, or that which is above, or that which is posterior to itself. But if it understands that which is posterior to itself; since it is intellect it will be converted to a worse nature, and will not even know that to which it is converted, because the object of its intellection will not reside in its nature, but will be external. And thus it will only possess in itself a type, or figure, of this external object. For it knows that which it possesses, and that to which it is passive, but not that which it does not possess, and by which it is not affected. But if it understands that which is above itself, since this is accomplished by the knowledge of itself, it will both understand itself, and the nature superior to its own. But if it knows that alone, it will at the same time that it is intellect, be ignorant of itself. But by knowing that which is superior to itself, it knows also that it is a cause, and of what it is the cause: for if it is ignorant of these, it will also be ignorant of that superior

* This must be understood, not as if the first intellect understood nothing but itself; but that it understands no other intellect besides itself. For the divine unities, and the first one, are the objects of its continual speculation: and in this exalted employment its life and felicity invariably and eternally consists.

† This last sentence of the proposition, is in the original: καὶ οὗτος ἐστὶν νοῦς, τὸ πᾶν, ὃ ἐστὶν, τοῦ θεοῦ, ἀπ' αὐτοῦ ἐστὶν. And this Portus renders with his usual unskillfulness: et est mente-perceptum. Hoc autem partim quidem, est illud, quod est, partim vero, est illud, a quo est. That is, "and it is intelligible. But this is partly that which it is, but partly is that from which it is." The wrong pointing after ἐστὶν, which instead of a period should be a comma, and πᾶν being erroneously printed for οὗτος were the causes of Portus' mistake: and this he would have rectified, had he understood the proposition.

nature. And hence by knowing that which is prior to itself, it will also know itself. If therefore any intellect is intelligible, this by knowing itself will understand an intelligible, and will be itself its own intelligible. But each of the intellects posterior to this, will at the same time understand that which is intelligible in itself, and that which is prior to itself. There is, therefore, in intellect, that which is intelligible, and in that which is intelligible intellect. But the one, is the same with that which is intelligible *; and the other is the same with the intelligible in itself, but is not the same with the intelligible prior to itself. For the one is simply intelligible, and the other is an intelligible in an intelligent nature.

PROPOSITION CLXVIII.

Every intellect knows in energy that which it understands. And it is not the property of one part of its nature to know, and of another to understand that which it knows.

FOR if it is intellect in energy, and knows itself as not different from the object of its intellection †; it will both know and perceive itself. But beholding that which is intelligent, and knowing that which beholds, it will know that it is intellect in energy. And knowing this, it will know that it understands, and will not alone know the object of its intellection. It will, therefore, at the same time both know that which is intelligible, and that it understands this: and by intellection it will be understood by itself.

PROPOSITION CLXIX.

Every intellect possesses in eternity, its essence, power, and energy.

FOR if it understands itself, and intellect is the same with that which is intelligible; intellection also is the same with intellect, and intelligible. For since intelligence

* Thus for instance intellect in *being itself*, which comprehends the highest order of intelligibles, is *your source*, or an *intelligible intellect*; because it is the object of intelligence to all subordinate natures, and because its vision is transcendently simple and occult. But every intellect is indeed the same with the intelligible in its own nature, but is subordinate to *intelligible itself*.

† Intellect in energy, or in the act of understanding is the same with the object of its intellection. For the object of its perception, must be resident in its essence, or it would perceive externally like sense; and thus would not behold the thing itself, but only its image. But if that which is intelligible is seated in the essence of intellect, it will in no respect differ from intellect: for it will be essential to its nature, and will consequently be intellectual, as well as intelligible.

is a medium between that which knows, and that which is known; and since these two are the same, intelligence also will be one and the same with each of these. But since the essence of intellect is eternal (for the whole subsists at once) intelligence also will be eternal: for it is the same with the essence of intellect. But if intellect is eternal, it will by no means be measured by time, neither according to essence, nor according to energy. And since these subsist in the same manner, the power also of intellect is eternal.

PROPOSITION CLXX.

Every intellect, at once understands all things. But an imparticipable intellect understands all things simply. And each of the intellects posterior to this understands all things according to one.

FOR if every intellect establishes its essence in eternity, and together with its essence, its energy, it will understand all things at once. And all things indeed exist according to parts, and a successive energy, which do not subsist in eternity. For every thing successive subsists in time; since it possesses prior and posterior, which are successive, and do not subsist all at once. If, therefore, all intellects understand similarly, they will not differ from each other: for if they understand all things similarly, they are all things similarly; since they are no other than the things which they understand. But if they are all things similarly, one intellect will not be imparticipable, and another not: for their essences are the same with the objects of their intellections; since the intellection of each is the same with its essence, and every intellect is both intelligence and essence. It remains, therefore, either that every intellect does not equally know all things but one or more, and not all things together; or that it knows all things according to one*. But to assert that intellect does not understand all things, is to make it ignorant of some particular being. For if it is affected with transition, and does not understand *at once*, but according to prior and posterior, at the same time possessing an immoveable nature, it will be inferior to soul, understanding all things according to motion, or a mutable energy; because intellect on this hypothesis, will only understand one thing by its permanent energy. It will, therefore, understand all things according to one. For it either understands all things; or one thing; or all things according to one. And the intelligence indeed of all things perpetually subsists in all intellects: but they terminate

* By an intellection *according to one* (*καθ' ἓνα*) we must understand a various intelligence subsisting indivisibly, and without mutation. Just as when by one and the same energy of vision, we survey the various parts of the same countenance though distant from each other. And an intellection of this kind belongs to all intellects subordinate to the first: for the intelligence of this is perfectly simple, and comprehends all things in one.

all things, according to one intelligence of all. Hence there is something pre-dominant in intellection, and the objects of intelligence; since all things are at once understood as one, through the dominion of one, which characterizes all things with itself.

PROPOSITION CLXXI.

Every intellect is an impartible, or indivisible essence.

FOR if it is without magnitude, incorporeal, and immoveable, it is impartible.

For every thing in any respect partible, is either partible on account of magnitude, or multitude, or on account of energies subsisting in time. But intellect is eternal according to all things, and is beyond a corporeal nature; and the multitude which it contains is united. It is, therefore, impartible. But that intellect is incorporeal, is manifest, from its conversion to itself: for no body possesses a self-convertive power. But that intellect is also eternal, the identity of its energy with its essence evinces: for this we have already demonstrated. And that its multitude is united, is evident from the coherence of intellectual multitude, with the divine unities: for these are the first multitude, and after these intellects subsist. Hence though every intellect is a multitude, yet it is an united multitude. For prior to that which is divided, that which is collected, and is nearer to the one, subsists.

PROPOSITION CLXXII.

Every intellect is the proximate sustaining cause of natures eternal, and immutable according to essence.

FOR every thing produced from an immoveable cause, is immutable according to essence. But immoveable intellect being all things eternally, and abiding in eternity, essentially produces that which it produces. But if it is perpetual, and subsists after the same manner, it will always produce, and according to one uniform energy. Hence it is not the cause of things which are sometimes beings, and sometimes not, but it is the cause of eternal beings.

PROPOSITION CLXXIII.

Every intellect is intellectually both the things which are prior and posterior to itself.

FOR it is the same with things posterior to itself according to cause, and with things prior to itself by participation: but still it is intellect, and is allotted an intellectual essence.

essence. Hence it defines all things according to its essence; both such as subsist according to cause in another, and such as subsist according to participation. For every thing according to its natural constitution, participates of more excellent natures: but not according to the subsistence of its superiors. For these indeed are participated by all things, though in a different respect, according to the various natures of the participants. And hence participations subsist according to the characteristic and power of the participants: and consequently in intellect things prior to its nature, subsist in an intellectual manner. But intellect is likewise intellectually things posterior to itself: for it does not consist from its effects, nor does it contain these, but the causes of these in itself. But intellect is the cause of all things by its essence, and its essence is intellectual; and consequently it contains the causes of all things intellectually. Hence every intellect possesses all things intellectually; both such as are prior and such as are posterior to itself. As, therefore, every intellect contains intelligibles intellectually, so likewise it contains sensibles according to an intellectual subsistence.

PROPOSITION CLXXIV.

Every intellect constitutes through intelligence natures posterior to itself: and its fabrication is contained in intellection, and its intelligence in fabrication.

FOR if intelligible and intellect is the same; hence the being of every intellect consists in self-intellection. But it fabricates that which it fabricates by its essence, and produces that which is, according to being; and consequently its productions arise from intelligence. For in intellect being and intelligence are one: because intellect is the same with every being which it contains. If, therefore, intellect fabricates by its essence, and its essence is intellection, it will operate through intelligence, and intelligence will subsist in energy in intellection. But this is the same with its essence: and its essence consists in operating. For that which operates immoveably, always possesses its essence in operating: and consequently intellection consists in fabrication.

PROPOSITION CLXXV.

Every intellect is primarily participated by those natures, which are intellectual, both according to essence, and according to energy.

FOR it is necessary that it should either be participated by these, or by other natures, which possess indeed an intellectual essence, but are not always intelligent. But it

is impossible that it should be participated by these latter. For the energy of intellect is immoveable. And hence the natures by which intellect is participated, always participate of an intellectual energy, which always causes the participants to be intellectual. For that which possesses its energy in any part of time, cannot be conjoined with an eternity of energy. But as in essences themselves, so also in the variations of energies, between every eternal energy, and that energy which receives its perfection in some period of time, that energy intervenes which possesses its perfection through the whole of time. For progressions subsist nowhere immediately, but are produced through kindred and similar natures, both according to hypostases, and the perfections of energies. Every intellect, therefore, is primarily participated by those natures which are able to understand through the whole of time, and which possess a perpetual intelligence; though their intellection may subsist according to time, and not according to the stability of eternity.

COROLLARY.

From hence it is evident that the soul which sometimes understands, and at other times is void of intellection, cannot proximately participate of intellect.

PROPOSITION CLXXVI.

All intellectual forms subsist in one another, and each is at the same time separate and distinct from the rest.

FOR if every intellect is impartible, and the multitude which it contains is united through an intellectual impartibility: hence all that intellect contains will entirely subsist in one, and impartibles will be united to each other, and all intellectual forms will penetrate through all. But if all intellectual forms subsist immaterially, and incorporeally, they are without confusion with respect to each other, and each separately preserves its own purity, and abides that which it is. But the characteristic participation of each distinct participant, declares the unconfused subsistence of intellectual forms. For if participated natures were not distinguished, and separate from each other, neither would their participants participate them distinctly, but there would be a much greater indistinct confusion in subordinate natures, from their subsisting in a more degraded order. For from whence could distinction arise, if the natures which constitute and perfect these, should be indistinct and confused? Again, the hypostasis of that which contains impartibly, and an uniform essence, attest the union of forms. For things possessing their hyparxis, in that which is impartible and uniform, subsist impartibly in the same. For how can that be divided, which is impartible and one? For natures of this kind

kind subsist together, and penetrate totally through each other, without distance: since that which contains, is not distant; and one thing is not in this place, and another in that, as in things separated by interval from each other. But every thing at once subsists in that which is impartible and one: and consequently they all subsist in each other. All intellectual forms, therefore, subsist unitedly in each other, and each is at the same time distinctly separate from the rest.

C O R O L L A R Y.

But if any one besides the above demonstrations requires examples, let him contemplate the theorems resident in one particular soul; all which subsist truly in the same soul, in an essence destitute of magnitude, and are united to each other. For the soul does not contain the things resident in its nature, according to magnitude, and locally, but impartibly, and without distance, unitedly, and distinct. For the soul produces all things distinctly, and each at the same time separate and apart, without attracting any thing to itself from the rest, which unless they were always distinguished according to habit, would not be distinguished by the energy of the soul.

P R O P O S I T I O N CLXXVII.

Every intellect since it is a plenitude of forms, comprehends either more universal or more particular forms. And superior intellects contain in a more universal manner, whatever posterior intellects contain in a more particular manner. But inferior intellects, contain according to a more partial mode, whatever prior intellects contain more universally.

FOR superior intellects employ greater powers, because they are more uniform than secondary intellects. But inferior intellects, from their being more multiplied, diminish the powers which they possess. For such as are more allied to the one, being contracted in quantity, are superior in power to such as are posterior; while such as are more distant from the one possess a contrary property. Superior intellects, therefore, establishing a greater power, but a less multitude, produce more effects through forms, less according to quantity. [But * intellects posterior to these, produce fewer

* That part of this proposition, within the crotchets is in one place very defective in the Greek, which may be corrected as follows: Instead of reading *ὅτι μὲν ἡμεῖς, ἡ πλείονα, ἡμεῖς. κατὰ τὸ ἴδιον ὡς ἡμεῖς ἐκείνη* ἢ ἡμεῖς πλείονα παραγόμεν, διανέμεται αὐτῇ ἴδῃ: read after *πλείονα*:—*ἡμεῖς, κατὰ τὸ ἴδιον ὡς ἡμεῖς ἐκείνη* αὐτῇ ἴδῃ, and the rest as above.

effects, through a greater multitude of forms, on account of their deficiency in power. If, therefore, superior intellects produce more effects, through a less number of forms, the forms which they contain are more universal.] And if inferior intellects, produce fewer effects through a greater multitude of forms, the forms which they contain, are more particular.

C O R O L L A R Y.

From hence it happens that the natures which are generated from the superior orders according to one form, are produced in a divided manner from secondary orders, according to a greater multitude of ideas. And on the contrary those natures which are produced from things subordinate, through many, and distinct forms, are produced by superior natures, through fewer, and more universal forms. And that which is universal and common, supernally accedes to all participants. But that which is divided, and peculiar proceeds from secondary natures. Hence secondary intellects by the more particular separation of characteristics, articulately distinguish, and attenuate the formations of primary intellects.

P R O P O S I T I O N CLXXVIII.

Every intellectual form, is the framer of eternal natures.

FOR if every intellectual form is eternal, and immoveable, it is essentially the cause of immutable and eternal hypostases; but not of such as subsist in generation, and are corruptible. And hence every thing fabricated according to an intellectual form, is an *intellectual eternal*. For if it produces all forms posterior to such as are intellectual, through *being*; and if the being of intellectual forms is eternally the same, their productions also will subsist after the same manner, and will be eternal. Hence neither the genera which according to some particular time, are fabricated by a formal cause, nor things corruptible, so far as corruptible, possess a pre-existent intellectual form. For they would be void of corruption and generation, if they possessed their hypostasis, according to a pre-existent intellectual form.

P R O P O S I T I O N CLXXIX.

Every intellectual number is bounded.

FOR if there is another multitude posterior to this diminished according to *essence*, and so more remote from the one, while intellectual number is nearer to the one:

and

and if that which is nearer to the one, is less according to quantity, and that which is far distant is more according to quantity; intellectual number also will be less than every multitude posterior to its nature. It is not, therefore, infinite: and so the multitude of intellects is bounded. For that which is less than another, is not infinite: because infinite, so far as infinite, is not less than any thing.

PROPOSITION CLXXX.

Every intellect is a whole, as composed from parts, and is united with others, and at the same time distinguished from them. But imparticipable intellect is simply universal; and contains in itself, as it were all parts universally. But each particular intellect possesses the whole as in a part; and thus contains all things particularly.

FOR if it is all things according to one thing; and if that which is all things according to one, is something particular alone: hence, the whole subsists in each of these particularly, on account of something particular, determinately predominating in them all.

PROPOSITION CLXXXI.

Every intellect which is participated is either divine, as depending on the gods; or is intellectual only.

FOR if there is a divine and imparticipable intellect, that which is primarily allied to this, does not differ from it in both these respects; that it is not divine, and that it is not imparticipable. For things dissimilar in both these respects, cannot be conjoined with each other. It is evident, therefore, that the medium between these, is partly similar to the first intellect, and partly dissimilar. Either, therefore, it is imparticipable, and not divine; or it is participated, and divine. But every thing imparticipable is divine, as being allotted an order in multitude, analogous to the one. And hence there will be some one intellect, divine, and at the same time participated. But it is requisite that there should be an intellect, not participating the divine unities, but intelligent only. For in every series, first natures, and which are conjoined with their unity, are able to participate their proximate superiors. But such as are far distant from their primary unity, cannot depend on the natures placed in an order proximately superior to their

their own. There is, therefore, both a divine intellect, and an intellect intellectual alone. And the latter subsists according to an intellectual characteristic which it possesses from its own unity, and from imparticipable intellect: but the former according to a union, which it receives from participated unity.

PROPOSITION CLXXXII.

Every divine intellect, which is participated, is participated by divine souls.

FOR if participation renders the participant similar, and causes it to be allied to that which is participated; it is evident that that which participates a divine intellect, must be a divine soul *. It is likewise evident that it must depend on a divine intellect, and that it must participate the deity which it contains, through intellect as a medium. For † intellect connects with deity (*θεός*) its participant soul, and conjoins one divine nature with another.

PROPOSITION CLXXXIII.

Every intellect, which is participated indeed, but is intellectual alone, is participated by souls neither divine, nor subsisting in a mutation from intellect, into a privation of intellect.

FOR neither are divine souls of this kind; nor such as participate of intellect. For souls participate of the gods through a divine intellect, as we have already demonstrated. Nor are such as participate of an intellectual intellect susceptible of mutation. For every intellect is participated by natures, which are always intellectual, both according to essence, and according to energy; as is evident from the preceding propositions.

* The reader must observe that this is to be understood of immediate participation.

† Instead of *ὁ θεὸς διὰ τοῦ νοῦ* as in the original, the sense requires that we should read *ὁ θεὸς διὰ τοῦ νοῦ* as in the original, the sense requires that we should read *ὁ θεὸς διὰ τοῦ νοῦ*.

CONCERNING

CONCERNING SOUL.

PROPOSITION CLXXXIV.

Every soul is either divine, or capable of being changed from intellect into a privation of intellect; or it always remains as a medium between these, and is at the same time inferior to divine souls.

FOR if a divine intellect is participated by divine souls, but an intellectual intellect, by those souls alone, which are neither divine, nor susceptible of a mutation from intellect into a privation of intellect (for there are souls of this kind, which sometimes understand, and are sometimes destitute of intelligence); it is evident that there are three genera of souls. And the first indeed are divine. But the second are not divine, yet they always participate of intellect. And the third are those, which are sometimes changed into an intellectual condition, and sometimes into a privation of intellect.

PROPOSITION CLXXXV.

All divine souls, are gods animastically, (*ψυχικῶς*, or according to the nature of soul). But all souls participating an intellectual intellect, are the perpetual attendants of the gods. And all souls susceptible of mutation, are some time or other attendants of the gods.

FOR if some souls possess a divine light, supernally illustrating their nature, but others are endued with perpetual intelligence, and others again, are sometimes only allotted this perfection: hence the first of these will among the multitude of souls, be analogous to the gods; but the second, will perpetually attend the gods, on account of their perpetually energizing intellect, and will depend on divine souls, to which they will have the same proportion, as that which is intellectual to that which is divine. And those which are sometimes endued with intelligence, will also sometimes attend the gods; but they will neither always participate intellect after the same manner, nor will they always be conversant with divine souls. For that which is only sometimes allotted intellect, cannot by any means always attend the gods.

P R O P O.

effects, through a greater multitude of forms, on account of their deficiency in power. If, therefore, superior intellects produce more effects, through a less number of forms, the forms which they contain are more universal.] And if inferior intellects, produce fewer effects through a greater multitude of forms, the forms which they contain, are more particular.

C O R O L L A R Y.

From hence it happens that the natures which are generated from the superior orders according to one form, are produced in a divided manner from secondary orders, according to a greater multitude of ideas. And on the contrary those natures which are produced from things subordinate, through many, and distinct forms, are produced by superior natures, through fewer, and more universal forms. And that which is universal and common, supernally accedes to all participants. But that which is divided, and peculiar proceeds from secondary natures. Hence secondary intellects by the more particular separation of characteristics, articulately distinguish, and attenuate the formations of primary intellects.

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FOR if every intellectual form is eternal, and immoveable, it is essentially the cause of immutable and eternal hypostases; but not of such as subsist in generation, and are corruptible. And hence every thing fabricated according to an intellectual form, is an *intellectual eternal*. For if it produces all forms posterior to such as are intellectual, through *being*; and if the being of intellectual forms is eternally the same, their productions also will subsist after the same manner, and will be eternal. Hence neither the genera which according to some particular time, are fabricated by a formal cause, nor things corruptible, so far as corruptible, possess a pre-existent intellectual form. For they would be void of corruption and generation, if they possessed their hypostasis, according to a pre-existent intellectual form.

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and if that which is nearer to the one, is less according to quantity, and that which is far distant is more according to quantity; intellectual number also will be less than every multitude posterior to its nature. It is not, therefore, infinite: and so the multitude of intellects is bounded. For that which is less than another, is not infinite: because infinite, so far as infinite, is not less than any thing.

PROPOSITION CLXXX.

Every intellect is a whole, as composed from parts, and is united with others, and at the same time distinguished from them. But imparticipable intellect is simply universal; and contains in itself, as it were all parts universally. But each particular intellect possesses the whole as in a part; and thus contains all things particularly.

FOR if it is all things according to one thing; and if that which is all things according to one, is something particular alone: hence, the whole subsists in each of these particularly, on account of something particular, determinately predominating in them all.

PROPOSITION CLXXXI.

Every intellect which is participated is either divine, as depending on the gods; or is intellectual only.

FOR if there is a divine and imparticipable intellect, that which is primarily allied to this, does not differ from it in both these respects; that it is not divine, and that it is not imparticipable. For things dissimilar in both these respects, cannot be conjoined with each other. It is evident, therefore, that the medium between these, is partly similar to the first intellect, and partly dissimilar. Either, therefore, it is imparticipable, and not divine; or it is participated, and divine. But every thing imparticipable is divine, as being allotted an order in multitude, analogous to the one. And hence there will be some one intellect, divine, and at the same time participated. But it is requisite that there should be an intellect, not participating the divine unities, but intelligent only. For in every series, first natures, and which are conjoined with their unity, are able to participate their proximate superiors. But such as are far distant from their primary unity, cannot depend on the natures placed in an order proximately superior to their

their own. There is, therefore, both a divine intellect, and an intellect intellectual alone. And the latter subsists according to an intellectual characteristic which it possesses from its own unity, and from imparticipable intellect: but the former according to a union, which it receives from participated unity.

PROPOSITION CLXXXII.

Every divine intellect, which is participated, is participated by divine souls.

FOR if participation renders the participant similar, and causes it to be allied to that which is participated; it is evident that that which participates a divine intellect, must be a divine soul *. It is likewise evident that it must depend on a divine intellect, and that it must participate the deity which it contains, through intellect as a medium. For † intellect connects with deity (*θεός*) its participant soul, and conjoins one divine nature with another.

PROPOSITION CLXXXIII.

Every intellect, which is participated indeed, but is intellectual alone, is participated by souls neither divine, nor subsisting in a mutation from intellect, into a privation of intellect.

FOR neither are divine souls of this kind; nor such as participate of intellect. For souls participate of the gods through a divine intellect, as we have already demonstrated. Nor are such as participate of an intellectual intellect susceptible of mutation. For every intellect is participated by natures, which are always intellectual, both according to essence, and according to energy; as is evident from the preceding propositions.

* The reader must observe that this is to be understood of immediate participation.

† Instead of *ὁ γὰρ θεὸς συνῆλκεν τὴν ψ. κ. τ. λ.* as in the original, the sense requires that we should read *ὁ γὰρ εὐς συνῆλκεν τὴν θεότητα. κ. τ. λ.*

CONCERNING

CONCERNING SOUL.

PROPOSITION CLXXXIV.

Every soul is either divine, or capable of being changed from intellect into a privation of intellect; or it always remains as a medium between these, and is at the same time inferior to divine souls.

FOR if a divine intellect is participated by divine souls, but an intellectual intellect, by those souls alone, which are neither divine, nor susceptible of a mutation from intellect into a privation of intellect (for there are souls of this kind, which sometimes understand, and are sometimes destitute of intelligence); it is evident that there are three genera of souls. And the first indeed are divine. But the second are not divine, yet they always participate of intellect. And the third are those, which are sometimes changed into an intellectual condition, and sometimes into a privation of intellect.

PROPOSITION CLXXXV.

All divine souls, are gods animastically, (*ψυχμας*, or according to the nature of soul). But all souls participating an intellectual intellect, are the perpetual attendants of the gods. And all souls susceptible of mutation, are some time or other attendants of the gods.

FOR if some souls possess a divine light, supernally illustrating their nature, but others are endued with perpetual intelligence, and others again, are sometimes only allotted this perfection: hence the first of these will among the multitude of souls, be analogous to the gods; but the second, will perpetually attend the gods, on account of their perpetually energizing intellect, and will depend on divine souls, to which they will have the same proportion, as that which is intellectual to that which is divine. And those which are sometimes endued with intelligence, will also sometimes attend the gods; but they will neither always participate intellect after the same manner, nor will they always be conversant with divine souls. For that which is only sometimes allotted intellect, cannot by any means always attend the gods.

P R O P O

PROPOSITION CLXXXVI.

Every soul is both an incorporeal essence, and separable from body.

FOR if it knows itself, and if every thing self-gnostic, is converted to itself, and every thing converted to itself is not a body (for every body is incapable of self-conversion), nor inseparable from body; for every thing inseparable from body, is not naturally adapted to be converted to itself, since through this, it would be separated from body; hence every soul, is neither a corporeal essence, nor inseparable from body. But that the soul, knows itself, is manifest. For if it knows things superior to itself, and is naturally adapted to know itself, it will much more know itself, through causes prior to its own nature *.

PROPOSITION CLXXXVII.

Every soul is immortal and incorruptible.

FOR every thing which is capable in any respect of dissolution and dispersion, is either corporeal and a composite, or is allotted an hypostasis in a subject. And that indeed which is dissolved, is corrupted, as subsisting from many things. But that which is naturally adapted to subsist in another, when separated from its subject, vanishes into non-entity. But soul is both incorporeal, and external to every subject, residing in itself, and being converted to itself. It is, therefore, immortal, and incorruptible.

PROPOSITION CLXXXVIII.

Every soul, is both life, and vital.

FOR that to which soul accedes necessarily lives; and that which is deprived of soul, is immediately left destitute of life. For it either lives through soul, or through something else, and not through soul. But it is impossible, that it should live through something else alone. For every thing which is participated, either communicates it-

* For inferiors are comprehended in superiors, and particulars in universals; so that he who knows universals, knows particulars also; though the reverse of this is not true. The soul, therefore, by possessing a natural capacity of knowing herself, and things superior to her own nature, will from the illuminations attending her knowledge of the latter, know herself in a much more eminent and perspicuous manner.

self,

self, or something of itself to its participant. But if it should do neither of these, neither will it be participated. But soul is participated by that to which it is present: and that is called animated, which participates of soul. If, therefore, that which is participated confers life on animated natures, it is either life, or vital alone, or at the same time both life and vital. But if it is vital alone, and not also life, it will be composed from life, and non-life*: and thus it will neither know, nor be converted to itself. For *life is knowledge*†; and that which is gnostic, or endued with knowledge, so far as it is gnostic, lives. If, therefore, there is any thing in soul destitute of life, this something will not essentially possess a self-gnostic power. But if soul, is life alone, it will no longer participate an intellectual life. For that which participates of life, is vital, and not life alone; since that which is life alone, is first and imparticipable life. But life posterior to this, is vital, and at the same time life. And soul is not imparticipable life. It is, therefore, both life, and vital.

PROPOSITION CLXXXIX.

Every soul is self-vital.

FOR if it is converted to itself, and every thing self-convertive, is self-subsistent, soul also is self-subsistent, and sustains itself. But it is also both life, and vital, and its hyparxis is according to vitality. For to whatever natures it is present, it communicates life, through its essence. And if the participant is adapted to participation, it immediately becomes animated and vital; soul neither reasoning nor choosing, nor vivifying by reasoning and judgement, but by its essence alone communicating life to the participant. Hence the being of soul, is the same with its life. If, therefore, it possesses being from itself, and this is the same with its life, it will essentially possess life, and will afford life to itself, and will possess life from itself. But if this be the case, soul will be self-vital.

* Thus for instance the body of the world, or of any particular animal, is *vital* from its receiving the echo of soul; but as it does not at the same time, essentially possess *life*, (or else it would be soul) it is composed from life, and non-life. For it is nothing more than body, or non-life, united with the last image of soul, or a debile life.

† This truly divine sentence, is derived from the most profound theory; and can alone be understood by those who have deeply studied the six books of Proclus on Plato's Theology. I shall, therefore, only observe for the sake of the *intellectual reader*, that as *essence*, *life*, and *intellect* subsist in occult union, in the first being, which comprehends the highest order of the gods; and as *intelligence* is the medium between that which is *intelligible*, and *intellect*; it is evident that life itself is intelligence.

PROPOSITION CXI.

Every soul is a medium between natures impartible, and such as are divisible about bodies.

FOR if it is self-vital, and self-subsistent, and has an hyparxis separate from bodies, it is separated from, and is more excellent than all partible natures, subsisting about bodies. For these are entirely inseparable from their subjects; because they are divided together with divisible weights, depart from themselves, and their own impartibility, and are co-extended with bodies. And though they subsist in vital natures, yet these are not the lives of partible essences, but of their participants: and though they abide in essence and forms, yet these are not their own forms, for they are forms of formed natures. Soul, therefore, is a self-subsisting, and self-vital essence; it is likewise a knowledge, gnostic of itself, and according to all these separable from bodies. But it likewise participates of life: and if this be admitted, it likewise participates of essence. But it participates also of knowledge from other causes. And hence it is evident, that it is worse than impartibles, because it is filled with life externally: and if with life, it is evident that it is also externally replenished with essence. For prior to every particular life, impartible life, and impartible essence subsists. But it is likewise manifest that soul, is not the first gnostic nature. For every soul so far as soul, possesses life indeed, but not knowledge also from its existing as soul. For certain souls, while they remain as souls, are at the same time ignorant of beings. Soul, therefore, is not the first gnostic nature, nor does it possess knowledge on account of its essence. And hence it possesses an essence the second from those, which are primarily, and essentially gnostic. Since, therefore, the essence of soul is divided from its knowledge, it does not rank among natures purely impartible. But it has been demonstrated, that neither does it subsist in the order of things divisible about bodies. It is, therefore, situated between both.

PROPOSITION CXII.

Every participable soul possesses an eternal essence, but its energy subsists in time.

FOR either it possesses both eternally, or both temporally; or one eternally, but the other temporally. But it cannot possess both eternally: for on this hypothesis, it would be an impartible essence; and the nature of soul would differ nothing from an intellectual

tellectual hypostasis; viz. a self-motive from an immoveable nature. Nor can it possess both its energy and essence in time: for thus it would be generated alone; and would neither be self-vital, nor self-subsistent. For nothing measured by time is essentially self-subsistent. But soul is self-subsistent. For that which is converted to itself according to energy, is also essentially converted to itself, and proceeds from itself. It remains, therefore, that every soul is partly eternal, and partly a participant of time. It is either, therefore, eternal according to essence, but participating of time, according to energy; or the contrary. But this latter hypothesis is impossible. Every participable soul, therefore, is allotted an eternal essence, but possesses an energy according to time.

PROPOSITION CXCH.

Every participable soul, ranks in the number of eternal beings, and among the first of generated natures.

FOR if it is eternal according to essence, it is true being according to its hyparxis, and is a perpetual being. For that which participates of eternity, participates likewise of perpetual being. But if it subsists in time according to energy, it is generated. For every thing participating of time, is always in generation (or in becoming to be) according to the prior and posterior of time, and is not at once, that which it is, but the whole of it is generated. But if every soul, is in a certain respect generated according to energy, it will be the first of generated natures. For that which is entirely generated, is more remote from eternal natures.

PROPOSITION CXCH.

Every soul subsists proximate to intellect.

FOR if it possesses an eternal, and immutable essence, it proceeds from an immoveable essence: since that which proceeds from a moveable essence, is entirely changed according to essence. The cause, therefore, of every soul is immoveable. But if it is proximately perfected by intellect, it is also converted to intellect, and participates the knowledge, which intellect confers on the natures able to participate cognition. For all knowledge proceeding from intellect, is inherent in all the natures, in which intellect resides. But that to which all things are naturally converted, is the source of their progression according to essence. Every soul, therefore, proceeds from intellect.

PROPOSITION CXCV.

Every soul possesses in a secondary manner, all the forms, which intellect primarily contains.

FOR if it proceeds from intellect, and intellect is the fabricator of soul; and if intellect subsisting immoveably produces all things; it will also impart to soul, which it constitutes, the essential reasons of all things which it contains. For every thing which operates through essence, imparts secondarily to its production, that which it is itself primarily. Soul, therefore, contains in a secondary manner the representations of intellectual forms.

PROPOSITION CXCV.

Every soul is all things, containing sensible natures, after the manner of an exemplar; (*παραδείγματικῶς*) but intelligibles after the manner of images (*εἰκονικῶς*).

FOR subsisting as a medium between natures impartible, and such as are divided about bodies; it produces and constitutes the latter of these; but establishes in itself the prior causes from which it proceeds. Hence it previously receives after the manner of an exemplar the natures to which it is prior as their cause: but it possesses through participation, and as the blossoms of first natures, the causes of its subsistence. It previously receives in its essence, therefore, through cause all sensible natures, and contains immaterial reasons of things material, incorporeal of such as are corporeal, and indistant of such as are distinguished by interval. But it contains intelligibles after the manner of an image, and receives partly, their impartible forms, such as are uniform variously, and such as are immoveable according to a self motive condition. Soul, therefore, is all beings; containing such as are first through participation, but such as are posterior to its nature, after the manner of an exemplar.

PROPOSITION CXCVI.

Every participable soul primarily uses an eternal body, which possesses an unbegotten and incorruptible hypostasis.

FOR if every soul is eternal according to essence, and through its essence first animates some particular body, it will always animate this body: for the essence of
every

every soul is immutable. But if this be admitted, that which is animated must be always animated, and must always participate life. But that which always lives, is perpetual by far the first of all things*. And that which is perpetual is eternal. Hence that body which is first animated, and which first depends on soul, is eternal. But every participable soul is primarily participated by some particular body; since it is not impartible, and essentially animates its participant. Every participable, or participated soul, therefore, uses a body primarily eternal, without generation, and incorruptible according to essence.

PROPOSITION CXCVII.

Every soul is *an essence* vital and gnostic, and *a life* essential, and gnostic, and is both knowledge, essence, and life. It likewise contains all things together, the essential, the vital, and the gnostic; and all in all, and each separate and apart from the rest.

FOR if it has a middle subsistence between forms impartible, and such as are divisible about bodies; it is neither so impartible as all intellectual natures, nor so partible, as corporeal forms. Since, therefore, both essences, lives, and cognitions, are distributed in corporeal natures; all these subsist impartibly in souls, unitedly, and incorporeally, and are at the same time all things, on account of their immateriality, and impartibility. And since all things subsist in intellects according to union, they are distinguished and divided in souls. All things, therefore, subsist together, and apart in soul. But if all impartibles subsist together and in one, they mutually penetrate through each other: and if separate they are again divided without confusion; so that each subsists by itself, and all in all. For in essence there is both life and knowledge: since if essence was essentially deprived of life and knowledge, every soul would not know itself. And in life there is both essence and knowledge. For life without essence and knowledge belongs to material lives, which are neither able to know themselves, nor are sincere and pure essences. And knowledge which is both destitute of essence and life, is incapable of self subsistence. For all cognition belongs to that which is vital, and which is allotted essence essentially.

* Because eternity subsists in life, and is no other than infinite life, as is copiously proved from Plotinus, in the note to Proposition LII.

PROPOSITION CXCVIII.

Every thing which participates of time, and is always moved, is measured by periods.

FOR since it is measured by time it both participates a measure and bound of motion, and proceeds according to number. But because it is always moved, and this *always*, is not eternal *, but temporal, it is necessary that it should use periods. For motion is a certain mutation from some things into others. But beings are terminated by multitudes and magnitudes. And these being terminated, there can neither be an infinite mutation, according to a right line, nor can that which is always moved proceed according to a finished progression. Hence that which is always moved will proceed from the same to the same; and will thus form a period in its progression.

PROPOSITION CXCIX.

Every mundane soul uses periods and restitutions of its proper life.

FOR if it is measured by time it operates transitively, and possesses a proper motion. But every thing which is moved and participates of time, when it is eternal, uses periods, revolves periodically, and proceeds from the same to the same. And hence every mundane soul, possessing motion and energizing according to time, will both possess periods of motion, and restitutions into its pristine state. For every period of eternal natures, returns to its pristine state.

PROPOSITION CC.

Every period of soul is measured by time. But the period of particular souls, is measured by some particular time: and the period of the first soul, since it is measured by time, is measured by universal time.

FOR if all motions contain prior and posterior, they participate of a period, and on this account of time. And that which measures all the periods of souls is time.

* For that which is properly eternal, is perfectly stable, and is never subject to mutation.

But

But if the periods of all souls were the same, and about the same; the time of all would be the same. But if the restitutions of different souls are different, the periodic time of their restitutions also, is different. That the soul, therefore, which is first measured by time, is measured by universal time, is evident. For if time is the measure of every motion; the first motion, will entirely participate of time, and will be measured by the whole of time. For if universal time, did not measure its first participant, neither would it measure any thing else, according to the whole of itself. But that all other souls are measured by the more particular measures of universal time, is evident from what we have now demonstrated. For if they are more particular than the soul which first participates of time, they cannot accommodate their periods to universal time. But the multitude of their restitutions, will be parts of that one period and restitution, by which the first participant of time, returns to its pristine state. For the participation of a lesser power is more particular, but of a greater, more universal. Other souls, therefore, are not naturally adapted to receive a universal temporal measure, through one life; since they are allotted an order more remote than that which is first measured by time, because they are allotted an inferior order.

PROPOSITION CCI.

All divine souls possess triple energies; one kind as souls; another as receiving a divine intellect; and a third kind, as depending on the gods. And they provide indeed for the universe, as gods; but they know all things through an intellectual life; and move bodies through a self-motive essence.

FOR since they naturally participate supermundane natures, and are not simply souls, but divine souls, bearing before themselves an order analogous to the gods, in an animastic latitude; they will energize not only animastically, but also divinely; because they are allotted a deified summit in their essence, and possess an intellectual hypostasis, through which they are spread under intellectual essences. They energize, therefore, not only divinely, but also intellectually; possessing one energy according to the one, which they contain in the recesses of their natures, but another according to an intellectual operation. There is likewise present to these divine souls, an energy according to their proper hyparxis; which is motive of natures moved by others, but vivific of such as possess an adventitious life. For this is the proper employment of every soul; but such energies as intelligence and providence, they receive through participation.

PROPO-

PROPOSITION CCII.

All souls attending upon, and always following the gods, are inferior to divine, but more eminent than particular souls.

FOR divine souls participate of intellect and deity. They are, therefore, at the same time intellectual and divine, and preside over other souls, in the same manner as the gods preside over the universality of things. But particular souls are deprived of a suspension from intellect, because they are not able to participate proximately of a divine essence. For they would not fall from an intellectual energy, if they essentially participated of intellect, as we have previously demonstrated*. Hence the souls, which always follow the gods, are of a middle condition; participating indeed a perfect intellect, and through this surpassing particular souls, yet not depending on the divine unities. For the intellect which they participate is not a divine intellect.

PROPOSITION CCIII.

Of every animastic multitude, (i. e. a multitude belonging to souls) divine souls since they are greater than others in power, are contracted according to number. But such as always follow the gods, retain a middle order among all souls, both in power, and quantity. And particular souls, are inferior to others in power, but proceed according to a greater number.

FOR divine souls are more allied to the one, on account of a divine essence; but those of a middle order, through the participation of intellect. And those of the last order, are essentially dissimilar to those of the middle and first kind. But among eternal natures such as are nearer to the one, are more united in number, and are more contracted in multitude, than such as are more distant. But such as are more remote, are more multiplied. Hence the powers of superior souls, are greater, and have the same proportion to secondary souls, as that which is divine to that which is intellectual, and as the intellectual to the animastic nature. And the quantities of inferior souls, are more in number. For that which is more distant from the one, is a greater, and that which is nearer a less multitude.

* In Proposition cxxxiv. And from hence it appears, that by particular souls in this Proposition, are meant such as are capable of being changed from the possession of intellect, into its privation.

PROPOSITION CCIV.

Every divine soul presides over many souls, the perpetual attendants on the gods ; and over a still greater number of such as sometimes receive this order.

FOR if it is divine, it is requisite that it should be allotted an order, generative of all things, and first-operative among souls. For that which is divine, throughout all beings, presides over the universality of things. And it is requisite that it should neither alone preside over such souls, as perpetually follow the gods ; nor alone over such as are sometimes their attendants. For if any divine soul alone presides over such souls as sometimes attend the gods, how can these be united with a divine soul ; since they are entirely different from this, and neither proximately participate intellect, nor (by a much stronger reason,) the gods ? But if it alone presides over such as perpetually follow the gods, how can the series proceed to souls, the partial attendants on the gods ? For thus intellectual natures will be the last, and will be unable through their barrenness, both to perfect other natures, and reduce them to their original. It is necessary, therefore, that such souls as follow the gods, and energize through intellect, and are reduced to intellects more partial than divine intellects, should first depend from every divine soul. But the second to these are partial or particular souls, which are able through the former, as mediums, to participate intellect, and a divine life. For through those which always participate, those which sometimes participate a more excellent condition, are perfected. And again, it is necessary, that about every divine soul, there should be a greater number of souls which sometimes follow, than of those which always attend on the gods. For the power of unity, always proceeds into multitude, according to remission, and subjection ; failing indeed in power, but excelling in number. Since in a similar manner every soul perpetually following the gods, presides over a greater multitude of particular souls, imitating a divine soul ; and elevates many souls to the first-operative unity of the whole series. Every divine soul, therefore, presides over a multitude of souls, the perpetual attendants on the gods : but presides over a still greater multitude of such as are sometimes allotted this order.

PROPOSITION CCV.

Every particular soul has the same proportion to the soul to which it is subjected according to essence, as the vehicle of the one to the vehicle of the other.

FOR if there is a natural distribution of vehicles in all souls, it is necessary that the vehicle of every particular soul, should have the same proportion to the vehicle of a universal soul, as the essence of the one, to the essence of the other. But the distribution of vehicles is according to nature: for first participants are naturally conjoined with the things participated*. If, therefore, as a divine soul is to a divine body, so is a particular soul to a particular body, each being participated essentially; hence that is true, which was asserted in the beginning, that vehicles also have the same proportion, as their correspondent souls.

PROPOSITION CCVI.

Every particular soul, possesses a power of descending infinitely into generation, and of ascending from generation to *being*.

FOR if it sometimes follows the gods, but sometimes falls from its pursuit of a divine nature, and alternately participates of intellect, and a privation of intellect; it is evident that it is conversant by parts in generation, and with the gods. But since it does not reside with the gods, through an infinite time, neither will it be conversant with bodies, through the whole succeeding time. For that which has no temporal beginning, cannot have any end: and that which has no end, is necessarily without a beginning†. It remains, therefore, that every soul must perform periods, both of ascensions from generation, and of descensions into generation; and that this will never fail, through an infinite time. Every particular soul, therefore, is capable of descending and ascending in infinitum: and this passion never ceases to take place about every particular soul.

* The reader must observe that these vehicles or divine bodies, the first participants of their correspondent souls, are no other than those vehicles, so beautifully described by Synesius, and inserted in the preceding history of Theology.

† For a demonstration of the truth of this sentence, see the note to page 59, vol. I. of this work.

PROPOSITION CCVII.

The vehicle of every particular soul is fabricated by an immoveable cause.

FOR if it eternally depends on the soul, by which it is used, and is by a natural sympathy immutable according to essence, it is allotted a subsistence from an immoveable cause. For that which is produced from moveable causes, is wholly changed according to essence. But every soul possesses an eternal body, which is the first participant of its nature. Hence the cause of every particular soul*, and consequently of its vehicle, is immoveable, and on this account super-mundane.

PROPOSITION CCVIII.

The vehicle of every particular soul, is immaterial, indivisible according to essence, and impassive.

FOR if it proceeds from an immoveable fabrication, and is eternal, it possesses an immaterial and impassive hypostasis. For such things as are naturally passive according to essence, are all of them changed, and material: and from their subsisting differently at different times depend on mutable causes. And on this account they receive an all various mutation, because they are moved with their primary causes. But that this vehicle is indivisible is manifest. For every thing which is divided, is corrupted so far as it is divided, because it relinquishes the whole, and departs from continuity and conjunction. If, therefore, the vehicle is essentially immutable, it will also be impassive, and indivisible.

PROPOSITION CCIX.

The vehicle of every particular soul descends indeed with the addition of material vestments †; but is conciliated with the soul, by

* Instead of *αὐτὴ καὶ ἡ ψυχὴ τοῦ σώματος*, καὶ τοῦ σώματος. *α. τ. λ.*—I read, *αὐτὴ καὶ αὐτὴ τοῦ σώματος ψυχὴ*, καὶ αὐτὴ. *α. τ. λ.*

† *ὑποπόδημα* is erroneously printed in the Greek, instead of *ὑποπόδημα*.

an ablation of every thing material, and by returning to a form proper to its nature, and analogous to the soul by which it is employed.

FOR the vehicle indeed descends, assuming irrational lives, but in its ascent, casts aside all the powers of generation, with which it was invested in its descent, and becoming [*pure returns to its proper form, and the pristine condition of its nature. It likewise**] imitates the lives of the souls which employ it as an instrument, and is every where moved in conformity, with their motions. And by its circulations, it represents the intellects of some souls, but the falling of others, through their inclination to the realms of generation; and the purgations of others through the revolutions which lead to an immaterial nature. But because it is essentially vivified by, and is connate with souls, it is all-variously changed along with their mutations; follows them every where; becomes passive, when they are exposed to passivity; returns with them when they are purified; and is elevated when they are elevated, and pursues its proper perfection. For every thing is perfected, when it pursues the perfection of its nature.

PROPOSITION CCX.

Every connate vehicle of the soul, possesses both a form and magnitude perpetually the same. But it appears to be both greater and less, and endued with a dissimilar figure, through the additions and ablations of other bodies.

FOR if it derives its essence from an immoveable cause, it is evident that both its figure and magnitude is derived from this cause: and each is immutable and invariable. But it appears differently at different times, as likewise greater, and less. Hence through the intervention of other bodies added from the material elements, and again taken away, it exhibits a different appearance both in quantity and form.

PROPOSITION CCXI.

Every particular soul, descending into generation descends totally. Nor does any part of it remain on high, and another part descend.

FOR if any thing belonging the soul remains in the intelligible world, it either perpetually understands without transition, or transitively. But if without transition,

* That part of this proposition, within the crotchets, is neither in the Greek which is here defective, nor in the translation of Patricius, but is added from my own conjecture; whether or not with propriety, the reader must determine.

it will be intellect, and not a part of the soul; and this particular soul will be that which proximately participates of intellect. But this is impossible. And if transitively, that which is perpetually, and that which is only sometimes intelligent, will form one essence. But this likewise is impossible: for all these differ, as we have previously shewn. Add too, the absurdity which results from supposing that the summit of the soul is perpetually perfect, and yet does not rule over the other powers, and give them perfection. Every particular soul, therefore, totally descends.

T H E E N D.